

Annual Report 2024



CHAPTERS
GROUP

NET XT CHAPTER

KEY FACTS

Countries

9

Operating
companies

48

Employees

~1.000



Invested Capital

> 260 MM €

Revenue

> 125 MM €

EBITDA

> 30 MM €



HAMBURG

HEADQUARTERS OF CHAPTERS GROUP AG

Foto: stock.adobe.com/rh2010



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LETTER TO THE SHAREHOLDERS

Dear shareholders, dear friends of the company,

2024 was a transformative year for us. We made major progress in sharpening our operating model and focusing on what we've set out to build in 2023 – the best home for mission critical digital solutions.



We operate as a decentralized group fueled by entrepreneurial energy.

Each company that joins brings its own unique culture and deep industry expertise, having developed tailored solutions rooted in customer proximity and market insight. We aim to preserve these cultures while strengthening the long-term competitiveness of each business.

To operate a decentralized organization at scale, we have centered our operating model around the "Manuscript Method". Spearheaded by our COO Marc Maurer who joined in March 2024 and his team, the Manuscript Method is developed alongside the platform managers. Based on our three core values (We grow together – We think in decades – We serve the edge), the Manuscript Method empowers our platforms and each operating subsidiary with real autonomy. We believe that Autonomy requires Authority: Decisions should be made by the teams closest to the customer.

Policy Deployment is our common language for aligning strategic priorities across the Group. Policy Deployment connects long-term goals with daily operations, ensures measurable progress, and supports accountability. The Manuscript itself is a set of standardized processes, tools, benchmarks, and best practices that foster continuous improvement and organic growth.

2024 as well as the first month of 2025 were also marked by the evolution of our corporate structure:

In 2024, we welcomed two new platforms: Waterkant Software GmbH and Altamount Software GmbH, both focused on vertical market software and each completing their first acquisition in 2024. Altamount brings a specific focus on Cybersecurity and GRC (Governance, Risk & Compliance) – an increasingly relevant area across all platforms.

In August 2024, we increased our stake in the Vertical Market Software Platform Ookam Software GmbH from 80% to 100%. Ookam comprised of 23 operating companies at that point and had already established sub-platforms with dedicated leadership in several industry-clusters. In early 2025, two new platforms emerged from Ookam: Via Unita Software GmbH and Vortex Software GmbH. In addition, we added two dedicated roles at CHAPTERS Group level responsible for other clusters within the former Ookam Group.

As part of the focus on mission-critical digital solutions, we also finalized the two spin-offs:

In September 2024, ENTRO Group, a subsidiary of NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH, secured a new funding partner to support its continued growth. Founded in 2022, ENTRO had acquired five companies in access solutions, fire protection, and security technology prior to the spin-off.

In April 2025, we completed the Management Buy-Out of GfW Group, which includes language schools across major German cities, a vocational school, and a professional training provider.

Both groups remain under the leadership of their (co-)founders and will continue to be supported by the NGC team. We also finalized the MBO of NGC itself.

These steps enable CHAPTERS to fully focus on growing its digital solutions portfolio.



In 2024, we also continued the growth of the Group. Fintiba GmbH joined forces with Coracle GmbH. In addition, 13 companies offering vertical market software solutions became part of the Group – delivering tailored digital solutions to a wide range of end clients, including Swiss border control and French public youth services to publishing houses, volunteer fire brigades, and motorcycle retailers.

With this ongoing growth, we are now shaping the Group around three core verticals: (1) Digital solutions for public sector clients and adjacent institutions, (2) Digital industry applications for enterprise clients, and (3) Digital solutions for financial services. This segmentation will guide strategic development and allow us to allocate resources with greater precision.



To fund the continuous growth of the company, we concluded two capital increases in 2024 – in March 2024, we finalized a capital increase for contribution in kind and became the largest shareholder of Software Circle plc, a serial acquirer of vertical market software businesses in the UK and Ireland.

In August 2024, we concluded a capital increase by way of cash contribution raising another € 85 million. In March 2025, we completed another capital increase raising an additional € 16.5 million.

We also strive to further optimize the financing structure. Alongside transaction-specific acquisition financing, we closed a junior debt facility in the amount of € 40 million right at the beginning of the financial year 2025 and decided to fully redeem the existing perpetual bond in May 2025.



The continued support of long-standing shareholders and the addition of new investors enables us to strengthen CHAPTERS in the long run and drives sustainable growth.

In the first few months of 2025, the Group developed very dynamically.

We would like to point out two transactions that illustrate the way the segmentation in industry verticals shapes our acquisition strategy:

Early in 2025, Altamount Software closed the acquisition of 100% of the shares of PSI Transcom GmbH, a software provider for public transportation companies. Only a few weeks later, Altamount also signed the acquisition of Verkehrsautomatisierung Berlin GmbH, one of the peers of PSI Transcom. Combining forces in the mission critical public transportation sector while keeping the individual corporate cultures and strength under the umbrella of Altamount, allows both companies to deliver even better services to their clients.

In May 2025, we announced the merger of Fintiba GmbH and Coracle GmbH with Expatrio Global Services GmbH. With these three companies joining forces combined with a strategic partnership with the Frankfurt International Bank AG under the CHAPTERS umbrella, the newly established player in financial services for international students and



expatriates plans to expand their product offering and making it even easier for international talent to access the German education and job market.



We're proud of the progress made and even more excited about the opportunities ahead.

We would like to thank all teams in the platform companies and operating companies for their great commitment and the development in 2024 and the beginning of 2025. It is great to see how each of the companies embraces their own strategic development plan and how each platform sharpens their vision and identity.

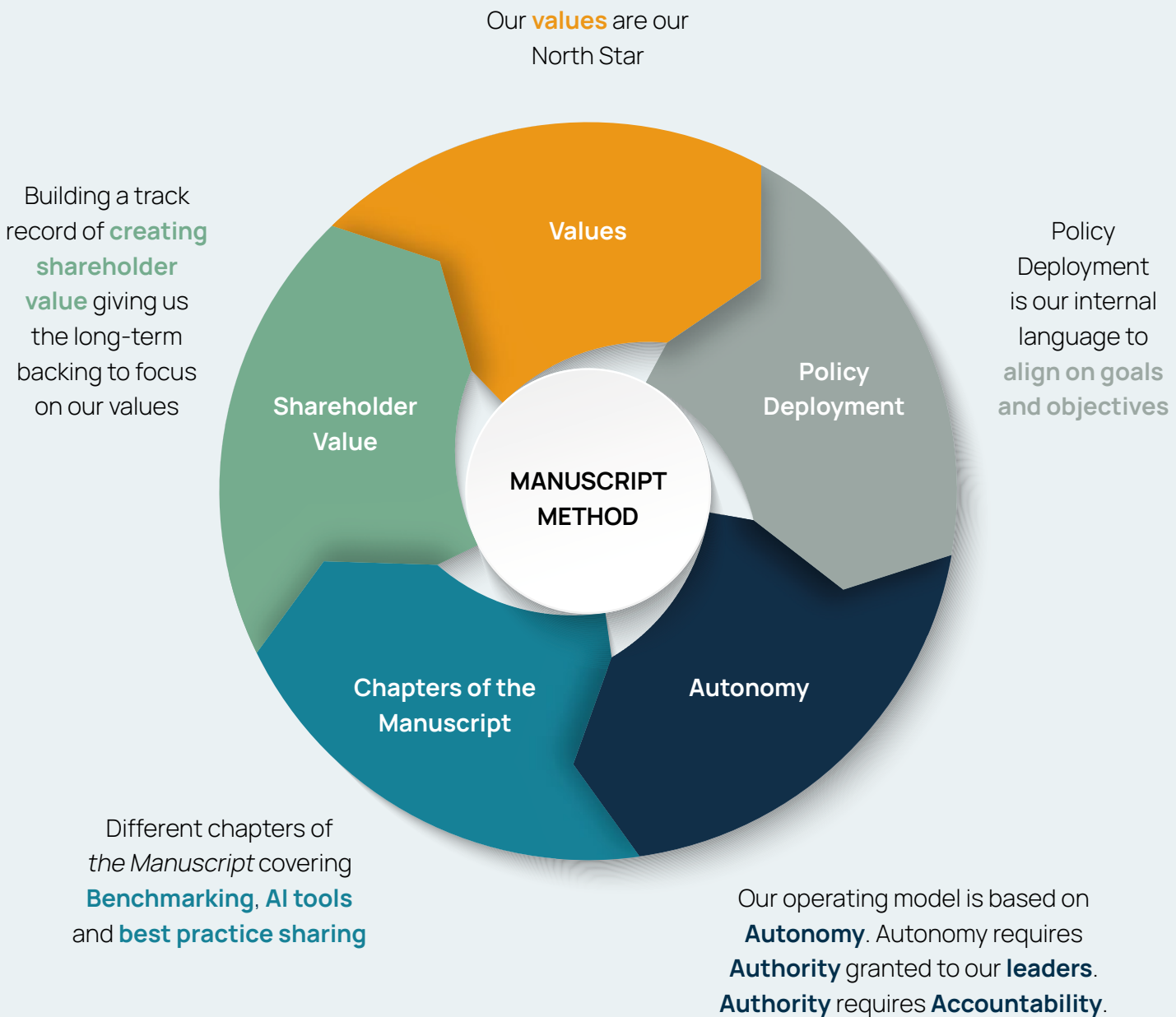
We would also like to thank our shareholders for the continued support and trust in what we are building. We look forward to hosting you in Hamburg for the Investor Day and Annual General Meeting on 8th and 9th July 2025!

Sincerely


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Jan-Hendrik Mohr

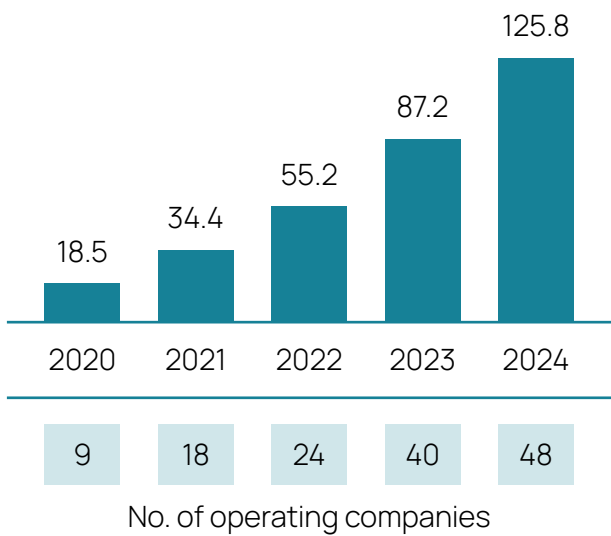

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Marlene Carl

MANUSCRIPT METHOD IMPROVES ORGANIC GROWTH WHILE MAINTAINING THE ENTREPRENEURIAL ENERGY OF A DECENTRALIZED ORGANIZATION

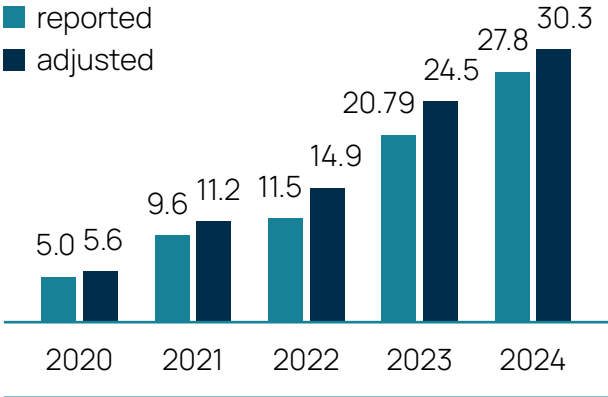


KEY FIGURES

REVENUE in EUR MM



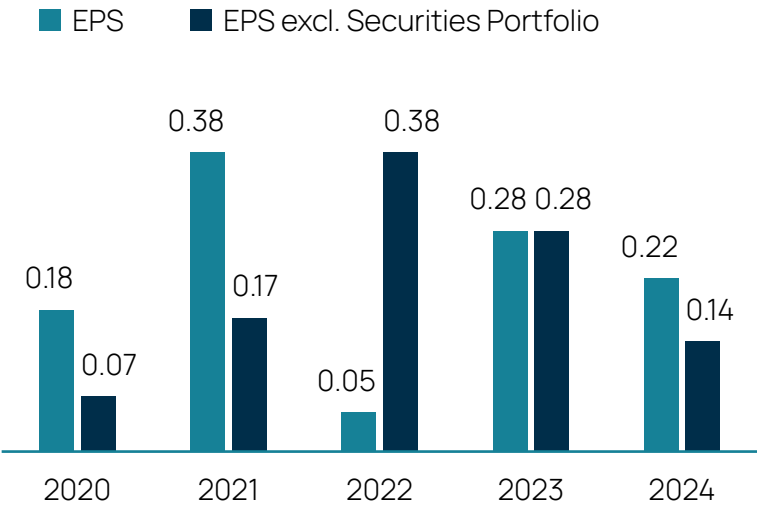
OPERATING EBITDA in EUR MM



For the calculation of operating revenue and EBITDA, we include all operating companies in which CHAPTERS owns a majority stake and that are part at the end of the relevant fiscal year of the group with 100% of their full year results in that year.

EARNINGS PER SHARE in EUR

For Earnings per Share, the net income for the fiscal year of all companies belonging to the group at the end of the relevant fiscal year is taken into account with the share attributable to CHAPTERS Group AG and divided by the number of shares outstanding at the end of the relevant year. For the calculation, all accounting related effects (e.g. goodwill depreciation) on the consolidated net income are excluded.



INSIDE CHAPTERS GROUP

In 2024, CHAPTERS Group AG continued its expansion. The Group now consists of 48 operating companies generating close to € 126 million in revenue in 2024 and employing approximately 1,000 people. The year was marked by strategic acquisitions and the deepening of our engagement in markets where we deliver mission-critical digital services. With our ongoing growth, we also introduced a segmentation around three key verticals:

- Public Sector
- Enterprise
- Financial Technologies

By segmenting the Group, we provide a clearer and more structured view of how our portfolio is built, why we invest where we do, and where we are heading. Each segment reflects a distinct strategic logic. Whether driven by regulatory resilience, sector-specific digitalization trends, or platform scaling opportunities.

This enhanced transparency not only sharpens the understanding of our current positioning but also enables us to identify potential and unlock synergies within our ecosystem, while allowing investors to better assess the sustainability of our long-term growth trajectory.

Segmentation aligns our internal reporting, capital allocation, and leadership responsibilities with the actual operating logic of our businesses. It allows our management team to benchmark performance within comparable peer sets, pursue relevant KPIs, and identify synergies and best practices specific to the segment. This vertical integration enhances focus, accountability, and execution at every level.

Segment data is presented on a fully consolidated basis for all companies in which CHAPTERS owns a majority stake with 100% of their revenue for the full financial year.

Segment	Revenue (EUR MM)	Operating Companies	Comment
Public Sector	49.1	22	Software for utilities, public administration, social services, and transportation.
Enterprise	41.6	20	Includes ERP, construction tech, CAD/CAM, property management, and orchestral systems.
Financial Technologies	17.2	2	A group of fintech platforms serving international students and expats.
Other	18.0	4	Continuous improvement in operations.

Public Sector

The Public Sector has emerged as a core strategic vertical for CHAPTERS, driven by our belief that digital infrastructure for (semi-) public institutions represents one of the most mission critical, resilient, scalable, and impactful investment areas in the European software landscape.

Public institutions, municipalities, education systems, transportation networks, and social service providers are under increasing pressure to modernize legacy systems, ensure regulatory compliance, and meet rising citizen expectations for efficient digital services. However, these institutions often rely on deeply embedded, highly specific software systems that require long term partnerships, domain expertise, and exceptional reliability.

This creates a unique opportunity: recurring revenue streams (often anchored in multi-year contracts), low customer churn, strong resilience to economic cycles, high potential for price normalization and a growing demand for secure, mission-critical digital tools. These characteristics align perfectly with CHAPTERS' strategic focus on long-term value creation through vertical software platforms.

CHAPTERS invests in companies that deliver mission-critical software and services across key segments of public infrastructure. Our portfolio includes providers of:

- ❖ Social case management software for municipalities
- ❖ Cybersecurity and compliance solutions for public administration
- ❖ Tailormade software solutions for utilities, education, and non-profit institutions

These solutions are essential to the functioning of public life, supporting not just operational efficiency, but also transparency, regulatory compliance, and social service delivery.

STRONG BRANDS IN THIS SEGMENT: OUR PORTFOLIO COMPANIES



Case Study

Strengthening Cyber Resilience Across the CHAPTERS Ecosystem

GBS Europa GmbH is a leading provider of email and collaboration security solutions, offering nearly 30 years of expertise in protecting sensitive data and ensuring regulatory compliance. As part of the CHAPTERS portfolio, GBS plays a critical role in enhancing the cyber resilience of both our group companies and their end customers. It's easy-to-deploy, market-leading email security solutions – already trusted by over 2,000 clients and 2 million users – are already being rolled out across CHAPTERS portfolio companies, such as Littera and PSI Transcom, to strengthen their cybersecurity posture. In addition, CHAPTERS companies are empowered to offer GBS solutions to their own customer bases, unlocking new value streams and reinforcing our ecosystem-wide focus on digital trust.

GBS's clear strategic focus on the public sector – an environment where cybersecurity is both mandatory and mission-critical – positions it as a natural and highly synergistic fit within CHAPTERS. Many of our portfolio companies operate in this space, and GBS's solutions address their stringent security requirements with proven, German-engineered technology. This shared focus creates significant group-wide potential for efficiency gains, both through harmonized cybersecurity standards and through reduced integration and operational costs.

To further extend this competitive advantage, CHAPTERS is actively pursuing targeted acquisitions in the cybersecurity domain. By expanding our capabilities in this high-growth sector, we strengthen our ability to offer end-to-end security solutions tailored to public-sector needs and deeply embedded across our portfolio to reinforce our commitment to safeguarding critical infrastructure in the public sector.



Case Study

gripware's Journey to SaaS: Driving Growth Through a Scalable Pricing Model

When **gripware** became the third VMS company to join CHAPTERS, it was a historic moment - not just for the company, but for the broader vision of unified growth and innovation in the VMS space. At the time of joining, Gripware had a team of five employees. Today, that number has grown to 10 reflecting a thoughtful approach to scaling and a focus on building capabilities to support customers more effectively.

But headcount growth is just one part of the story. Since integrating with CHAPTERS, gripware has increased its revenue and profitability up to 20% per year. This change is part of an ongoing effort to align more closely with customer needs and provide greater flexibility in how Gripware solutions are accessed and supported.

Most recently, gripware initiated a strategic transformation: shifting from a traditional license-and-maintenance model to a modern, subscription-based SaaS approach. This evolution goes beyond a change in revenue mechanics; it represents a deliberate, customer-centric repositioning. By adopting SaaS, gripware is aligning its business model with growing market expectations for flexibility, seamless scalability, and continuous product enhancement. This also means that the previous on-premise offering will be successively supplemented with meaningful cloud services. The move enables more predictable revenue streams while delivering ongoing value to customers through faster innovation cycles, simplified onboarding, and a lower total cost of ownership. gripware's journey is a clear example of how joining CHAPTERS can unlock growth, innovation, and long-term resilience. The story so far is one of measured, sustainable growth, grounded in teamwork, customer trust, and a willingness to evolve thoughtfully as needs change.

Enterprise

This segment encompasses a breadth of digital solutions tailored to a wide range of sectors, such as construction, manufacturing and logistics.

Our portfolio companies within this segment deliver operationally embedded tools: project management systems, CAD and engineering software, document and data management platforms, ERP solutions, and specialized scheduling or billing systems.

The strength of these businesses lies in their domain expertise, strong local brands, and long-standing customer relationships. Their applications are often mission-critical for small and medium-sized enterprises that rely on software deeply integrated into their daily workflows.

This segment benefits from high customer retention, recurring revenue, and scalable growth opportunities in underserved digital verticals. As industries continue to modernize legacy processes, demand for flexible, reliable, and purpose-built software is accelerating - creating a favorable environment for both organic growth and buy-and-build strategies.

STRONG BRANDS IN THIS SEGMENT: OUR PORTFOLIO COMPANIES



Financial Technologies

Initiated with the acquisition of a minority stake in Fintiba GmbH in May 2021, Financial Technologies has emerged into a core segment for CHAPTERS and we increased its ownership in Fintiba to a majority position over the years.

Fintiba delivers digital solutions that are mission-critical for cross-border mobility and compliance with regulatory requirements in Germany, including blocked accounts for visa applications, insurance packages, and rental guarantees. With the integration of Coracle GmbH in December 2024, Fintiba broadened its customer base.

SUCCESSFUL STRATEGIC MERGER

In May 2025, CHATPERS led the successful strategic combination of Fintiba, Coracle and Expatrio. This merger creates a new player in digital solutions for international students and professionals in Germany and provides a strong platform for scalable growth, efficiency gains, and synergistic expansion. Through a strategic partnership with Frankfurt International Bank AG (FIB), the group will broaden its existing product offering. It is also planned to develop further innovative financial products together with FIB.



STRONG BRANDS IN THIS SEGMENT: OUR PORTFOLIO COMPANIES



Case Study

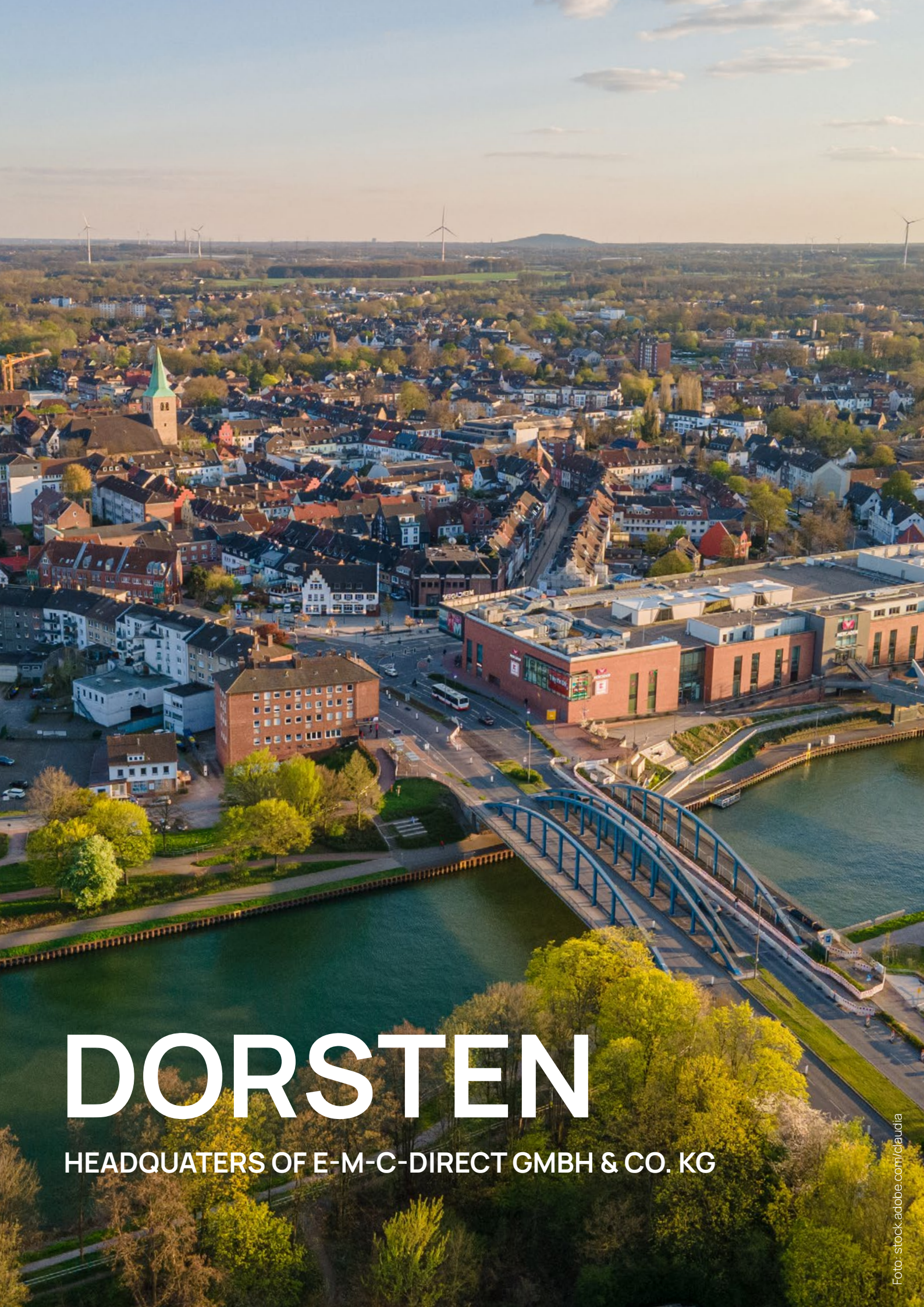
How a mission-critical digital platform is tackling skills shortages and boosting German exports

Chapters is focused on acquiring and developing mission-critical digital platforms - those that serve as essential infrastructure in tightly regulated or high-trust environments. Fintiba and Coracle fits this profile precisely: as one of the leading providers of blocked accounts and related services for international students in Germany, it plays a central role in the student onboarding journey. The company has built a strong reputation in a niche market that is defensible, growing, and under-digitized.

With the foundation of Frankfurt International Bank (FIB), founded by Chapters, Fintiba and other shareholders, the group has added a licensed banking layer to its operations. This significantly enhances the economic model in different core areas as cost optimization: In-house blocked accounts reduce reliance on third-party banks and allow for direct monetization of deposits. FIB enables rapid deployment of tailored financial product. With its planned expanded offering, the organization aims to further strengthen its position while improving access for international talent to the German education and job market - contributing to efforts to address the country's ongoing skills shortages. At the same time, small-ticket export financing solutions from FIB are helping to boost German exports. Together, these initiatives play a role in tackling two of the most pressing challenges facing the German economy.

Further future success factors within Fintiba's core business are favorable fee structures, consolidated compliance, and automated processing. FIB is not a standalone play, but a strategic enabler while improving conditions for students while strengthening the profitability and defensibility of the Fintiba ecosystem. International students represent a high-LTV, low-default segment with increasing demand for tailored financial products. By owning multiple points along the student journey, the group unlocks significant cross-selling potential e.g. Insurance products, loans, Savings and investment tools or post-study financial services (e.g., relocation accounts, pensions, asset management).





DORSTEN

HEADQUARTERS OF E-M-C-DIRECT GMBH & CO. KG

Foto: stock.adobe.com/audia

Other

These companies were originally acquired under a value-oriented investment approach and, represent sound investment opportunities in niche or locally strong business models. Over time, however, our strategy has evolved toward platform scaling, sector specialization, and recurring revenue visibility, prompting a clearer focus on areas where we can deliver structural synergies and long-term growth. We continue to support the businesses in this segment and include them in our Manuscript Method processes to drive operational improvements – and enable solutions to find a new home when appropriate.

ONCE UPON A TIME IN DORSTEN

E-M-C-direct is the first ever company that became part of the group under our value-oriented investment approach. As a minority investment, E-M-C-direct is not included in the segment data – but it all started with this.

STRONG BRANDS IN THIS SEGMENT: OUR PORTFOLIO COMPANIES



SEGMENTE

PUBLIC SECTOR

ENTERPRISE

FINANCIAL TECHNOLOGIES

OTHER

**AS OF DECEMBER 31, 2024, THE GROUP INCLUDES
48 OPERATING COMPANIES (PLUS ONE MINORITY STAKE),
DELIVERING MISSION CRITICAL SOLUTIONS
TO THEIR CUSTOMERS**

PUBLIC SECTOR

- ❖ Technocarte SAS
- ❖ DIVERA GmbH
- ❖ filmwerte GmbH with its subsidiary myfilmfriend LLC
- ❖ Xplain AG with its sister company Xplain Iberica S.L.
- ❖ GBS Europa GmbH with its subsidiary Group BusBS (UK) Ltd.
- ❖ MAJELIS Tutelle SAS
- ❖ CSWin SAS
- ❖ rocom GmbH
- ❖ LITTERA Software & Consulting GmbH (in Austria and Germany)
- ❖ appwerke GmbH
- ❖ Glasfaser Direkt GmbH, Jobst-NET GmbH and Eifel-Net GmbH
- ❖ Utilities Systems s.r.o. with its subsidiary Usys Slovakia s.r.o.
- ❖ Conditon - Integrierte Softwarelösungen GmbH
- ❖ Software und Beratung Meinhard GmbH
- ❖ Solarys Informatik GmbH
- ❖ ingenia Glasfaser GmbH
- ❖ Interactive Network Communications GmbH
- ❖ carrierwerke GmbH
- ❖ OPAS Software GmbH
- ❖ SWH Softwarehaus Heider GmbH

FINANCIAL TECHNOLOGIES

- ❖ Fintiba GmbH
- ❖ Coracle GmbH

ENTERPRISE

- ❖ 3GWIN SAS
- ❖ HUP GmbH with its subsidiary LEO Bytes GmbH
- ❖ Equinox Software SAS with its subsidiary Equinox Automotive SAS
- ❖ GAIN Software GmbH
- ❖ BG Informatique SAS
- ❖ GI Informatique SAS
- ❖ CSB Bruns & Börjes GmbH
- ❖ KeyLogic GmbH
- ❖ MWM Software & Beratung GmbH
- ❖ Teamware GmbH
- ❖ WAREHaus GmbH
- ❖ Voigt Software und Beratung AG
- ❖ eKom solutions GmbH
- ❖ Corporate Montage Europe GmbH
- ❖ direkt cnc-systeme GmbH
- ❖ DATEX Software GmbH
- ❖ Software24.com GmbH
- ❖ gripsware datentechnik GmbH
- ❖ Parity Software GmbH
- ❖ BleTec Software GmbH

OTHER

- ❖ DIE NEUE SCHULE GbR
- ❖ Kunstschule Wandsbek GmbH
- ❖ Speakeasy Berlin GmbH with its sister companies Speakeasy München GmbH and strassenberger Akademie GmbH
- ❖ Kältehelden GmbH
- ❖ E-M-C-direct GmbH & Co. KG. KG



Since 1992, Technocarte has specialized in the development and provision of administrative software for local authorities, particularly in the areas of child, youth and early childhood care. The software includes tools for appointment and document

Part of the Group since November 2024

management, digital records management and automated time recording. More than 10 major cities and hundreds of municipalities of all sizes in France use the solutions to manage their citizen services.



DIVERA 24/7 enables the forward-looking planning of on-call personnel availability for emergency organizations such as fire departments, rescue services, police and aid organizations. Bottlenecks are identified at an early stage, deployments are coordinated efficiently and only available personnel are alerted. With users not only in Germany but also in neighboring countries, the system has established itself as a central Software-as-a-Service (SaaS)

Part of the Group since November 2024

platform for information exchange during critical incidents. Favored by its mostly volunteer end users, their full-time employers also adopt DIVERA 24/7 for personnel planning, order scheduling and crisis management. Interfaces enable easy integration into existing infrastructures such as security control centers/dispatch and management systems and access control systems.



filmwerte GmbH, based in Potsdam, is the leading provider of VoD services for public libraries. Its flagship product, filmfriend, offers a carefully curated selection of over 2,500 films and 140 series – with a focus on European arthouse, documentaries, and high-quality children's programming. filmwerte

Part of the Group since November 2024

works with over 250 licensors and currently serves 800+ libraries across Germany, Austria, Switzerland, France, Belgium, Luxembourg, and Liechtenstein. Since 2024, myfilmfriend is also available in the USA and Canada, marking a key milestone in filmwerte's international expansion.



Xplain is a leading provider of standard software solutions for all application areas in the Homeland Security industry such as Cantonal and Federal Police forces, Border Control Authorities, and various justice organizations. Our products enable organi-

Part of the Group since October 2024

zations in the field to drastically increase their productivity and significantly reduce their workload. From data entry through processing and the final report - digital end-to-end - both geographically and organizationally.



GBS is a leading provider of email security and GRC solutions for enterprise customers with over 30 years of experience in data protection, productivity and compliance. With locations in Germany and UK, it helps its 2000+ customers and 2+ million end users to communicate and collaborate securely and compliantly in the digital world with

Part of the Group since June 2024

flexible, easy-to-use and powerful solutions. The next generation cybersecurity solutions include protection for Microsoft 365, Exchange and HCL Domino, including malware protection, encryption, data loss prevention, workflow management and compliance.



Majelis Software is also a provider of specialised solutions for the efficient management of persons under legal guardianship. Compared to CSWin their focus is more on individual care-givers (MJPM)

and family members managing people under legal guardianship. Their full web SAAS solution is highly intuitive and simple to use.

Part of the Group since April 2024



CSWin is a French software company based in Plérin (Brittany) that has been developing specialized solutions for the efficient management of persons under legal guardianship. CSWin focuses mainly on hospitals and associations that manage several hundred or thousands of persons under

legal guardianship. Depending on the customer requirements, its solution is offered on premise or hosted. It differentiates itself by the breadth of its solution and the in-depth industry knowledge that the entire team developed over the years.

Part of the Group since January 2024



Part of the Group since December 2023

With the products Tau-Office, Tau-Cloud and Tau-Work-Together, rocom GmbH offers comprehensive administration software for social and municipal institutions. The company has been established in this field for more than 30 years and the

solution is specially tailored to the specific requirements of users. Its more than 400 customers include numerous cities and municipalities as well as social associations such as Caritas and Diakonie.



Part of the Group since November 2023

LITTERA Software & Consulting GmbH offers a modern, cloud-based platform for archive, library and literature management. As the market leader in Austria and a strong player in the fragmented

German market, the company supports over 2,500 libraries, museums and educational institutions across the world. The solution streamlines all core workflows in the sector.



Part of the Group since November 2023

appwerke offers scalable tools for Internet Service Providers and network operators ranging from customer management, process automation, online

ordering, end-customer portals, and sales and thereby enabling efficient telecom operations.



Part of the Group since August 2023

Glasfaser Direkt GmbH, Jobst-NET GmbH and Eifel-Net GmbH became part of the Group in August 2023. The companies provide internet and tele-

communications services for private and commercial customers, which are primarily sold in Euskirchen, Amberg and other areas of Bavaria.



Part of the Group since April 2023

Utilities Systems s.r.o., based in Prague and with a subsidiary in Slovakia, develops and distributes customer information systems for the water and energy industry. In addition to the majority of water supply companies in the Czech Republic, its cus-

tomers include private electricity and gas suppliers in the Czech Republic, Poland and Slovakia. The product and customer portfolio is supplemented by a solution for public broadcasting companies in the Czech Republic and Slovakia.



Part of the Group since January 2023

Conditon - Integrierte Softwarelösungen GmbH develops and distributes software for hunting, fishing and firearms license management in Ger-

many. Its more than 500 long-standing customers are the authorities responsible for administration.



Part of the Group since December 2022

Software und Beratung Meinhard GmbH develops and operates a complete system for the administration and billing of daycare centers and kindergartens. It also offers a supplementary parent

portal. The company's customers primarily include municipal and local authority providers of daycare centers and kindergartens.



Part of the Group since February / December 2022

In September 2023, Solarys Software GmbH emerged from the merger of Solarys Informatik GmbH and blaulichtSMS GmbH, both based in Austria. With syBOS, the company offers a software solution for managing fire departments as well as mountain, water and cave rescues. The modular software covers all relevant processes from personnel, vehicle, material and equipment

management to remuneration and finance. The blaulichtSMS alerting app offers an additional alerting solution for fire departments, rescue services and emergency organizations such as the THW to maximize their operational reach. Its customers include numerous fire departments and control centers in Austria and Germany.



Part of the Group since September 2022

ingenia Glasfaser is a regional internet and telephone provider in Hohenloher-Land, where it supplies private and business customers with high-performance fiber-optic internet. Founded in September 2022, the company commenced operations in 2023.



Part of the Group since November 2021

Interactive Network Communications GmbH offers individual technical solutions for commercial customers. In addition to fiber optic Internet products for major customers, these also include solutions in the cyber security environment and the operation of e-mail and data storage in secure environments. The company's product portfolio and technical equipment complement the services offered by carrierwerke GmbH within the CarMa Group.



Part of the Group since August 2021

carrierwerke GmbH provides comprehensive broadband services for municipal utilities and network operators, including white-label Internet, telephony, and TV solutions. They also offer full network operation and connectivity to major Internet hubs. Since launching in 2021, they've partnered with DB Broadband and gained initial municipal clients.



Part of the Group since December 2020

OPAS is the global market leader for orchestra management software and can look back on more than 25 years of experience in this niche. The software solution from OPAS has been specially adapted to the needs of orchestra management and includes functionalities for the management of e.g. music libraries, program planning as well as travel and logistics planning. More than 250 orchestras worldwide (from Australia to China and Europe to the USA) use the software solution, which is available in 15 languages.



Part of the Group since December 2019

SWH Softwarehaus Heider GmbH develops and distributes a software solution specially tailored to the requirements of school administrations. In addition to timetable planning and the management of student data, the range of services also includes the management of school fees, which is particularly relevant for private institutions and German schools abroad. Customers include renowned private educational institutions in Germany and German schools abroad.





3GWIN develops specialized POS software for telecommunications providers, mobile repair shops and more generally retailers with functions such as warehouse management, invoicing and back-office automation. As a certified solution, it offers more security than many self-certified competi-

tors. Its client base consists of major Telco operators such as SFR, smaller chains and franchise providers as well as individual stores.. By integrating supplier catalogues such as Big-Ben (accessories) and insurance contracts, 3GWIN is a comprehensive industry solution.

Part of the Group since **October 2024**



For over 40 years, HUP GmbH has been a reliable partner for national and international media companies seeking digital transformation and automation. Headquartered in Braunschweig, HUP develops innovative software solutions for publishers and offers a comprehensive range of services to help businesses efficiently manage and distrib-

ute their content, ensuring future-proof success. These include advertising, subscriber management, logistics, production, multi-channel content management and more. Approximately 100 highly skilled experts ensure that more than 34 million of newspapers and digital content reach their readers reliably every day.

Part of the Group since **September 2024**



Equinox Software offers a simple and efficient software suite to enable non-IT professionals to manage their customer databases and optimize their marketing campaigns. They provide accessible solutions for data processing, segmentation, and extraction, adapting to the needs of business-

es, regardless of their size or complexity. Equinox is a market leader in the management of donor databases in particular and is used by the majority of major French charities. Based in Paris, the company serves over 100 clients in the charity, automotive, data trading and press sectors.

Part of the Group since **July 2024**



BG Info develops customized software and offers its own accounting and payroll tools. 57% of revenue comes from recurring maintenance and host-

ing fees, mostly for customized software solutions. In addition, BG Info provides software development resources for third-party companies.

Part of the Group since **May 2024**



GI Informatique is an IT services company established in 1992 with a focus on accounting and payroll solutions. The versatile team of developers, trainers and hotliners enables the software to be flexibly adapted to companies of all sizes and sectors - from accounting offices and catering busi-

nesses to retailers such as Carrefour and Système U. With approx. 1000 customers and its main modules Winlogic (accounting), Wingip (payroll) and Wingifact (invoicing), GI In-formatique is today one of the relevant software providers for independent retailers.

Part of the Group since **January 2024**



CSB Bruns & Börjes GmbH has been offering software solutions for the motorcycle, bicycle, motorized equipment for over 30 years. The core of all products is a merchandise management system that includes all the classic functionalities of merchandise management, including an integrated cash register, GoBD-compliant cash book,

TSE connection, a digital workshop, connection to vehicle portals with calculation options and the pre-accounting of sales revenue as well as sales evaluations. The system can be expanded to include an online store, an interface to eBay and a CSB app. This market leader's product is currently used by 900+ dealers in three countries.

Part of the Group since **January 2024**



KeyLogic GmbH develops modular software for Computer Aided Facility Management (CAFM). The solution covers space and asset management, contract administration, occupational safety,

cleaning services and energy controlling. Clients include public property owners, commercial real estate operators and large-scale companies in Germany, Luxembourg and Switzerland.

Part of the Group since **August 2023**



GAIN Software GmbH develops and distributes product data management software with comprehensive interfaces to common CAD and ERP systems. The modular system is specially tailored to

the needs of medium-sized companies in the manufacturing industry. The company serves over 140 customers across various industries, particularly in the fields of mechanical engineering.

Part of the Group since **July 2023**



Part of the Group since **June 2023**

MWM Software & Beratung GmbH delivers specialized software for the construction industry, particularly in the areas of measurement, quantity surveying and invoicing. The company serves more than 900 clients, including project developers, general contractors, mid-sized construction firms and trade professionals.



Part of the Group since **March 2023**

Teamware GmbH develops a Microsoft Teams-based SaaS solution for managing digital construction and project files. Founded in 2020, the company has shown strong growth and adds significant value to the Group's real estate and construction software portfolio. Its intuitive integration with Microsoft tools makes it particularly attractive for teams seeking digital collaboration in construction documentation.



Part of the Group since **June 2022**

WAREHaus GmbH provides highly specialized software for utility and heating cost billing, specifically designed for private landlords and small property managers. Its flagship products from the "easy" suite complement Software24's Win-CASA and extends the Group's capabilities in the housing and utility billing domain.



Part of the Group since **May 2022**

With its cloud platform IMKE, Voigt Software und Beratung AG offers an all-in-one solution for real estate developers. The software supports processes from project development and construction management to marketing and sales, accessible across all devices. The company is also a market leader in software for the energy distributing companies, particularly in liquefied natural gas (LNG) and related fields.



Part of the Group since **December 2021**

The core product of elKom solutions GmbH is a software solution for group consolidation that maps the standard functions of group accounting and evaluation in accordance with all common accounting standards. The product portfolio is supplemented by a solution for corporate and group planning as well as a business intelligence solution for analysis, reporting and controlling. Customers include large corporations as well as smaller medium-sized companies.



Part of the Group since **September 2021**

Corporate Montage Europe GmbH is a long-standing partner of the software providers ELO® Digital Office - one of the leading enterprise content management software solutions - and Bentley, a US provider of CAD software well known in the infrastructure sector. The range is supplemented by software solutions developed in-house, particularly at the interface between CAD software and ECM software, in order to offer customers a comprehensive and customized solution.



Part of the Group since **May 2021**

With "NC Hops", direkt cnc-systeme gmbh offers one of the leading machine- and manufacturer-independent CAD/CAM software solutions for the wood, plastics and aluminum processing industries. The modular software covers the entire production process, from design and construction to work planning and production, and can be individually adapted to specific customer requirements using numerous add-on modules.



Part of the Group since **April 2021**

DATEX Software GmbH offers one of the leading complete business management solutions for real estate developers in the German-speaking market. The modular software AMADEUS supports the entire development lifecycle - from project planning, cost control and defect management to documentation and financial accounting. With several hundred customers, some of whom have been using the software for more than 25 years, include smaller property developers as well as larger real estate developers - mostly for projects in Germany's metropolitan areas.

ENTERPRISE



Part of the Group since April 2021

With Win-CASA, Software24.com GmbH offers a comprehensive industry solution for property management companies of all sizes. The software covers the full range of administrative tasks for rental management and condominium/ home owner associations. Additional modules such as device management and custom reporting enhance its flexibility. Today, several thousand clients – mostly small and regional property managers – rely on Win-CASA across Germany.



Part of the Group since December 2020

With its highly specialized software, BleTec Software GmbH offers a modular ERP/PPS solution tailored to the core operational processes of sheet metal processing companies. The company primarily serves small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs). Over the past 20 years, BleTec has continuously acquired new clients and now serves a broad customer base of more than 150 companies.



Part of the group since December 2019

gripware datentechnik GmbH develops and distributes software solutions to support the ideal construction process. The modularly bookable license products include a mobile construction diary with included deficiency management, as well as solutions for construction time and project planning, financing or budget control, but also, for example, modules for monitoring health and safety plans. Its more than 2,500 customers primarily include engineering and architecture firms, but also construction companies, public authorities and municipalities.



Part of the group since August 2019

Parity Software GmbH is a provider of highly customizable standard ERP solutions. The company develops and distributes its own modular ERP solution, PARITY.ERP, which supports core business functions with a strong focus on inventory management and B2B-trade. A key strength of the platform lies in its release-safe customization tools, enabling tailored configurations without compromising future updates. Parity serves SME commercial and industrial enterprises across Germany, offering cross-platform compatibility and seamless integration into existing IT environments.



Part of the Group since December 2024

Coracle is a German FinTech company that has been offering digital solutions for international students for over seven years. It offers a fully digital blocked account with no monthly fees that is recognized by German embassies. In addition, the PRIME package also includes health and travel insurance to facilitate the visa application process. Every year, Coracle supports over 15,000 students worldwide with their start in Germany.



Part of the Group since May 2021

Founded in 2016, Fintiba GmbH has established itself as one of the leading providers of support for international students and young professionals in Germany. Based in Frankfurt, Fintiba enables visa applicants to open the blocked account required for the visa process online from abroad. The company also offers support with insurance and rental guarantees. Since its foundation, Fintiba has accompanied over 300,000 international students on their way to Germany.

WIEN
HEADQUARTERS OF SOLARYS SOFTWARE GMBH



DIE NEUE SCHULE was founded in 1984 and offers - just like the speakeasy group - conversation-oriented language courses in small groups as well as language courses for companies and individu-

al lessons. It also offers telc examinations. Based in West Berlin, DIE NEUE SCHULE ideally complements the GfW Group's existing presence in East Berlin.

Part of the Group since April 2023



Kunsthochschule Wandsbek GmbH, a state-recognized vocational school, has been offering a degree course in communication design for over 30 years. Since the acquisition by the subsidiary of NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH, GfW Gesellschaft für Weiter-

bildung GmbH, the range of courses has been expanded to include Game Creation and Illustration Design – all three study programs are also available for online studies.

Part of the Group since March 2021



Speakeasy offers conversation-oriented language courses in small groups as well as language courses for companies and individual lessons and is certified as an examination center for the European Language Certificate "telc". In addition, the school offers complementary services such as support in the VISA process and a University Pathway Program. The group includes speakeasy Berlin GmbH,

which operates locations in Berlin and Hamburg, and speakeasy München GmbH, which was founded in 2021. In the 2021 financial year, the offering was also expanded as part of an asset deal to include strassenberger Akademie GmbH's professional development offering with a focus on law firm and practice management.

Part of the Group since December 2020



Kältehelden GmbH is a master company for refrigeration and air conditioning technology based in Hamburg. The company offers consulting, planning, new construction and maintenance with a 24-hour emergency service. In addition to refrigeration and air conditioning solutions, the range of

services also includes air purification. The focus is on a comprehensive service approach that serves customers throughout Germany. For further expansion, we support the founder in setting up a modern refrigeration/air conditioning technology group.

Part of the group since August 2020



E-M-C-direct GmbH & Co. KG is a specialist wholesaler and developer of cable management and protection solutions, with a core focus on photovoltaic EPCs and installers. It also serves B2B customers in industrial sectors such as commercial vehicle construction and mechanical engineering. The company operates primarily in the DACH re-

gion through a direct sales model and offers comprehensive service packages to support long-term customer relationships. Following the 2021 acquisition of TOOLOVA, E-M-C-direct expanded into crimping and cutting tools, supplying private label and OEM solutions to leading tool brands.

Part of the group since January 2019

REPORT OF THE SUPERVISORY BOARD

Dear shareholders,
dear friends of the company,

In the 2024 financial year, CHAPTERS Group AG was once again able to continue its growth trajectory. In a challenging capital market environment, the company secured funds for further expansion through a capital increase by cash contribution in August 2024.

Furthermore, a capital increase for contributions in kind was registered in March 2024, and CHAPTERS Group AG became the largest shareholder of Software Circle plc.

The platform companies belonging to the group acquired interests in 14 additional operating companies. Taking into account the spin-off of the ENTRO Group in September 2024, a total of 48 companies were part of the group by the end of the year.



During the reporting period, the Supervisory Board performed the duties incumbent upon it in accordance with the law and the Articles of Association. It monitored the Management Board of CHAPTERS Group AG on the basis of written and verbal reports and provided advice in joint discussions.

The Supervisory Board was informed by the Management Board about the ongoing development of the business and matters of particular importance and was directly involved in all decisions of fundamental importance to the company. In addition, there was an exchange of information between members of the Supervisory Board and the Management Board throughout the fiscal year.

In accordance with the Articles of Association, the Supervisory Board consisted of four members during the reporting period. The Supervisory Board did not form any committees.

Eight Supervisory Board meetings and several strategy days were held in 2024. All members of the Supervisory Board attended seven of the eight meetings in person or by telephone. At times, experts were called in for individual meetings.

The meetings and consultations focused on:

- ❖ Planning, support and supervision of the subsidiaries CHAPTERS Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH, Ookam Software GmbH, CarMa Holding GmbH, mlog capital SAS, Altamount Software GmbH, CHAPTERS Switzerland Software GmbH and Waterkant Software GmbH.
- ❖ The extension of the Management Board contract of Ms. Marlene Carl until December 31, 2028.
- ❖ Consultancy on and resolution of a capital increase through contributions in kind in January, with registration in March 2024; execution of a subscription agreement with a group of institutional investors in April 2024; and subsequent implementation of a capital increase by cash contribution in August 2024. Review, consulting and monitoring of the Global Heart Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH project.
- ❖ Approval of the buyback offer for the bearer bonds of the 2020 bond held by the company in March 2024.
- ❖ Consultation and approval of the establishment of further investment platforms in Germany and abroad.
- ❖ The establishment of two new VMS investment platforms, Altamount Software GmbH and Waterkant Software GmbH in June and September 2024.
- ❖ The acquisition of 20% of shares in Ookam Software GmbH in September 2024.
- ❖ Support for various acquisitions by the platform companies and their subsidiaries.

FOS-SUR-MER

HEADQUARTERS OF TECHNOCARTE SAS

- ❖ The review and approval of the inclusion of a subordinated credit line at the level of Ookam Software GmbH.
- ❖ Monitoring of the reporting on the securities portfolio of CHAPTERS Group AG.



The Supervisory Board reviewed and discussed the annual financial statements prepared in accordance with the German Commercial Code, the consolidated financial statements of CHAPTERS Group AG and the combined management report, and consulted with the Management Board. The annual and consolidated financial statements for the fiscal year from January 1, 2024, to December 31, 2024, were audited by the auditing firm BDO AG, Tobias Haerle, Hamburg, and issued with an unqualified audit opinion.

These documents and the auditor's report were submitted to all members of the Supervisory Board. The auditor explained the results of the audit of the consolidated and annual financial statements in detail to the Supervisory Board at its meeting to approve the financial statements on May 26, 2025, and answered questions from the Supervisory Board.

The Supervisory Board acknowledged and approved the audit report for CHAPTERS Group AG. Based on the final results of its review, the Supervisory Board raised no objections to the documents submitted. The Supervisory Board approved the consolidated and annual financial statements and the combined management report. The annual financial statements are thus adopted in accordance with Section 172 of the German Stock Corporation Act.



The Supervisory Board would like to thank the Management Board and all employees of the Group for their great commitment and achievements.

Dr. Mathias Saggau
Chairman of the Supervisory Board



COMBINED MANAGEMENT REPORT FOR THE FISCAL YEAR 2024

A. Background of the Group and CHAPTERS Group AG

BUSINESS ACTIVITY AND ORIENTATION

CHAPTERS Group AG aims to build the home for "mission critical digital solutions". For us, "mission critical" means products and services that are essential for end customers - be it an ERP system or a blocked account for the visa process.

More than 50 companies have become part of the Group since the first investment at the beginning of 2019. In the 2024 fiscal year, we continued the process initiated in 2023 towards a stronger focus on specific areas and will segment our companies into three main core areas in future:

- ❖ Digital solutions for public sector companies and civil society institutions („Public“)
- ❖ Digital solutions for private companies („Enterprise“)
- ❖ Digital solutions for financial services („Financial Technologies“)

Each segment follows its own strategic logic - be it through regulatory stability, industry-specific digitalization trends or scaling potential within platforms.

This segmentation allows us to develop our portfolio in a targeted manner along relevant market verticals through strategic capital allocation, to identify value chains and to better identify and realize synergies within the respective clusters.

We are guided by our three core values in the further development of the Group:

WE THINK IN DECADES

Our investments are made with an unlimited time horizon. Disposals to increase the value of the company in the short term are expressly not part of the strategy. Nevertheless, disposals may be made, especially when they enable companies and their managing directors to take the next step on their growth path.

The companies that are or will become part of CHAPTERS Group AG have - usually over many years - developed solutions that are tailored to the needs of their customers - based on a strong customer focus as well as market and industry knowledge. We pursue a sustainable and entrepreneurial approach in the further development of our companies. Together with the managing directors and local employees, we want to maintain and strengthen the sustainable competitiveness of the companies and continuously improve and expand the solutions for customers.

WE GROW TOGETHER

Our investments are usually made via subsidiaries of CHAPTERS Group AG: our platforms. The strategy and focus of the individual platform are set independently by the respective management team that drive the development. By offering equity ownership to the platform teams, we enable them to participate in the long-term increase in value.

WE SERVE THE EDGE

We operate in a decentralized operational model based on autonomy. The companies belonging to the Group have individual corporate cultures that we preserve. Decisions should always be made by the teams that are closest to the respective customer and are not centralized. Combined with networking and knowledge sharing between Group companies, benchmarking and best practice sharing as well as the provision of central resources and experts for specific focus topics, we can effectively promote the development of our companies..

GOALS AND STRATEGY

CHAPTERS Group AG pursues the goal of sustainably increasing the Group's enterprise value in the long term. We use the long-term development of earnings per share, which we have been calculating since the 2020 fiscal year, as an indicator of the development of the company's value. The main factors influencing earnings per share (EPS) are the organic development of the companies belonging to the Group, inorganic growth and the financing structure.

SUSTAINABLE FURTHER DEVELOPMENT OF THE OPERATING PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

We want to develop the companies belonging to the Group in a long-term and sustainable manner. To this end, we support companies in their growth, e.g. through best practice sharing in the areas of sales or pricing strategies.

FURTHER ACQUISITIONS AS GROWTH DRIVERS

The main driver of growth in recent years has been inorganic growth through the acquisition of new operating companies. We want to continue to grow through acquisitions. A particular focus here is on the acquisition of companies that operate in a niche in which we are already present with oth-

er Group companies as well as on companies that offer solutions complementing the offering of our existing companies.

OPTIMIZATION OF THE FINANCING STRUCTURE

The companies belonging to the Group are characterized by a high and stable cash flow conversion. In the past, we have already financed part of the purchase prices paid with debt. The liquidity surpluses generated by the operating companies are primarily used to repay existing debt financing. This ongoing repayment continuously creates additional capacity to raise new financing. In addition, by optimizing the repayment structures towards partially bullet structures, we can create further capacity to finance inorganic growth with less additional equity.

CONTROL SYSTEM

We operate in a decentralized operational model based on **autonomy**. Decisions are not made centrally. The **decision-making authority** should always lie with the teams that are closest to the respective customer: Be it in the operating companies or at the level of our platforms in connection with the management of the companies or in the identification and analysis of new portfolio companies and transaction structuring. In order to operate effectively in this decentralized structure, clearly defined framework parameters and **accountability** are required. Decision-makers in our organization must take responsibility for results and be open to learning from others.

INVESTMENT DECISIONS ALONG DEFINED FRAMEWORK PARAMETERS

Our platforms are responsible for identifying and analyzing new portfolio companies. Together with the platform teams, we have defined framework parameters for new acquisitions, which serve as a basis for discussion when making an investment

decision. Potential new investments are presented to CHAPTERS Group AG and discussed and validated by the Management Board (together with the Supervisory Board if necessary), after which an investment decision is made.

MANUSCRIPT METHOD AS THE FOUNDATION FOR ACCOUNTABILITY

Responsibility for the development of the operating Group companies lies with the respective platform teams. CHAPTERS Group AG monitors developments based on monthly key financial figures. In particular, we look at the development of revenue and the development of adjusted operating earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization (adjusted EBITDA) compared to the same period of the previous year and compared to the budget agreed between the respective operating managing directors, platform managers and CHAPTERS Group AG.

Moreover, we are developing our "Manuscript Method" together with the platform managers. In addition to modules for best practice sharing, the Manuscript Method contains a series of standard processes that are to be introduced and implemented in the operating Group companies. These include the development of strategic priorities for the coming years, including the associated improvement initiatives and action plans, a regular review of the company's pricing strategy and a standardized approach to identifying and developing talent within the organization.

Responsibility for the introduction and implementation of the Manuscript Method lies with the respective platform teams. In monthly review meetings key developments at the platform and in the relevant Group are discussed. If necessary, measures to address potentially undesirable developments early on as well as measures to make optimum use of new potential are agreed.

EQUITY PARTICIPATION AS A STRUCTURAL CONTROL ELEMENT

A key structural control element in the CHAPTERS Group is the selected shareholding and incentive structure. The platform teams usually have a stake in the equity of the platform they manage.

Capital required to finance the acquisition of new operating companies and, if necessary, for the business activities of the companies is provided by CHAPTERS Group AG as the ultimate parent company by means of shareholder loans. These bear interest at an annual rate of 10%. This provides a clear incentive for all Group companies to only make investments where the expected return significantly exceeds this value. There is also an incentive to return surplus liquidity to CHAPTERS Group AG if reinvestment in the company's own business is not expected to generate a higher return.

B. Economic report

MACROECONOMIC AND SECTOR-SPECIFIC FRAMEWORK CONDITIONS

In 2024, economic development in the European Union recovered somewhat compared to the previous year and gross domestic product in the European Union recorded an overall increase of 1.0%.¹ However, growth was again subdued, particularly in comparison to global growth of 3.2%. Driven by the interest rate cuts introduced in 2024, the inflation rate fell significantly once again and stood at 2.6% in the European Union in 2024.²

A noticeable decline in inflation can also be observed in Germany, from 6.0% in the previous year to 2.5% in 2024. Economic growth, on the other hand, was slightly negative at - 0.2% and well below the European average.

ONGOING DIGITIZATION TREND IN GERMAN SMES DESPITE ECONOMIC WEAKNESS

According to surveys by the KfW SME Panel, digitalization expenditure in the German SME sector rose again in 2023 - despite the weak economy - and amounted to EUR 31.9 billion (compared to EUR 29.3 billion in the previous year). While digitalization activities typically tend to increase in economically favorable phases, the current trend indicates that the need for digitalization measures has been recognized, particularly in German SMEs. As in previous years, projects to digitize customer and supplier contacts, introduce new applications, build up expertise and reorganize workflows account for the majority of digitization projects.³

CYBER SECURITY AND ESG AS GROWTH DRIVERS IN EUROPE

According to a study by the OECD⁴, the main drivers for digitalization in SMEs in other European countries (France, Italy and Spain) and worldwide (USA, Japan, Korea) are the digitalization of customer contacts and the automation of processes as well. Unlike in the USA, Japan and Korea, measures to increase cyber security are much more important for the companies surveyed in Europe. Just under 60% of companies in European countries have also introduced software solutions for monitoring environmental effects - compared to 30% to 40% in the USA, Japan and Korea.

NUMBER OF FOREIGN STUDENTS AT GERMAN UNIVERSITIES IS GROWING

Fintiba GmbH and Coracle GmbH, which was added in the 2024 fiscal year, support international students and young professionals on their way to Germany.

According to surveys by the German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD), the number of international students at German universities in the winter semester 2023/24 increased again year-over-year: by 3.3% to 379.94 thousand.⁵ Germany is the most important non-English-speaking host country for international students and ranks third overall on the list of host countries after the USA and UK, together with Australia. As last year, around a third of students still come to Germany from the Asia/Pacific region; around 19% from North Africa and the Middle East and around 5% each from sub-Saharan Africa and Latin America. According

to an OECD study from 2022, around 67% come to a German university for a Master's degree or a doctorate. More than 50% stay in Germany for at least five years after graduating - 45% for more than ten years.⁶

CONTINUED EXPANSION ACTIVITIES IN THE FIBER OPTIC SECTOR

In 2024, the proportion of households in Germany equipped with fiber optic connections will have risen from around 40% to around 49%.⁷ Although this means that Germany has caught up in a European comparison, it is still well below the European average of around 75% (in September 2024).⁸

CONTINUING UPWARD TREND IN COMPANY SUCCESSIONS

The majority of our company investments are made as part of succession solutions when the founders and managing directors wish to retire from the operational side of the business for personal reasons. The number of company successions in the

German SME sector has been growing for years due to demographic factors. According to estimates by the Institut für Mittelstandsforschung Bonn, around 190,000 companies in Germany will be up for transfer between 2022 and 2026 because the owners want to retire from management for personal reasons.⁹ At 45.1%, companies offering business-related services account for the vast majority. Around 40% of the transfers are expected to be for companies in the size category between EUR 1 million and EUR 25 million in revenue which is particularly relevant for the Group.

In view of the demographic development in Europe, it can be assumed that the trend in other European countries is comparable.

BUSINESS PERFORMANCE

The Group's growth continued successfully in the 2024 fiscal year: With Altamount Software GmbH and Waterkant Software GmbH, two new vertical market software platforms became part of the Group. In addition, CHAPTERS Software Switzerland GmbH was founded, which is also active as a platform in the field of vertical market software with a focus on Switzerland.

In the 2024 fiscal year, a total of 13 vertical market software companies became part of the Group within the various platforms. In addition, Fintiba GmbH acquired 100% of the shares in its market companion, Coracle GmbH.

Two significant structural measures were also executed in the 2024 fiscal year:

¹ Statistical Office of the European Union, price-adjusted
² Statistical Office of the European Union, annual change in the harmonized consumer price index
³ KfW SME Digitization Report 2024, March 2025
⁴ SME digitalization in 2024 - managing shocks and transitions, OECD, 2024
⁵ Science open to the world compact, 2025 (DAAD/DWHZ)
⁶ Retention and economic impact of international students in the OECD in International migration outlook 2022, OECD
⁷ BREKO market analysis update, April 2024
⁸ FFTH Council Europe, FTTH /B Market Panorama Europe, September 2024
⁹ Institut für Mittelstandsforschung Bonn, Facts and Figures No. 27: Company successions in Germany 2022 to 2026

In September 2024, CHAPTERS Group AG increased its stake in the industry software platform Ookam from 80% to 100%.

The spin-off of the ENTRO Group, in which NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH held 65% of the shares, also took place in September. The ENTRO Group was founded in June 2022 together with the two managing directors with the aim of establishing a leading integrated group of companies in the field of technical services for industrial access, security and fire protection systems in German-speaking countries. The ENTRO Group will continue to be managed by the managing directors and co-founders and will be supported in its further growth by the NGC management team. The five operating companies that were already part of the Group in the 2023 fiscal year and the Group's three holding companies will be included in the consolidated financial statements of CHAPTERS Group AG with their results until the deconsolidation date at the end of September.

	2024	2023
Revenue of operating subsidiaries (majorities)	EUR 125.8 MM	EUR 87.2 MM
EBITDA (adjusted) of operating subsidiaries (majorities)	EUR 30.3 MM	EUR 24.5 MM
Adjusted earnings per share	EUR 0.22	EUR 0.28
Adj. Earnings per share excluding net income from securities ¹³	EUR 0.14	EUR 0.28
Operating subsidiaries (majority shareholdings)	48	40
Invested capital ¹⁴	EUR 260.0 MM	EUR 139.5 MM ¹⁵
<i>Additional capital invested in the acquisition of and investments in minority interests¹⁶</i>	<i>EUR 38.3 MM</i>	<i>EUR 15.5 MM</i>

On December 31, 2024, a total of 48¹⁰ operating companies were majority-owned by the Group (previous year: 40 companies).¹¹

Since March 2024, CHAPTERS Group AG has also been the largest shareholder in Software Circle plc, which holds a 29.90% stake in industry software companies in the UK and Ireland. As in the previous year, CHAPTERS Group AG also holds a minority stake in two companies that are not yet operationally active and has held a 20.0% stake in MedNation AG since 2021.

KEY FIGURES ON 12/31/2024¹²

The successful continued growth of the Group in the 2024 fiscal year is reflected in a significant increase in the Group's key performance indicators.

Adjusted earnings per share do not take into account the effects on consolidated net income, which are solely attributable to the consolidation requirements of the German Commercial Code (HGB). This mainly relates to the amortization of assets disclosed as part of the purchase price allocation and the associated deferred taxes as well as amortization of goodwill. In addition, the results of operating subsidiaries are only included in the

consolidated financial statements for the period after acquisition. For the adjusted earnings per share, results before acquisition are also taken into account. Other adjustments (e.g. for one-off expenses as included in the calculation of adjusted EBITDA) are not made for the calculation.

The decline in adjusted earnings per share is mainly due to three factors:

Profit and loss transfer agreements are usually concluded between the operating companies that are part of the Group and the relevant acquisition company, which allow the interest expenses incurred at the level of the acquisition company for the financing of the purchase price to be offset against the operating results and reduce the tax burden. For the companies that became part of the Group in the 2024 fiscal year, these contracts will not take effect until 2025, resulting in an increased tax expense that can be offset in subsequent years. In addition, the 2024 fiscal year includes one-off legal and consulting costs for additional borrowing at various levels of the Group.

In the 2024 fiscal year, one company also became part of the Group that will make a significant negative contribution to earnings in 2024. In addition, two companies in the CarMa Group that were already acquired in the 2023 fiscal year are included in the calculation for the first time (as no annual financial statements were available for the companies at the time the consolidated financial statements for 2023 were prepared). For the calculation of adjusted EBITDA, their negative contribution is adjusted to EUR 0.00, while the loss is fully taken

into account for the calculation of earnings per share. We expect all three companies to make a slightly positive contribution to earnings in the 2025 fiscal year.

In addition, due to the positive development of the CHAPTERS Group AG share price, provisions were recognized for share-based remuneration, which are also included in the result and, at EUR 2.79 million, were significantly higher than the previous year's figure of EUR 0.87 million due to the positive development of the share price.

¹⁰ In the previous year, two companies were merged. They were considered as two companies in 2023, but will be treated as a single company going forward. Operational subsidiaries and sister companies are not considered separately, but are attributed to their parent company.

¹¹ And, as in the previous year, a minority shareholding that is not listed on the stock exchange. The company has decided to no longer include minority interests in the calculation of the key figures.

¹² As discussed at the 2024 Annual General Meeting, the company has decided to no longer calculate the base value as a key performance indicator.

¹³ Includes income from the of operating portfolio companies by NGC successor capital of € 0.04 per share in 2023 and € 0.05 per share in 2024.

¹⁴ Comprises the total capital invested for the acquisition of Group companies (including debt financing and equity contribution from minority shareholders) as well as funds provided by CHAPTERS Group AG for the operating business of subsidiaries. The company has decided to no longer include the investment in minority interests in the amount shown here, but to disclose it separately. In the case of minority interests, only the amount invested by CHAPTERS Group AG for the acquisition of the company is taken into account.

¹⁵ Excluding the investments in the ENTRO Group included in previous years.

¹⁶ As in previous years, the investments for the shares in Med-Nation AG are not included. The increase year-over-year is due to the acquisition of the shares in Software Circle plc and the investment in the capital reserve of an existing minority interest.



The **revenue** and **EBITDA** figures presented here are pro forma figures that include all operating Group companies belonging to the Group on December 31, 2024, for the entire fiscal year. For the calculation in the consolidated financial statements, results are only included for the period in which the company was part of the Group in accordance with Section 301 HGB.

In addition, CHAPTERS Group AG as well as the platform companies and acquisition companies are also included in the consolidated financial statements. Costs at the level of the platform companies and acquisition companies are primarily incurred for two reasons: on the one hand, to drive the further growth of the group by evaluating new acquisitions, and on the other hand, to support the development of the operational portfolio companies - for example, by establishing advisory boards staffed with industry experts.

The costs included in the EBITDA of CHAPTERS Group AG also include the costs for share-based remuneration of EUR 2.79 million (previous year: EUR 0.87 million). Excluding the share-based remuneration, the costs of CHAPTERS Group AG and its direct subsidiaries were approx. EUR 1 million above the previous year's figure. In addition to the growth-driven higher running costs, expenses for the ongoing review of new investment opportunities are included.

The costs at the level of the portfolio companies, which were also higher than the previous year's figure of EUR 2.95 million, include one-off expenses of EUR 0.77 million for the raising of (re-)financing. In addition, the establishment of new platforms in the 2024 fiscal year impacts the number.

¹⁷ The company has decided to no longer include the results from minority interests in the key figures in future.

¹⁸ For the calculation of the reported EBITDA, the reduction in inventories of finished goods and work in progress resulting from the purchase price allocation, changes in inventories, income from the reversal of provisions and income, losses and costs from the disposal of fixed assets are not taken into account. The calculation can be found in the notes on the Group's earnings position.

¹⁹ The ENTRO Group companies deconsolidated in the 2024 fiscal year are not included.

RECONCILIATION OF REVENUE AND EBITDA TO THE 2024 CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS¹⁷

	Revenue in EUR MM	EBITDA (reported) ¹⁸ in EUR MM
Total operating portfolio companies	125.84	27.78
- of which before acquisition date	27.85	6.39
+ of which before the date of disposal	12.56	0.28
= Total operating subsidiaries in the consolidated financial statements	110.55	21.67
+ Platform and acquisition companies	0.12	-4.10
+ CHAPTERS Group AG and direct subsidiaries	0.00	-5.80
= Value in the consolidated financial statements	110.67	11.77

The **adjusted EBITDA** for the full year 2024 of all operating companies in which CHAPTERS Group AG directly or indirectly holds a majority stake at the end of the 2024 fiscal year¹⁹ amounts to EUR 30.28 million.

The corrections applied to EBITDA amount to a total of around EUR 2.50 million in the 2024 fiscal year. (previous year: EUR 3.73 million). Of this, EUR -1.14 million is attributable to prior-period income offset against prior-period expenses. EUR 1.85 million is attributable to ramp-up costs for companies that are still being established, the majority of which are attributable to companies in the CarMa Group. An amount of EUR 0.76 million is attributable to one-off expenses, which were mainly incurred for legal advice and in connection with personnel recruitment and remuneration.

EUR 0.48 million is attributable to external costs for new product development. Payments to sellers of EUR 0.30 million are included. Regularly, the seller of companies acquired through one of the platforms has also been active as a managing director. After the acquisition, the management will be handed over to a new managing director. In order to make the transition as smooth as possible, the previous managing director usually stays on board for a few more months and accompanies the process.

ORGANIC GROWTH OF THE GROUP

We define organic growth as the full-year results for a fiscal year based on the respective Group structure on June 30 of that fiscal year - compared to the results of the same Group for the previous fiscal year. For organic growth in 2024, the full-year results for 2024 based on the Group structure on June 30, 2024, are compared with the full-year results for 2023 for this Group structure. At around 11% in the 2024 fiscal year, organic revenue growth exceeded expectations of a slightly positive development - reported EBITDA increased by the same proportion. As expected, adjusted EBITDA was only slightly above the previous year's level.

ADJUSTED EARNINGS PER SHARE

Inherent to the business model of CHAPTERS Group AG and its subsidiaries, the company's consolidated earnings are particularly affected by the results of capital consolidation, the resulting amortization of (intangible) assets, the release of the order backlog identified as part of the purchase price allocation and the associated release of deferred tax liabilities. In addition, the amortization of goodwill has a significant impact on the consolidated result. For the adjusted consolidated profit, the consolidated net loss for the year is adjusted for

these effects (and the related effects on income attributable to non-controlling interests). In addition - as for revenue and EBITDA - the earnings of the companies acquired in the current fiscal year that were generated by a Group company prior to the acquisition are also taken into account (adjusted proportionately for the shares of non-controlling shareholders at the various levels). The result from associated companies is only included in the calculation if it relates to distributions (after taxes).

RECONCILIATION FROM CONSOLIDATED NET INCOME TO ADJUSTED EARNINGS PER SHARE

	2024 in EUR '000	2023 in EUR '000
Net loss for the year	-12,247.36	-6,390.72
- Minority interests	-778.08	-2,306.62
= Consolidated net loss	-11,469.28	-4,084.09
+ Reduction in inventories of finished goods from purchase price allocation	2,022.25	738.99
+ Amortization of assets from purchase price allocation and goodwill	17,544.73	10,963.63
- Release of deferred tax liabilities	1,517.39	718.61
- thereof attributable to non-controlling interests	2,309.86	2,795.76
+ Other consolidation-related adjustments (to the extent attributable to the parent company)	-1,613.25	-1,420.97
Correction of the consolidated loss from the results of capital consolidation	14,126.47	6,767.28
- Result from associated companies	-306.86	1,194.66
+ Dividend received from associated companies	0.00	1,316.70
Correction of the consolidated loss from the results of associated companies	306.86	122.04
± Results of subsidiaries before the date of acquisition / date of sale	3,300.43	3,752.98
± thereof attributable to non-controlling interests	1,141.38	1,453.09
Correction of consolidated loss from results before the acquisition date	2,159.06	2,299.90
= Adjusted consolidated profit	5,123.10	5,105.11
/ Number of shares at the end of the year	22,986,027	18,149,192
= Adj. Earnings per share	0.22	0.28
- Earnings per share from the securities portfolio of CHAPTERS Group AG	0.08	0.00
= Adj. Earnings per share excluding net income from securities ²⁰	0.14	0.28

FINANCIAL POSITION AND NET ASSETS OF THE GROUP

EFFECTS OF CAPITAL CONSOLIDATION AND PURCHASE PRICE ALLOCATION ON THE FINANCIAL POSITION

Inherent to the business model of CHAPTERS Group AG and its subsidiaries, the Group's balance sheet is characterized in particular by the results of the capital consolidation of its subsidiaries. The book value of the investment (purchase price and incidental transaction costs), which is usually recognized at the level of the acquisition company, is offset against the revalued equity of the operating company (to the extent attributable to the acquisition company).

Capital consolidation is carried out using the revaluation method: As part of a purchase price allocation, the main (in-)tangible assets of the respective operating company are identified and revalued if necessary. The identified hidden reserves or hidden liabilities²¹ are capitalized in the consolidated financial statements and - if depreciable - amortized or released on a scheduled basis and, if necessary, written off.

As the Group companies are service and software companies whose business model is characterized by a low level of capital expenditure and debt, no material hidden reserves or liabilities were identified in the tangible assets and liabilities, with the exception of one business property and the telecommunications networks acquired by the CarMa Group. The following intangible assets were identified and measured as part of business model analyses:

Software: The costs for the subsidiaries' self-developed software are not usually capitalized in

the individual financial statements. As part of the purchase price allocation, the software was revalued, capitalized and - depending on the modernity of the software solution - amortized over three to seven years.

Brand: The companies acquired through the platforms are regularly established and well-known in their specific niches, meaning that a value can be assigned to the respective brand. The assets identified in this way are capitalized in the consolidated financial statements and depreciated over 15 years.

Order backlog: The Group's software companies, in particular, are characterized by a high proportion of maintenance contracts, which are accompanied by an annual maintenance fees payments by the customers. Depending on the time of acquisition and the notice periods of the contracts, there are hidden reserves at the time of acquisition due to future revenue which were uncovered as part of the purchase price allocation. The assets identified in this way are recognized in current assets under finished goods and merchandise (thereof from purchase price allocation) and released to income over the remaining term of the contracts (usually one year).

²⁰ Includes one-off income from the sale of an operating investment company by NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH of EUR 0.04 per share in 2023 and EUR 0.05 per share in 2024.
²¹ Hidden liabilities arise when the valuation of assets as part of the purchase price allocation results in a value below the carrying amount reported in the respective separate financial statements.

Deferred tax liabilities were recognized on the hidden reserves uncovered at initial consolidation and the resulting temporary recognition and measurement differences between the commercial balance sheet and the tax balance sheet. These deferred taxes are recognized directly in equity upon initial consolidation. For simplicity's sake, an average combined tax rate of 30% is used to calculate this for companies based in Germany. The country-specific tax rate is used to recognize deferred tax liabilities for companies based abroad. Deferred tax liabilities are released to the consolidated income statement over the useful life of the respective assets.

The difference between the carrying amount of the investment at the direct parent company and the revalued equity at the fully consolidated subsidiary as a positive difference is recognized in the consolidated balance sheet as **goodwill**, which is amortized over ten years. Goodwill reflects the long-term business relationships and the good operating profitability of the operating portfolio companies. The respective acquisition date of the subsidiaries was selected as the measurement date.

Any negative difference between the carrying amount at the direct parent company and the revalued equity of the subsidiaries as part of the pur-

chase price allocation is recognized as difference from capital consolidation on at the level of the direct parent company and disclosed as an item after equity. The difference included in the 2024 fiscal year results from the first-time consolidation of the two companies acquired by CarMa Holding GmbH out of insolvency in the 2023 fiscal year. Due to the insolvency situation, a purchase price was paid for these that was below the revalued value of the acquired assets. Both companies performed positively in the 2024 fiscal year in line with expectations at the time of purchase and should break even in 2025/26, meaning that there will be no correction due to expected losses.

In the corporate structure, minority shareholders are located at various levels. If capital consolidation takes place at the relevant level, the relevant share of the amortization and release of hidden reserves in the assets and goodwill identified in the purchase price allocation are allocated to the non-controlling interests in the net profit for the year or in the equity carried forward.

The disposals and derecognitions in the 2024 fiscal year result from the disposal of consolidated companies (all numbers in EUR thousand).

In EUR '000	Acquisition 2019-2023	Disposal / derecog- nition 2019-2023	Depre- ciation / reversal 2019-2023	End of 2023 / Beginning of 2024	Acquisition	Disposal / derecog- nition/ Rebooking	Depre- ciation / dissolution	End of 2024
Goodwill	133,174.6	-14,401.1	-19,095.5	99,678.0	99,368.9	-10,494.9	-14,106.5	174,445.5
Intangible assets from revaluation	20,530.8	-392.4	-4,547.6	15,590.8	16,725.7	0.0	-3,573.0	28,743.5
Property, plant and equipment from revaluation	145.6	0.0	-24.2	121.4	0.0	-4,481.3	112.9	-4,275.1
Order backlog from revaluation	4,802.4	-114.7	-2,790.5	1,897.2	2,853.4	0.0	-2,022.3	2,728.4
Deferred tax liabilities	7,123.9	0.0	2,021.3	5,102.6	5,329.1	-4.6	1,574.0	8,853.0
Effect on the annual result			-24,436.4				-18,172.9 ²²	
Of which minority interests			6,486.1				2,308.6	
Share of consolidated profit/loss carried forward			-17,950.3	-17,950.3			-15,864.3	33,814.6

FINANCIAL POSITION OF THE GROUP

The Group's **total assets** increased by around 58.0% from EUR 223.95 million to EUR 353.74 million in the 2024 fiscal year as a result of the ongoing acquisition activities of the platform companies.

The Group's **fixed assets** increased from EUR 154.45 million to EUR 267.91 million in the 2024 fiscal year, of which around 76% (previous year: 75%) is attributable to goodwill²³ and hidden reserves on assets disclosed as part of the purchase price allocation.

The Group's **financial assets** increased from EUR 30.29 million to EUR 49.68 million in the 2024 fiscal year.

Included in the financial assets are the **shares in associated companies** held by CHAPTERS Group AG or its wholly owned subsidiary CHAPTERS Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH in amount of EUR 38.02 million (previous year: EUR 15.59 million). Shares in associated companies are valued at acquisition costs less dividends received since the investment and the accumulated earnings of the respective company. If the acquisition costs exceed or fall short of the equity of the respective

company at the time of acquisition, the resulting difference is released to the income statement over ten years and included in the consolidated income statement in the result from associated companies. In the 2024 fiscal year, the shares increased by EUR 5.19 million due to the payment into the capital reserve of Global Heart Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH, an indirect subsidiary of CHAPTERS Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH. Newly accounted for as shares in associated companies is the shareholding of CHAPTERS Group AG's in the listed company Software Circle plc, in which CHAPTERS Group AG became the largest shareholder with 29.90% in March 2024. Software Circle plc invests in vertical market software companies in the UK and Ireland. CHAPTERS Group AG has held shares in Software Circle since 2023; the threshold of 20% was exceeded in 2024. The acquisition costs for the shares in Software Circle total EUR 17.36 million. In addition, a 50% stake in one

²² Includes the release of deferred tax assets in an amount of EUR 56.64 thousand.
²³ An amount of EUR 1.06 million (previous year: EUR 0.18 million) of this is attributable to goodwill already recognized in the acquired companies prior to acquisition by CHAPTERS Group AG and its subsidiaries.

of the operating Group companies, which was previously included in other investments, was newly included in associated companies. The acquisition costs amount to EUR 0.01 million. Considering the result from associated companies of EUR -0.31 million and a currency difference from revaluation in connection with Software Circle plc of EUR 0.18 million recognized directly in equity, the total increase of this position amounts to EUR 22.43 million.

The **shares in affiliated companies (non-consolidated)**²⁴ included in the 2023 consolidated financial statements of EUR 1.22 million are included in the scope of consolidation in the 2024 fiscal year.

The **securities held as fixed assets** of EUR 8.65 million (previous year: EUR 11.79 million) mainly relate to the securities portfolio held by CHAPTERS Group AG as the Group parent company, which was partially reduced in the 2024 fiscal year. To a lesser extent, securities are held by subsidiaries of the group. Further information on the composition of the securities portfolio can be found in the presentation of the financial position and net assets of CHAPTERS Group AG as the parent company of the Group.

Other loans to associated companies of EUR 1.71 million (previous year: EUR 1.38 million) relate to shareholder loans issued by CHAPTERS Group AG to subsidiaries in which the company holds more than 20% but less than 50%. The companies are included in the Group as associated companies using the at-equity method and the shareholder loans are therefore not eliminated as part of the debt consolidation.

Other fixed asset loans of EUR 1.24 million (previous year: EUR 0.29 million) relates to a seller loan (including retained interest) granted in connection with the spin-off of the ENTRO Group in the fiscal year.

The Group's **property, plant and equipment** increased by EUR 3.58 million to EUR 10.66 million in the fiscal year. Around 64% of the increase resulted from investments by a subsidiary of CarMa Holding. In the 2023 fiscal year, CarMa Holding acquired the Glasfaser-Direkt Group, including a partially completed fiber-to-the-home telecommunications network, which is now being completed by the CarMa Group. The first-time consolidation of the two companies of the Glasfaser Direkt Group acquired in the 2023 fiscal year accounted for an additional 16% of the increase. In total, c. 80% of the increase hence is attributable to companies belonging to the CarMa-Group.

The Group's **current assets** increased from EUR 65.73 million to EUR 82.53 million in the fiscal year, of which EUR 58.51 million is attributable to **cash and cash equivalents** (previous year: EUR 50.84 million). Around EUR 26.52 million of this is attributable to (previous year: EUR 38.04) is attributable to CHAPTERS Group AG and its three direct wholly owned subsidiaries.

The increase in **finished goods and merchandise** from EUR 2.37 million to EUR 3.24 million is mainly due to the hidden reserves in connection with existing contracts identified as part of the purchase price allocation.

Trade receivables amount to EUR 10.34 million at the end of the year and increased by EUR 2.64 million during the fiscal year. EUR 3.50 million of this is attributable to the growth of the Group through the acquisition of further subsidiaries. EUR 1.51 million in trade receivables from the previous year were disposed of as part of the deconsolidation of subsidiaries. At the companies included in the consolidated financial statements for the 2023 and 2024 fiscal years, receivables of EUR 0.65 million were added.

Prepaid expenses of EUR 1.87 million (previous year: EUR 3.53 million), EUR 0.53 million of which is attributable to the discount on the perpetual bond

issued by CHAPTERS Group AG in May 2020 (to the extent not related to the shares in the bond held by the company). The discount is amortized over the first five years of the term. Further information on this can be found in the presentation of the financial position and net assets of CHAPTERS Group AG as the Group parent company. In addition, prepaid expenses are recognized at individual operating companies for invoices paid in the 2024 fiscal year, some of which are economically attributable to the 2025 fiscal year.

Equity increased by EUR 24.63 million as a result of the capital increase against contributions in kind at CHAPTERS Group AG as the Group parent company. The capital increase was registered on March 6, 2024. An amount of EUR 1.40 million is attributable to the share capital and EUR 23.23 million to the capital reserve. The subscribers to the capital increase contributed a loan repayment claim against CHAPTERS Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH of EUR 10.35 million and a total of 88,485.50 thousand shares in Software Circle plc, which were valued for the capital increase at a price of GBP 0.138 per share in line with the share price at the time of the resolution to implement the capital increase. On 12/31/2024, the share price was GBP 0.23 per share.

With the capital increase against cash contributions registered on August 23, 2024, the equity of CHAPTERS Group AG increased by a further EUR 84.93 million through the issue of 3,438,322 shares and a corresponding increase in share capital. The capital increase was carried out by means of a private placement.

²⁴ This relates to the investment in two companies by CarMa Holding GmbH in the 2023 fiscal year. The necessary financial statements of the individual company were not yet available for the companies at the time the 2023 consolidated financial statements were prepared, so they were not included in accordance with Section 296 (1) no. 2 HGB.

The amount of EUR 0.15 million included in the capital reserve in 2023 that resulted from an allocation of a capital contribution by non-controlling shareholders to the Group's equity position was eliminated in the fiscal year 2024 as part of the deconsolidation. The capital reserve therefore amounts to a total of EUR 229.91 million. (previous year: EUR 125.34 million).

The item "Currency difference from revaluation" of EUR 1.44 million (previous year: EUR 0.85 million) results from the Czech subsidiary newly added to the Group in the 2023 fiscal year and the subsidiary based in Switzerland newly added to the Group in the 2024 fiscal year. Differences in exchange rates between the valuation at the time of acquisition and the preparation of the consolidated financial statements result in a difference in the revalued assets from purchase price allocation, which is offset via this item.

The profit carried forward attributable to the Group was reduced by EUR 0.03 million due to the increase in the share of a minority shareholder at the level of one of the subsidiaries. Taking into account the net loss for the year and minority interests in equity at the various Group levels, Group equity on December 31, 2024, totaled EUR 224.99 million (previous year: EUR 124.08 million). The equity ratio is 63.6% (previous year 55.4%).

The **difference from capital consolidation** of EUR 2.14 million included in the 2024 fiscal year results from the initial consolidation of the two companies acquired by CarMa Holding GmbH out of insolvency in the 2023 fiscal year, for which a purchase price was paid that was below the revalued value of the acquired fixed assets due to the insolvency situation. Both companies performed positively in the 2024 fiscal year in line with expectations at the time of purchase and should break even in 2025/26, meaning that there will be no correction due to expected losses.

The **special item** of EUR 1.62 million (previous year: EUR 0.0 million) relates to subsidies received in the past for the expansion of a fiber optic network at a company in the Glasfaser Direkt Group. The received subsidy is recognized as a liability and released to the income statement via other operating income over the useful life of the subsidized network.

Provisions amount to EUR 19.20 million at the end of the fiscal year (previous year: EUR 10.39 million). Of this amount, EUR 7.03 million is attributable to tax provisions (previous year: EUR 4.12 million). Of the EUR 2.91 million increase, EUR 1.93 million is attributable to companies that became part of the Group in the 2024 fiscal year. Companies that were already part of the Group in the 2023 fiscal year have built up tax provisions totaling EUR 1.12 million. The deconsolidation resulted in a reduction of EUR 0.14 million.

Other provisions increased from EUR 6.27 million to EUR 12.17 million and include EUR 3.66 million in provisions for share-based payments at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG (previous year: EUR 0.87 million). Share-based remuneration was introduced in the 2023 fiscal year. Further information on the calculation of provisions can be found in the following notes on the financial position and net assets of CHAPTERS Group AG.

In connection with the acquisition of companies, provisions for potential earn-out payments of EUR 2.05 million are recognized. Provisions for earn-out payments of EUR 2.25 million were derecognized in the course of deconsolidation, resulting in a total



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value of EUR 2.29 million on December 31, 2024, (previous year: EUR 2.49 million). EUR 2.70 million of the other increase is attributable to the Group's growth. The effects of deconsolidation account for EUR 0.50 million.

Liabilities amount to EUR 86.74 million at the end of the fiscal year (previous year: EUR 80.30 million). An amount of EUR 25.95 million has a remaining term of less than one year (previous year: EUR 29.07 million) and an amount of EUR 38.61 million has a remaining term of between one and five years (previous year: EUR 21.79 million). An amount of EUR 22.18 million has a remaining term of more than 5 years (previous year: EUR 29.44 million). The decrease in non-current liabilities is due to the netting of the shares held in the perpetual bond. Due to the refinancing of bank loans at the level of various subsidiaries, the proportion of non-current bank liabilities has increased.

Of the total amount of liabilities, an amount of EUR 16.00 million is attributable to (previous year: EUR 25.00 million) on the **perpetual bond** issued by CHAPTERS Group AG in May 2020. Details about the bond can be found in the presentation of the financial position and net assets of CHAPTERS Group AG as the parent company of the Group.

Liabilities to banks increased by EUR 13.93 million to EUR 43.35 million in the 2024 fiscal year. Bank financing of EUR 9.54 million was taken out for transactions that took place in previous years to repay the bridge loan provided by CHAPTERS Group AG. The positive operating performance of the relevant operating subsidiaries and repayments made in the past also made it possible to raise a further EUR 7.18 million to refinance interest retained in the past and long-term shareholder loans, of which EUR 5.90 million accrued to CHAPTERS Group AG and EUR 1.16 million to minority shareholders. EUR

4.34 million in bank debt was raised for transactions that took place in the 2024 fiscal year.

As a result of deconsolidation, liabilities to banks were reduced by EUR 3.03 million. Existing bank financing of EUR 1.82 million for acquired companies was assumed. Repayments on bank loans were made in the total amount of EUR 6.13 million.

EUR 0.08 million was raised at the operating level. Interest for 2024, which had not yet been paid on December 31, 2024, results in an increase of € 0.14 million.

The **trade payables** of EUR 4.34 million (previous year: EUR 3.06 million) mainly include liabilities for purchased services at the level of the operating subsidiaries and increased by EUR 1.27 million in the fiscal year. EUR 2.01 million of this is attributable to the growth of the Group through the acquisition of further subsidiaries. EUR 0.73 million in trade payables from the previous year were disposed of as part of the deconsolidation of subsidiaries. The companies included in the consolidated financial statements for the 2023 and 2024 fiscal years reduced liabilities by EUR 0.01 million.

Other liabilities amount to EUR 22.89 million (previous year: EUR 22.45 million) and include EUR 14.25 million (previous year EUR 14.92 million) in **liabilities to sellers**. An amount of EUR 2.33 million in seller loans was repaid in the 2024 fiscal year. A further amount of EUR 10.35 million was redeemed at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG as part of the capital increase against contributions in kind. An amount of EUR 1.76 million was disposed of as part of the deconsolidation.

In the course of transactions in the 2024 fiscal year, an amount of EUR 13.85 million in purchase prices was deferred as a seller loan. For transactions from

previous years, an additional EUR 0.40 million was classified as seller loans as part of agreements on earn-out payments. An amount of EUR 0.08 million results from lower than originally expected payments and exchange rate-related changes.

Other liabilities also include EUR 2.80 million (previous year EUR 3.26 million) in **liabilities to minority shareholders**. In the fiscal year, minority shareholders paid in EUR 0.32 million in new shareholder loans (net of repayments made) at various levels of the Group. Accumulated interest amounted to EUR 0.20 million. Disposals of previously consolidated companies resulted in a decrease of EUR 0.98 million.

Deferred income of EUR 10.18 million (previous year: EUR 4.08 million) includes payments already received at the level of the operating portfolio companies for contracts with a term that extends beyond the reporting date. Of the overall increase, an amount of EUR 3.90 million is due to the addition of companies to the scope of consolidation.

Deferred tax liabilities of EUR 8.85 million (previous year: EUR 5.10 million) mainly result from the purchase price allocation carried out as part of the capital consolidation.

LIQUIDITY POSITION OF THE GROUP

CHAPTERS Group AG Group reported a **positive cash flow from operating activities** of EUR 11.47 million in the reporting period (previous year: EUR 7.37 million).

Cash flow from investing activities totaled EUR -97.40 million (previous year: EUR -36.34 million), of which an amount of EUR 100.18 million (previous year: EUR 52.00 million) was paid out for the acquisition or increase of shares in operating subsidiaries.

From the disposal of previously consolidated companies, the Group received EUR 8.89 million (previous year: 5.06 million) Payments totaling EUR 3.70 million (previous year: EUR 2.47 million) for investments in tangible assets include EUR 2.30 million (previous year: EUR 1.78 million) for the completion of fiber optic networks and the associated investments in active technology by companies belonging to CarMa Holding GmbH. The payments totaling EUR 16.55 million (previous year: EUR 18.11 million) for financial assets include a payment of EUR 5.19 million (previous year: EUR 12.16 million) into the capital reserve of an associated company and EUR 0.74 million for the acquisition of shares in Software Circle plc. EUR 2.34 million of the additional acquisition costs for the investment in Software Circle plc already arose in the previous year and EUR 14.27 million arose as part of the capital increase in return for a non-cash contribution and therefore did not affect liquidity. EUR 10.20 million result from the acquisition of securities at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG. The disposal of financial assets resulted in a positive cash flow totaling EUR 13.23 million (previous year: EUR 29.67 million) of which EUR 12.60 million resulted from the sale of securities by CHAPTERS Group AG.

Cash flow from financing activities amounts to EUR 85.90 million (previous year: EUR 48.15 million) of which EUR 84.93 million (previous year: EUR 35.37 million) is attributable to the capital increase against cash contributions carried out by CHAPTERS Group AG in August 2024. The capital increase against contributions in kind in March 2024 is not included as it did not affect liquidity. On the level of various Group companies, minority shareholders contributed a total of EUR 0.28 million (previous year: EUR 0.34 million).

The minority shareholders received an amount of EUR 0.32 million through distributions. Subsidiaries provided external financing of EUR 32.92 million (previous year: EUR 17.56 million). Of this, an amount of EUR 11.80 million is attributable to the re-financing of existing liabilities, which are included in the repayments. In addition, repayments of EUR 6.13 million were made and a nominal volume of EUR 9 million in the perpetual bond was repurchased at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG at a price of 91.07% of the nominal value. The cash outflow of EUR 8.20 million is also included in the item payments from the redemption of bonds and (financial) loans. New seller loans are not considered as they do not affect liquidity. Liquidity-related repayments of EUR 2.79 million on existing seller loans were made.

The amount of cash and cash equivalents acquired by the platform companies as part of the acquisition of new operating portfolio companies amounted to EUR 8.66 million (previous year: EUR 6.30 million). The change due to the disposal of companies included in the scope of consolidation in 2023 amounted to EUR -1.00 million (previous year: EUR -0.92 million).

The exchange rate-related changes in cash and cash equivalents result from the Czech subsidiary, which has been included in the scope of consolidation since the 2023 fiscal year, and the different exchange rates used for the consolidation on December 31, 2023, for the closing balance of cash and cash equivalents held there in local currency and the translation on December 31, 2024.

Overall, **cash and cash equivalents** increased to EUR 58.51 million at the end of the year (12/31/2023: EUR 50.84 million).

FINANCIAL AND ASSET POSITION OF CHAPTERS GROUP AG (GROUP PARENT COMPANY)

The company's **total assets** on December 31, 2024, increased by EUR 108.25 million to EUR 271.54 million year-over-year. Taking into account the net profit for the year of EUR 3.64 million and the increase in share capital and capital reserves by a total of EUR 109.55 million as part of the capital increases in March and August 2024, the company's **equity** on December 31, 2024, totaled EUR 249.93 million (previous year: EUR 136.74 million).

The increase in **provisions** from EUR 1.27 million to EUR 5.28 million is mainly due to recognition of EUR 2.79 million to the provisions in connection with the share-based payment. In the 2023 fiscal year, the Supervisory Board established a share option plan ("Virtual Share Option Plan", "VSOP") for the company's Management Board. In the 2024 fiscal year, the Management Board – with the approval of the Supervisory Board – also adapted the share option program for Group employees. A total of 298,230 share options were granted in the 2024 fiscal year, 250,000 of which were for the company's Management Board. In addition to the options granted in the 2023 fiscal year, a total of 548,230 virtual share options were granted. According to Black Scholes, the options are valued at between EUR 5.91 and EUR 6.70 per option. Further information on the VSOP can be found in the notes to the consolidated financial statements under provisions. In addition, tax provisions of EUR 1.32 million are recognized (previous year: EUR 0.12 million).

The perpetual bond issued in May 2020 is reported under **liabilities**. In March 2025, the company announced the full repayment and termination of the bond in May 2025 in connection with a buyback offer. The shares in the bond held by the company itself in the nominal amount of EUR 9.00 million are therefore – unlike in previous years – offset against the nominal value of the bond of EUR 25.00 million (net disclosure in accordance with HGB). The

bond was issued in May 2020 with a discount of 35%, which was recognized in prepaid expenses and released pro rata in line with the development of the repayment value via the interest expense. On December 31, 2024, an amount of EUR 0.53 million remains (also reported net without considering the value attributable to the shares held by the company).

Shares in affiliated companies increased from EUR 32.82 million to EUR 43.47 million in the 2024 fiscal year. The company has paid a total of EUR 10.65 million into the free capital reserves of CHAPTERS Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH. CHAPTERS Beteiligungsgesellschaft used the funds to increase its (indirect) shareholding in Global Heart Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH from 41.73% to 48.88% and to make an associated contribution to the company's free capital reserves. Secondly, a contribution was made to the capital reserves of CHAPTERS Software Switzerland GmbH, which used these funds for the acquisition of Xplain AG and the associated Xplain Iberica SL.

As in the previous year, the shares held by CHAPTERS Group AG in NPV Nachfolge Beteiligungen GmbH and the shares held in MedNation AG (formerly Eifelhöhen-Klinik AG), based in Bonn (ISIN DE0005653604), are reported under **participation**. The shares are recognized at acquisition costs. The increase from EUR 2.54 million on December 31, 2023, to EUR 19.90 million on December 31, 2024, results from CHAPTERS Group AG's investment in Manchester-based Software Circle plc (ISIN GB0009638130). With 29.9%, CHAPTERS Group AG became the company's largest shareholder in March 2024.

In its role as Parent company, CHAPTERS Group AG provides the necessary funds for the acquisition of new portfolio companies by the platform

companies and, to a lesser extent, to finance the expansion of business operations in the form of **shareholder loans or payments into the capital reserves** of subsidiaries. Regularly, part of the purchase price is financed by debt capital provided by banks. If bridge loans are required as part of the transaction process for the period between the acquisition of the company and the provision of debt capital, this is provided in the form of shareholder loans as well. Refinancing usually takes place within a few weeks.

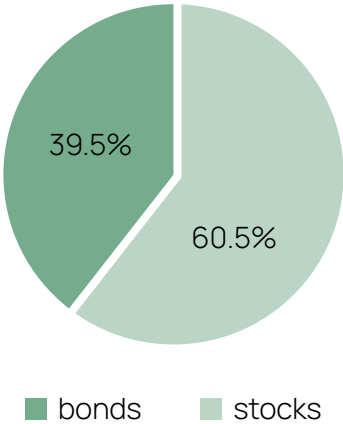
The interest accrued on the shareholder loans can be deferred or paid at the subsidiaries' discretion. In principle, the payment of interest by the subsidiaries is planned. In the 2024 fiscal year, an amount of EUR 2.17 million (previous year: EUR 2.42 million) was received in cash payment of interest from the previous and current fiscal year.

The bridge loans and retained interest are reported under current assets as receivables from affiliated companies and investments. On 12/31/2024, the amount is EUR 46.31 million (previous year: EUR 18.16 million). Of this, an amount of EUR 32.35 million (previous year: EUR 11.28 million) is attributable to shareholder loans issued as part of the bridge loans. Of this, an amount of EUR 28.75 million was already repaid after the reporting date. The amount of deferred interest (including interest from previous years, if not paid) amounts to EUR 13.97 million (previous year: EUR 6.87 million). Of this amount, EUR 6.97 million was already paid after the reporting date.

Such shareholder loans, which are not to be redeemed in the short-term through refinancings but are to be repaid over the next years from the operating cash flow of the acquired companies, are recognized as loans to affiliated companies and investments in fixed assets due to their longer-term nature. Overall, the amount of long-term shareholder loans increased by EUR 54.61 million to EUR 122.51 million in the fiscal year, reflecting the investment activities of the platform companies in the 2024 fiscal year.

Other assets of EUR 3.77 million (previous year: EUR 0.26 million) include EUR 0.23 million in corporation tax reclaims for 2022, as in the previous year. A cash deposit of EUR 2.21 million is included in connection with the delisting carried out by Med-Nation AG. The company supported the delisting of MedNation as part of a bidding consortium and increased its stake in MedNation AG from 20% to approx. 21.5% as part of the tender offer. In January 2025, an amount of EUR 2.11 million of that cash deposit was repaid - the difference is attributable to the shares acquired from CHAPTERS Group AG plus pro rata costs.

**Structure of securities portfolio
on 12/31/2024 (market values)**



As part of its **liquidity management**, CHAPTERS Group AG invests some of its free funds in securities. The securities portfolio was reduced in the 2024 fiscal year in order to finance the acquisition of further operating portfolio companies by the Group. As of December 31, 2024, the market value of the securities portfolio (excluding the shares in MedNation AG and Software Circle plc) was EUR 8.27 million (previous year: EUR 12.66 million).²⁵ In accordance with the lower of cost or market principle under commercial law (Section 253 (3) sentence 5 HGB), the equity investments are valued at the lower of cost or market value on December 31, 2024. A depreciation to market value is only recognized if the market value is at least 5% below

cost. Bond investments are valued at the lower of acquisition cost and nominal value. From the company's perspective (on the reporting date), there is no credit or liquidity risk for the securities. At EUR 8.26 million, the carrying amount is slightly below the market value of EUR 8.27 million. On December 31, 2024, the portfolio consisted of a total of eleven securities, of which five were corporate bonds and six were shares. Based on the market value on 12/31/2024, the weight of the individual securities in the overall portfolio ranges between 0.6% and 12.4%.

LIQUIDITY POSITION OF CHAPTERS GROUP AG

CHAPTERS Group AG received EUR 10.35 million from the capital increase against contributions in kind in March 2024, which was deposited as collateral for the loan contributed (less the costs of the capital measure totaling EUR 0.10 million). In addition, the company received EUR 84.90 million after costs from the capital increase against cash contributions in August 2024. Together with the net proceeds from the reduction of the securities portfolio, the available capital was used to issue new shareholder loans and provide equity for the acquisition of further operating Group companies by the platforms.

	2024 in EUR '000	2023 in EUR '000
Bank balances at the beginning of the fiscal year	26,953.0	17,708.5
Cash flow from shareholder loans & Investments in subsidiaries	-87,518.3	-59,992.7
Shareholder loans issued	-102,518.7	-54,034.6
Repayments from refinancing through bank loans	+26,638.4	+14,961.8
Interest received and similar income	+2,861.1	+2,428.4
Investment in the equity of subsidiaries	-11,397.2	-23,348.5
Other investments	-3,101.8	0.00
Cash flow from investment in securities & Interest	+ 3,073.5	+26,100.6
Outflow from the purchase of securities (incl. accrued interest)	-10,203.7	-4,301.2
Inflow from the sale of securities (incl. accrued interest)	+12,604.1	+29,976.2
Inflow from interest and dividends on securities (after taxes)	+189.7	+208.1
Inflow from interest on sight deposits (after tax)	+483.5	+217.4
Cash flow from capital measures and financing activities	+86,952.5	+44,981.2
Cash inflow from capital increases (after costs)	+95,166.0	+35,333.1
Cash out-/inflow from the perpetual bond (after costs)	-8,213.6	+9,648.1
Other cash flow from operating activities	-2,970.6	-1,844.5
Bank balances at the end of the year	26,490.1	26,953.0
Securities portfolio at the end of the year²⁶	41,517.3	13,600.9

²⁵ The previous year's figure includes shares in Software Circle plc amounting to EUR 3.66 million. The threshold of 20% for disclosure in the investments was only exceeded in the 2024 fiscal year.

²⁶ including the shares in Software Circle plc of EUR 32.31 million (previous year: EUR 3.66 million) and MedNation AG of EUR 0.94 million (previous year: EUR 0.94 million)

EARNINGS POSITION OF THE GROUP

Revenue amounts to EUR 110.67 million in the fiscal year (previous year: EUR 70.77 million). As already explained in the presentation of business activities, the company decided to divide its business into three main segments in the 2024 fiscal year:

	Total in EUR MM	Public in EUR MM	Enterprise in EUR MM	Financial Techno- logies in EUR MM	Other in EUR MM	Holding companies in EUR MM
Pro forma sales 2023	87.37	20.67	22.71	12.31	31.50	0.18
of which from companies that were deconsolidated in 2024	16.55				16.55	
Revenue from companies that were already part of the scope of consolidation in 2023	92.34	22.17	24.60	14.91	30.55	0.12
Revenue from companies that became part of the Group in 2024 (pro rata temporis)	18.33	9.41	8.92			
Group revenue 2024	110.67	31.58	33.51	14.91	30.55	0.12
Minus revenue from companies that were deconsolidated in 2024	-12.56				-12.56	
Plus revenue in the months prior to inclusion in the consolidated financial statements	27.85	17.50	8.04	2.31		
Pro forma revenue 2024	125.96	49.08	41.55	17.22	17.99	0.12

The presentation corresponding to the consolidated financial statements for 2023 is also included below for the 2024 fiscal year for reasons of consistency.

	Total in EUR MM	Software & internet services in EUR MM	Financial Services in EUR MM	Education in EUR MM	Industry- related services in EUR MM	Holding companies in EUR MM
Group revenue 2023	70.77	35.06		11.84	23.69	0.18
Minus revenue from companies that were deconsolidated in 2023	-12.88				-12.88	
Plus revenue in the months prior to inclusion in the consolidated financial statements	29.49	8.33	12.31	0.56	8.28	
Pro forma revenue 2023	87.37	43.39	12.31	12.40	19.10	0.18
of which from companies that were deconsolidated in 2023 ⁴	16.55				16.55	
Revenue from companies that were already part of the scope of consolidation in 2023	92.34	46.76	14.91	15.42	15.13	0.12
Revenue from companies that became part of the Group in 2024 (pro rata temporis)	18.33	18.33				
Group revenue 2024	110.67	65.09	14.91	15.42	15.13	0.12
Minus revenue from companies that were deconsolidated in 2024	-12.56				-12.56	
Plus revenue in the months prior to inclusion in the consolidated financial statements	27.85	25.54	2.31			
Pro forma revenue 2024	125.96	90.63	17.22	15.42	2.57	0.12

The **reduction in inventories of finished goods and work in progress** of EUR 1.87 million (previous year: EUR 1.09 million) consists of an increase at the level of operating group companies of EUR 0.16 million (previous year: reduction of EUR 0.36 million) and the release of the order backlog identified as part of the purchase price allocation of EUR 2.02 million (previous year: EUR 0.74 million). The significant increase in the effects from the purchase price allocation is due to the Group's growth in the 2023 fiscal year and in the current year.

Other operating income of EUR 8.40 million (previous year: EUR 7.56 million) results in EUR 2.76 million (previous year: EUR 3.12 million) from income from the disposal and appreciation of securities at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG. EUR 3.52 million (previous year: EUR 3.04 million) results from the disposal of consolidated companies of which of EUR 2.10 million (previous year: EUR 2.04 million) is attributable to non-cash income from the deconsolidation of subsidiaries.

The **cost of materials** amounts to EUR 18.91 million (previous year: EUR 11.87 million). The cost of materials ratio for the Group remains unchanged at around 17%. The increased percentage share of expenses for raw materials, consumables and supplies in the cost of materials is mainly due to the companies of the ENTRO Group,²⁷ which were only included in the consolidated financial statements proportionately in the 2023 fiscal year in accordance with their date of acquisition. In the 2024 fiscal year, the five companies are included until the date of deconsolidation.

Personnel expenses amount to EUR 54.98 million (previous year: EUR 36.97 million). The personnel expenses ratio fell slightly to 49.6% compared to 52.2% in the previous year) - mainly driven by the deconsolidation of a company from the building services sector, which was still included in the

²⁷ The companies offer installation, replacement and repairs in the field of electronic gate and door systems, barriers and fire and smoke protection systems, among other things, and therefore have a rather high cost of sales inherent in their business model.

scope of consolidation for nine months in the 2023 fiscal year. Due to the share-based remuneration at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG, the personnel expenses ratio in the group of companies included in the consolidated financial statements for both fiscal years with their full-year results has risen slightly to around 51.0%.

Depreciation and amortization amount to EUR 20.37 million (previous year: EUR 12.47 million). EUR 3.44 million (previous year: EUR 2.01 million) of this amount is attributable to amortization of hidden reserves on assets identified as part of the purchase price allocation and EUR 14.11 million (previous year: EUR 8.95 million) to amortization of goodwill resulting from capital consolidation. On the one hand, the increase in the 2024 fiscal year is due to the acquisition of further companies in the 2024 fiscal year. On the other hand, amortization of intangible assets and goodwill at companies acquired in the 2023 fiscal year is recognized for the full fiscal year, whereas in the previous year amortization was only calculated pro rata temporis from the date of acquisition.

Other operating expenses amount to EUR 27.62 million (previous year: EUR 17.59 million). The previous year included an amount of EUR 2.31 million from losses from the disposal of fixed assets, which mainly resulted from disposals from the securities portfolio of CHAPTERS Group AG. In the 2024 fiscal year, the loss amounts to EUR 0.08 million. The expenses from currency translation of EUR 0.39 million (previous year: EUR 0.61 million) mainly result from interest on shareholder loans

from CHAPTERS Group AG for the acquisition of a subsidiary in the Czech Republic in the 2023 fiscal year, as in the 2023 fiscal year. Interest at the subsidiary is recognized in Czech korunas using a different exchange rate than in the Group. A detailed breakdown of ordinary operating expenses of EUR 26.90 million (previous year: EUR 14.52 million) is included in the notes to the consolidated financial statements.

For the calculation of **EBITDA** (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization) of EUR 11.77 million (previous year: EUR 8.15 million) at the Group level, the reduction in inventories of finished goods resulting from the release of the order backlog identified as part of the purchase price allocation is added to earnings before taxes in addition to depreciation and amortization. Moreover, expenses and income from currency translation are corrected and income and losses from the disposal of fixed assets and related costs are not taken into account in the calculation.

		2024 in EUR MM	2023 in EUR MM
	Earnings before interest and taxes according to the consolidated income statement	-4.67	-1.68
+	Reduction in inventories from purchase price allocation	2.02	0.74
+	Depreciation and amortization	20.37	12.47
±	Expenses / income from currency translation	0.37	0.59
-	Income from the disposal/write-up of fixed assets	-6.47	-6.39
+	Losses from the disposal of fixed assets	0.08	2.31
+	Disposal and start-up costs (other operating expenses)	0.07	0.10
=	EBITDA after result from the disposal of non-current assets	11.77	8.15
+	Share-based payment	2.79	0.87
=	EBITDA after result from the sale of non-current assets and share-based payment	14.56	9.02

The **financial result** totals EUR -4.72 million (previous year: EUR -3.03 million) and includes the items listed below:

- ❖ The **result from associated companies and investments** amounts to EUR -0.29 million (previous year: EUR 1.19 million) of which EUR -0.31 million is attributable to the result from associated companies. The composition of the result can be found in the notes to the consolidated financial statements. The decrease is mainly due to the increase in the company's stake in Fintiba GmbH from 39.9% to 55% at the end of December 2023: While the results of Fintiba are still included in the result from associated companies in the 2023 fiscal year, Fintiba GmbH and its results are fully consolidated in the 2024 fiscal year.
- ❖ **Income from other securities and loans classified as financial assets** amounts to EUR 0.41 million (previous year: EUR 0.69 million) and, in addition to dividends and interest on shares and bond investments in the securities portfolio managed by CHAPTERS Group AG, include interest on loans amounting to EUR 0.17 million (previous year: EUR 0.14 million) of which EUR 0.12 million (previous year: EUR 0.09 million) come from companies in which an equity investment is held.
- ❖ **Other interest and similar income** amount to EUR 1.69 million (previous year: EUR 0.83 million). EUR 1.24 million (previous year: EUR 0.59 million) of this amount is attributable to interest income of CHAPTERS Group AG which is explained in the presentation of CHAPTERS Group AG's earnings position. At the subsidiary level, income was primarily realized from interest income on bank deposits.
- ❖ **Interest and similar expenses** of EUR 5.39 million (previous year: EUR 4.22 million) include EUR 1.99 million (previous year: 1.84 million) from the perpetual bond at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG. The interest expense of EUR 3.40 million (previous year: EUR 2.38 million) of the subsidiaries results from interest

on external financing (bank and seller loans) taken out to refinance the purchase prices paid and, to a lesser extent, from interest incurred on loans provided by minority shareholders. The increase is due to the additional bank financing raised as part of ongoing acquisition activities.

- ❖ **Depreciation on financial assets** amount to EUR 1.13 million (previous year: EUR 1.53 million) and, as in the previous year, fully result from depreciation on securities on the level of CHAPTERS Group AG. Further information on the securities portfolio can be found in the presentation of the financial position and financial performance of CHAPTERS Group AG.

Income taxes amount to EUR 2.76 million (previous year: EUR 1.65 million) of which EUR 1.49 million (previous year: EUR 0.60 million) are attributable to the release of deferred tax assets and liabilities (resulting mainly from the results of the purchase price allocation) offset with income tax at the level of the individual companies of EUR 4.26 million (previous year: EUR 2.26 million).

The Group's **net loss for the year** amounts to EUR 12.25 million (previous year: EUR 6.39 million). Of this, EUR 0.78 million (previous year: EUR 2.31 million) is attributable to minority shareholders from the various levels of the Group and EUR 11.47 million (previous year: EUR 4.08 million) to the parent company. For the consolidation-related effects on the consolidated result, please refer to the reconciliation from consolidated loss to adjusted earnings per share in the statement of business performance.

EARNINGS POSITION OF CHAPTERS GROUP AG (GROUP PARENT COMPANY)

The **revenue** of EUR 0.33 million generated in the 2024 fiscal year (previous year: EUR 0.0 million) relates to revenue from the charging of personnel costs borne by CHAPTERS Group AG to subsidiaries (platforms).

Interest income from shareholder loans (including loans to companies in which CHAPTERS Group AG holds a minority stake) and similar income from affiliated companies totaled EUR 9.75 million (previous year: EUR 5.94 million) and - driven by acquisition-related growth - is thus above the expected figure of EUR 7.5 million to EUR 8.5 million. Of this, EUR 0.12 million (previous year: EUR 0.09 million) are included in the income from loans of financial assets. The significant increase in interest income reflects the investment activity in the 2024 fiscal year and the resulting increase in shareholder loans provided by CHAPTERS Group AG for the acquisitions.

The total **interest expense** for the 2024 fiscal year amounts to EUR 1.99 million (EUR 1.84 million) and results in full from the perpetual bond. In April 2024, the company repurchased 36% of the nominal volume as part of a voluntary repurchase offer. The pro rata interest income attributable to this - from the time of repurchase - amounts to EUR 0.51 million. In the previous year, the company held 50% of the shares until a new placement in May 2023 and generated interest income of EUR 0.36 million from this. Both items have no effect on liquidity.

The **income from securities** of CHAPTERS Group AG amounts to EUR 1.81 million in the 2024 fiscal year (previous year: EUR 0.19 million) and is made up of EUR 2.48 million in realized income (previous year: EUR 0.58 million) which, with the reversal of depreciation on securities in the previous year of EUR 0.28 million (previous year: EUR 2.54 million), is included in included in **other operating income**.

The **losses from the disposal of fixed assets** of EUR 0.07 million (previous year: EUR 2.12 million) include realized losses compared to acquisition costs of EUR 0.24 million (previous year: EUR 4.28 million) and the reversal of depreciation from previous years of EUR 0.17 million (previous year: EUR 3.05 million). In addition to **dividend income** of EUR 0.17 million (previous year: EUR 0.18 million), **income from securities and loans held as financial assets** includes income from bond investments of EUR 0.08 million (previous year: EUR 0.37 million). **Depreciation on financial assets and securities held as fixed assets** amount to EUR 1.13 million on 12/31/2024 (previous year: EUR 1.53 million). As in the previous year, the depreciation in the 2024 fiscal year result in full from depreciation on securities. In accordance with the lower of cost or market principle under German commercial law (Section 253 (3) sentence 5 HGB), equity investments are measured at the lower of cost or market value on December 31, 2024, whereby a write-down to market value is only made if the market value is at least 5% below cost. Bond investments are valued at the lower of acquisition cost and nominal value.

The costs of CHAPTERS Group AG as an individual company are mainly divided between personnel, legal and consulting expenses as well as costs incurred in connection with the legal form of the company.

Personnel expenses amount to EUR 3.61 million in the 2024 fiscal year (previous year: EUR 1.38 million). EUR 2.79 million (previous year: EUR 0.87 million) of this amount is attributable to provisions recognized in connection with the share-based payment (in addition to those already existing from the previous year). In the 2023 fiscal year, the company's supervisory board established a share-based compensation component ("Virtual Share Option Plan" ("VSOP") for the company's manage-

ment board. In the 2024 fiscal year, the share option plan for key employees of the company. The options granted and vested on December 31, 2024, amount to 548,230, of which 500,000 are for the management board. The options are valued at an option value of between EUR 5.91 and EUR 6.70 according to Black Scholes, taking into account the respective strike price and the remaining term until exercise. Further information on the VSOP can be found in the notes to the consolidated financial statements under "Remuneration of the executive bodies". The increase in other personnel expenses is mainly due to the recruitment of employees for the platforms, which - as shown above - are charged on to the platforms.

At EUR 0.53 million, **legal and consulting costs** were slightly below the previous year's figure of EUR 0.59 million. In its role as a holding company, CHAPTERS Group AG incurs legal and consulting costs as part of its ongoing business activities (e.g. in connection with the preparation of the consolidated and separate financial statements and advice on capital market law) on the one hand and for the ongoing review of growth opportunities for the Group on the other. In the 2024 fiscal year, around 55% of legal and consulting costs were attributable to the review of growth opportunities.

The **costs resulting from the company's legal form** amount to EUR 0.60 million in the 2024 fiscal year (previous year: EUR 0.38 million). The increase is due to the costs for the two capital increases carried out in the fiscal year included in here and an increase in the costs for the audit of the company's (consolidated) financial statements, which is due to the growth of the Group. The ancillary costs associated with the public notice, which are also included, are roughly on a par with the previous year.

In total, ordinary operating expenses amounted to EUR 2.37 million and, in addition to the legal and consulting costs and the costs resulting from the company's legal form described above, mainly include non-deductible VAT, costs for services provided by subsidiaries and costs in connection with recruitment. Including personnel expenses (to the extent not recharged) and excluding share-based remuneration, CHAPTERS Group AG's costs for the 2024 fiscal year amounted to EUR 2.86 million, slightly above the expected figure of EUR 2.75 million.

Income taxes amount to EUR 1.43 million (previous year: EUR 0.21 million). Since the fiscal year, the company does not have any tax loss carryforward.

Overall, the company reports a **net profit for the year** of EUR 3.64 million on December 31, 2024 (previous year: EUR 1.66 million). The **loss carried forward** is thus reduced to EUR 2.97 million (previous year: EUR 6.60 million).

C. Opportunity and risk report

CHAPTERS Group AG pursues the goal of sustainably increasing the Group's enterprise value in the long term. To this end, the existing portfolio of operating companies being part of th Group is to be further expanded in the coming years, and the value of the existing operating companies is to be continuously increased.

In principle, CHAPTERS Group AG as a group benefits from the diversified positioning of its operating companies, so that the effects of a potentially below-plan development of individual operating companies can be mitigated by positive developments at other companies. Based on the Group structure at the time of preparing the annual report, no company accounts for more than 13.2% of the Group's adjusted EBTIDA (based on the results for the 2024 fiscal year). The largest share is still attributable to Fintiba GmbH, which together with Coracle GmbH contributes approx. 13.5% of EBITDA (previous year approx. 20%).

As investment activity continues, the share of individual companies is becoming increasingly smaller. In the 2024 fiscal year, some companies were combined below one acquisition company and refinanced together. However, the operating Group companies are still largely independent of each other in terms of their business development, meaning that potentially negative events at individual companies do not have a direct and immediate impact on the other Group companies. Joint refinancing also reduces the risks associated with financing, as the interest and repayment burden can be borne by several companies.

The main **risks** for the CHAPTERS Group AG Group are listed below in descending order of relevance (according to the company's assessment) for the future development of the Group.

The company sees significant **opportunities** for the long-term and sustainable increase in enterprise value in the increased focus on the organic growth of the existing Group companies and the investment in further operating companies along the established segments.

RISKS IN CONNECTION WITH THE ACQUISITION OF NEW PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

As part of the acquisition of new Group companies, the platforms carry out a comprehensive market analysis as well as tax, legal and financial due diligence. Nevertheless, it cannot be ruled out that not all risks are known or identified at the time of acquisition. In order to limit the resulting risks, new portfolio companies are usually acquired through legally independent acquisition vehicles and no profit and loss transfer agreements are concluded between the individual acquisition vehicles and the platforms (or CHAPTERS Group AG as the ultimate parent company). In addition, the share purchase agreements contain extensive guarantees on the part of the seller regarding the completeness and accuracy of the information received.

RISKS FROM PERSONNEL DEPENDENCIES

Both at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG as the parent company and at the level of the platforms, the fundamental operational and organizational decisions are made at the level of the management board or the respective managing directors of the platforms. In this respect, there is a dependency on individuals, particularly with regard to the further growth of the Group.

RISKS IN CONNECTION WITH CYBER SECURITY

Cyber security is a key risk area for companies in the software industry. Advancing digitalization, increasing regulatory requirements and the growing professionalization of cyberattacks - particularly through ransomware, phishing or zero-day exploits - are leading to an increased threat situation. Potential consequences include business interruptions, data loss, reputational damage and legal and financial consequences.

To date, there have been no cyber security incidents at companies during their affiliation with the Group that have resulted in significant financial impact. However, two companies that became part of the Group (one in 2024, one in the current fiscal year 2025) had security incidents before they were acquired. Both companies implemented targeted improvements to their IT security architecture prior to the acquisition.

Here, too, the Group benefits from its decentralized structure: Each operating company has an independent IT infrastructure. This means that cyber attacks on a single company cannot spread to other companies in the Group, which significantly reduces systemic risks and strengthens the resilience of the Group as a whole.

Cyber security is also one of the focus topics for 2025. In addition to targeted awareness-raising, the establishment of a competence center for IT security is intended to further expand the exchange and introduction of best security practices within the framework of the Manuscript Method.

RISKS FROM THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE OPERATING PORTFOLIO COMPANIES

The development of the operating companies is dependent on the general economic situation and economic trends. A large number of companies are software companies that offer specialized industry solutions and are therefore ultimately de-

pendent on the development of their respective customers' industries. The majority of customers are based in the country in which the respective operating company is domiciled. The end customers of the software companies come from a wide variety of sectors, some of which tend to be less affected by economic fluctuations (e.g. customers from the education sector and the public sector) and others more (e.g. from the construction sector or the wood or sheet metal processing industry). However, the vast majority of the operating companies is characterized by a broad customer base with a high proportion of recurring revenue which makes them robust in the face of short-term deterioration in economic conditions. Accordingly, the Group companies also performed robustly in the 2024 fiscal year.

Fintiba GmbH and Coracle GmbH, which was added in the 2024 fiscal year, offer digital financial services for international students and young professionals in Germany. Both companies will be negatively affected if the flow of internationals to Germany declines.

For CarMa Group, , the speed of expansion of telecommunication networks particularly by municipal utilities and local authorities is highly relevant. As in the previous year, the pace of expansion by the CarMa Group's end customers was impacted adversely by the challenges surrounding the energy supply and increased financing costs.

Across the Group, risks result in particular from the worsening shortage of skilled workers, which could also impact the growth of the companies belonging to the Group.

RISKS FROM INTEREST RATE CHANGES IN CONNECTION WITH DEBT FINANCING

The purchase prices paid as part of the Group's ongoing growth are partly financed with borrowed capital. Bank financing is subject to an inherent interest rate risk. The majority of existing financing

is not hedged. Within the Group, the effects of increased financing costs are mitigated by the results of Fintiba GmbH, which inherently benefits from rising interest rates in its business model.

The risk from the securities portfolio managed by CHAPTERS Group AG listed in previous years is no longer a significant risk factor from the company's perspective. On December 31, 2024, the securities portfolio accounted for around 2.4% of the Group's total assets.

OPPORTUNITIES FOR THE FURTHER GROWTH OF THE GROUP

Including the transactions that have taken place since the end of the fiscal year, the Group now includes 52 companies that offer digital solutions for their customers. The company sees three main opportunities for the further growth of the Group, which are listed below in ascending order of relevance (according to the company's assessment) for the development of the Group.

One of the key issues in the 2024 fiscal year was establishing a culture of organic growth within the Group. The introduction and continuous development of the Manuscript Method is intended to strengthen the Group's organic growth profile. The new segmentation into the three core areas of Public, Enterprise and Financial Technologies established in the fiscal year is also intended to strengthen the organic growth profile. It allows our management team to measure their own development against comparable market players, identify relevant performance indicators and best practices and leverage specific synergies.

We also see particular growth opportunities in the increasing importance of cyber security solutions - especially in the public segment and in other areas. By focusing on the topic at Group level, we can not only make our products more secure and thus create added value for customers but also develop additional functionalities for the existing prod-

uct range of the Group companies. The increasing spread and acceptance of artificial intelligence is also creating opportunities - whether through internal solutions for technical support, for example, in order to respond to customer inquiries more quickly and in a more targeted manner, or through the introduction of additional functionalities for end customers.

In the 2024 fiscal year, we expanded our geographical focus and invested in several companies in France and one in Switzerland. New Investments are reviewed on an ongoing basis, regardless of geography. We see significant opportunities in acquisition-driven growth within the newly established segments. As in the previous year, the clustering of activities in certain areas enables access to smaller transactions through direct contacts in the relevant market and efficient implementation and management within the existing Group structure.

The company continues to see opportunities in investing in existing industry software platforms or companies that can develop into a platform but is currently focusing more on the growth of existing platforms. The Group is not bound by rigid specifications with regard to transaction structures and can, for example, enable sellers to re-invest in different structures and thus realize the best structure for all parties involved, which can mean a decisive competitive advantage in the transaction business. Continuous adaptation allows opportunities to be seized flexibly.

OVERALL PRESENTATION OF THE OPPORTUNITY AND RISK SITUATION

In the 2024 fiscal year, the Group's growth continued successfully thanks to numerous transactions by the existing platform companies and the establishment of new platforms. We have also made important progress in the further development of structures and processes within the Group. We are convinced that CHAPTERS Group AG as the ultimate parent company and the Group as a whole are well positioned to continue to seize opportuni-

ties flexibly in the future and thus drive long-term, sustainable growth. Based on the information currently available, there are no identifiable risks that, individually or in combination, could jeopardize the continued existence of individual Group companies, the Group as a whole or CHAPTERS Group AG.

KEY FEATURES OF THE INTERNAL CONTROL AND RISK MANAGEMENT SYSTEM WITH REGARD TO THE GROUP ACCOUNTING PROCESS

The consolidated financial statements are prepared in accordance with the provisions of the German Commercial Code (HGB) and the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG). The consolidated financial statements are based on the individual financial statements prepared by the consolidated companies. Responsibility for the accounting process and compliance with the relevant accounting regulations lies with the respective subsidiaries. The platform companies belonging to the Group work together with a small number of selected tax consulting firms, which are responsible for preparing the financial statements for the subsidiaries held by the respective platform and in many cases also handle the accounting. After the acquisition of a new operating portfolio company, accounting is usually transferred to the partner firms within a few months. The ongoing bookkeeping of CHAPTERS Group AG and the preparation of the annual financial statements are also carried out by a tax consultancy firm in order to ensure a four-eye principle and compliance with the principles of proper bookkeeping.

The individual financial statement data supplied by the Group companies are consolidated by CHAPTERS Group AG with the help of consolidation software, in which the necessary consolidation work is carried out. Recording is largely automated and reviewed in a four-eye-process. As part of the recording process, the figures are also validated, including a consistency check against the previous year. In addition to capital consolidation, debt consolidation is particularly relevant regarding the shareholder loans provided by CHAPTERS Group AG for the acquisition. The purchase price allocation is also carried out at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG (with the support of Baker Tilly GmbH & Co. KG Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft).

D. Outlook

A central theme in 2024 was the continuation of the process initiated in 2023 to sharpen the focus on specific areas, as well as the establishment of a culture of organic growth within our companies. In the 2025 fiscal year, the Group has already grown by seven additional companies, all in the field of digital solutions. In addition, the GfW Group, whose operating companies are active in the education sector, was spun off. Further information on this can be found in the supplementary report.

At the time of publication, the Group therefore comprised a total of 52 companies that generated revenue of around EUR 167 million and operating EBITDA (adjusted) of around EUR 41 million in the 2024 fiscal year - with EBITDA coming almost exclusively from companies that offer digital solutions for their customers.

For the 2025 fiscal year, we expect to achieve organic growth for both revenue and EBITDA (adjusted) in the low teens range. We define organic growth as the full-year results for a fiscal year based on the respective Group structure on June 30 of that fiscal year - compared to the full-year results of the same Group for the previous fiscal year. For organic growth in 2025, the full-year results for 2025 based on the Group structure on June 30, 2025, are compared with the full-year results for 2024 for this Group structure.

We also anticipate strong inorganic growth again in 2025. The platforms of CHAPTERS Group AG continuously review the acquisition of further operating portfolio companies within their respective markets and corresponding strategies. No forecast can be made with regard to the volume and timing of further investments. It is therefore not possible to make a valid forecast for the absolute amount of Group revenue and Group EBITDA for

the current fiscal year 2025. The Group is developing dynamically and seizes opportunities where they are considered sensible - and where it is in a position to finance them.

CHAPTERS GROUP AG AS GROUP PARENT COMPANY

The main contribution to earnings at CHAPTERS Group AG level is primarily the interest income from the shareholder loans to finance the acquisition of the operating portfolio companies. Interest income again increased significantly year-on-year in the 2024 fiscal year as a result of the platform companies' ongoing investment activities. The company anticipates a further increase in interest income in the 2025 fiscal year. Based on the currently outstanding shareholder loans, we expect interest income of EUR 12 to 14 million. The development in the 2024 fiscal year is highly dependent on the ongoing investment activities of CHAPTERS Group AG and its platform companies. It is not possible to forecast the volume and timing of further transactions.

With regard to the operating costs of CHAPTERS Group AG, the company anticipates an increase to around EUR 4.5 to 5 million, partly due to the ongoing growth of the Group and the expansion of the team at CHAPTERS Group AG level. Costs that are passed on within the Group and share-based remuneration are not taken into account.

The annual result of CHAPTERS Group AG is also influenced by the results from the securities portfolio and the formation of provisions for share-based remuneration.

DISTRIBUTIONS

No distributions by CHAPTERS Group AG are planned for the 2024 fiscal year or for the coming years. We are convinced that the income generated in the operating Group companies - in addition to servicing existing debt financing at the various levels of the Group - can be used sensibly and in a value-creating manner for further organic and acquisitive growth.

Hamburg, May 26, 2025


.....
Jan-Hendrik Mohr
CEO


.....
Marlene Carl
CFO

CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS FOR THE FINANCIAL YEAR 2024

Consolidated Income Statement for the year ended December 31, 2024

	Fiscal year in EUR '000	Previous year in EUR '000
1. Revenue	110,673.47	70,766.28
2. Decrease or increase in inventories of finished goods and work in progress <i>thereof from purchase price allocation</i> <i>thereof other changes</i>	-1,865.89 156.36 -2,022.25	-1,094.88 -738.99 -355.88
Overall performance	108,807.58	69,671.40
3. Other operating income <i>thereof income from the disposal of and write-ups to non-current assets</i>	8,404.84 6,469.02	7,558.93 6,386.43
4. Cost of materials a) Cost of raw materials, consumables and supplies and of purchased goods b) Expenses for purchased services	-18,912.72 -8,643.49 -10,269.24	-11,869.69 -4,760.31 -7,109.39
5. Personnel expenses a) Wages and salaries <i>thereof for share-based payment</i> b) Social security contributions and expenses for pensions and other benefits <i>thereof for pensions</i>	-54,980.98 -45,661.45 -2,788.07 -9,319.53 -333.92	-36,970.26 -30,574.89 -867.50 -6,395.37 -139.99
6. Depreciation and amortization a) on intangible assets and property, plant and equipment <i>thereof on assets from purchase price allocation</i> <i>thereof on goodwill</i> b) on current assets <i>(to the extent that these exceed the company's normal depreciation)</i>	-20,371.63 -20,343.60 -3,439.35 -14,105.38 -28.02	-12,474.52 -12,448.94 -2,009.57 -8,954.06 -25.57
7. Other operating expenses <i>thereof losses from the disposal of fixed assets</i>	-27,616.91 -83.07	-17,594.17 -2,306.08
Earnings before interest and taxes	-4,669.82	-1,678.30
8. Result from associated companies	-306.86	1,194.66
9. Income from investments	13.87	0.00
10. Income from other securities and from loans classified as financial assets <i>thereof from companies in which an equity interest is held</i>	408.71 118.38	694.84 93.83
11. Other interest and similar income <i>thereof from shares held in perpetual bonds</i> <i>thereof from companies in which an equity interest is held</i>	1,691.39 506.19 16.89	828.54 362.78 10.95
12. Write-downs on financial assets <i>thereof impairment losses</i>	-1,131.14 -1,131.14	-1,529.15 -1,529.15
13. Interest and similar expenses <i>thereof for perpetual bond</i>	-5,392.86 -1,992.69	-4,223.52 -1,836.49
14. Income taxes <i>thereof from the reversal of deferred tax assets and liabilities</i>	-2,765.19 1,492.97	-1,651.51 604.83
Earnings after taxes	-12,151.90	-6,364.44
15. Other taxes	-95.46	-26.28
Net loss for the year	-12,247.36	-6,390.72
attributable to non-controlling interests	-778.08	-2,306.62
Consolidated net loss for the year	-11,469.28	-4,084.09

Consolidated Balance Sheet as at December 31, 2024

	12/31/2024 in EUR '000	12/31/2023 in EUR '000
A. Fixed assets	267,914.58	154,448.72
I. Intangible assets	207,578.77	117,087.11
1. Purchased concessions, industrial property rights and similar rights and assets thereof from purchase price allocation	31,916.03 28,743.50	17,210.68 15,590.82
2. Goodwill	175,510.42	99,861.23
3. Advance payments made	152.32	15.19
II. Property, plant and equipment	10,658.45	7,074.61
1. Land / buildings	1,326.05	1,205.94
2. Property, plant and equipment	1,105.84	813.33
3. Other equipment and operating and office equipment	5,110.82	4,397.69
4. Advance payments and assets under construction	3,115.74	657.65
III. Financial assets	49,677.36	30,287.01
1. Shares in associated companies	38,018.34	15,586.76
2. Shares in affiliated companies (not consolidated)	0.00	1,217.63
3. Loans to associated companies	1,709.98	1,375.45
4. Other participations in companies	62.00	25.00
5. Securities held as fixed assets	8,648.20	11,793.07
6. Other loans	1,238.84	289.10
B. Current assets	82,531.63	65,726.80
I. Inventories	4,383.25	3,964.69
1. Raw materials and supplies	7.89	622.87
2. Work in progress, unfinished services	1,100.18	971.90
3. Finished products and goods thereof from purchase price allocation	3,240.13 2,728.31	2,368.13 1,897.14
4. Advance payments made	35.05	1.78
II. Receivables and other assets	19,640.61	10,918.91
1. Trade receivables	10,342.08	7,697.56
2. Receivables from companies in which an equity interest is held	332.02	241.91
3. Other assets	8,966.51	2,979.45
III. Cash on hand, bank balances	58,507.77	50,843.20
C. Accrued items	1,808.44	3,533.03
D. Deferred tax assets	1,485.70	237.75
Total assets	353,740.35	223,946.31

	12/31/2024 in EUR '000	12/31/2023 in EUR '000
A. Equity	224,992.71	124,079.38
I. Subscribed capital	22,986.03	18,149.19
II. Capital reserve	229,909.73	125,344.75
II. Currency difference from revaluation	1,382.86	853.76
IV. Loss carryforward	-18,324.69	-14,207.01
V. Consolidated net loss for the year	-11,469.28	-4,084.09
VI. Non-controlling interests	508.06	-1,977.22
B. Difference from capital consolidation	2,144.94	0.00
C. Special items	1,621.85	0.00
D. Provisions	19,203.59	10,385.66
1. Tax provisions	7,028.76	4,119.43
2. Other provisions thereof for share-based payment thereof for potential additional purchase price payments (earn-outs)	12,174.83 3,655.57 2,285.00	6,266.23 867.50 2,485.00
E. Liabilities	86,741.35	80,301.36
1. Bond	16,000.00	25,000.00
2. Liabilities to banks	43,351.25	29,426.02
3. Advance payments received on orders	162.26	364.51
4. Trade payables	4,338.08	3,064.81
5. Other liabilities thereof from seller loans thereof to minority shareholders	22,889.76 14,246.38 2,797.54	22,446.02 14,922.70 3,259.50
F. Deferred income	10,182.91	4,077.31
G. Deferred tax liabilities	8,853.00	5,102.61
Total liabilities	353,740.35	223,946.31

Consolidated Statement of Changes in Equity as at December 31, 2024

Attributable to the shareholders of the parent company						
	Share capital in EUR '000	Capital reserve in EUR '000	Currency difference from revaluation in EUR '000	Loss carried forward in EUR '000	Consolidated net loss for the year in EUR '000	Total in EUR '000
Valid 01/01/2024	18,149.19	125,344.75	853.76	-18,291.10	0.00	126,056.60
Capital increase 03/2024	1,398.51	23,229.31				24,627.82
Capital increase 08/2024	3,438.33	81,488.23				84,926.56
Profit distributions						
Changes in the scope of consolidation		-152.56	8.68	2,156.55		-143.88
Ongoing change in value from currency translation			2.95			2.95
Other changes			517.47	-33.59		483.88
Group result					-11,469.28	-11,469.28
Valid 12/31/2024	22,986.03	229,909.73	1,382.86	18,324.69	-11,469.28	224,484.65

The amount attributable to non-controlling interests before revaluation reserve, equity difference from currency translation and net profit/loss for the year corresponds to the proportionate interest of the respective minority shareholder in the share capital and the capital reserve of the subsidiaries concerned.

In the 2023 fiscal year, minority shareholders made payments into the capital reserves of subsidiaries, which were credited to the Group on a pro rata basis. The deconsolidation of the corresponding subsidiaries reduced the capital reserves attributable to the Group by the same amount in the 2024

fiscal year. The minority interests in the revaluation reserve result from capital consolidation. Insofar as minority shareholders have a direct interest in the acquired company, their share of the purchase price allocation is reported here. The share in these items attributable to the Group are eliminated as part of capital consolidation.

The currency difference from revaluation item results from the Czech subsidiary newly added to the Group in the 2023 fiscal year and the subsidiary in Switzerland newly added in the 2024 fiscal year as well as the shares in an associated company in the UK. Differences in exchange rates between the

Non-controlling interests							
	Non-control- ling interests before revaluation reserve, equity difference from currency translation and net income for the year in EUR '000	Revaluation reserve in EUR '000	Currency difference from revaluation in EUR '000	Difference from capital consoli- dation in EUR '000	profit and loss attributable to non- controlling interests in EUR '000	Total in EUR '000	Group equity in EUR '000
Valid 01/01/2024	1,075.22	1,566.18	213.44	0.00	-4,832.06	-1,977.22	124,079.38
Capital increase 03/2024							24,627.82
Capital increase 08/2024							84,926.56
Profit distributions					-325.31	-325.31	-325.31
Changes in the scope of consolidation	-6.90		1.75	536.23	1,395.49	1,926.57	1,782.69
Ongoing change in value from currency translation							2.95
Other changes	-100.03		-213.44		1,975.57	1,662.10	2,145.98
Group result					-778.08	-778.08	-12,247.36
Valid 12/31/2024	968.29	1,566.18	1.75	536.23	-2,564.39	508.06	224,992.71

valuation at the time of acquisition and the preparation of the consolidated financial statements result in a difference in the revalued assets from purchase price allocation, which is offset by this item. In addition to the above-mentioned payment into the capital reserve, other changes include changes resulting from the increase or reduction of the Group's shares in subsidiaries.

The movements from changes in the scope of consolidation include the changes from the deconsolidation of the ENTRO Group on the one hand and the effects from the inclusion of new companies in the scope of consolidation on the other. The prof-

it distributions mainly result from distributions in connection with the spin-off of the ENTRO Group in the 2024 fiscal year. The share of these payments attributable to minority interests is reported under non-controlling interests in equity. To a lesser extent, distributions from the previous year's earnings were made to minority shareholders at the level of the operating subsidiaries.

Consolidated Cash Flow Statement for the year ended December 31, 2024

Cash and cash equivalents correspond to the balance sheet item "Cash in hand and bank balances". Of this, EUR 120.00 thousand (previous year: EUR 120.00 thousand) was deposited as collateral for a bank guarantee issued by CHAPTERS Group AG and is subject to corresponding restrictions on disposal. EUR 5,239.05 thousand (previous year: EUR 1,797.58 thousand) relates to subsidiaries for which the approval of minority shareholders is required to dispose of the funds. Subsidiaries have an amount of EUR 529.50 thousand that is restricted. Other non-cash income (previous year expenses) mainly includes the result from associated companies. Further information on the development of the Group's liquidity position can be found in the Combined Management Report. The exchange rate-related changes in cash and cash equivalents result from the Czech subsidiary belonging to the Group and the cash and cash equivalents held there.

	Fiscal year in EUR '000	Previous year in EUR '000
Profit for the period (including minority interests)	-12,247.36	-6,390.72
Reversal of orders/goods on hand from the purchase price allocation	2,022.25	738.99
Depreciation/write-ups of property, plant and equipment <i>thereof on assets disclosed as part of the purchase price allocation</i>	1,658.14 112.92	1,045.34 0.17
Write-downs/write-ups on financial assets	-1,131.14	-1,014.25
Amortization/write-ups of intangible assets <i>thereof on assets disclosed as part of the purchase price allocation</i> <i>thereof on goodwill</i>	18,685.46 3,326.43 14,105.38	11,403.60 2,009.40 8,954.06
Increase/decrease in provisions	4,361.40	1,184.36
Other non-cash expenses/income	591.25	-1,237.86
Increase/decrease in inventories, receivables Loans and other assets (unless investment/financial assets)	-3,509.16	-2,445.33
Increase/decrease in payables Liabilities and other payables (unless investment/financial liabilities)	2,043.16	2,384.31
Profit/loss from the disposal of fixed assets	-6,385.95	-1,536.94
Interest expenses/interest income	3,370.12	2,883.15
Other investment income	-91.24	-183.00
Income tax expense/income	4,258.16	2,256.33
Income tax payments	-2,903.71	-1,002.54
Release of deferred taxes from purchase price allocation	-1,517.39	-718.61
Cash flow from operating activities	11,466.28	7,366.85
Proceeds from the disposal of intangible assets	7.05	0.00
Payments for investments in intangible assets	-799.08	-1,090.21
Proceeds from the disposal of property, plant and equipment	216.31	259.77
Payments for investments in property, plant and equipment	-3,704.70	-2,465.23
Proceeds from the disposal of financial assets	13,232.68	29,674.59
Payments for investments in financial assets	-16,488.74	-18,111.84
Payments for additions to the scope of consolidation	-100,182.70	-52,004.04
Proceeds from disposals from the scope of consolidation	8,894.74	5,061.11
Interest and dividend payments received	1,425.50	2,336.76
Cash flow from investing activities	-97,398.92	-36,339.10
Proceeds from capital measures of CHAPTERS Group AG	84,926.55	35,372.12
Proceeds from equity contributions from other shareholders	276.06	340.12
Change in liabilities to shareholders	-131.93	514.89
Payments to company owners and minority shareholders	-325.31	-658.23
Proceeds from the issuance of bonds and taking out (financial) loans	33,167.79	27,209.40
Payments from the repayment of bonds and (financial) loans	-28,915.62	-12,934.67
Interest paid	-3,079.51	-1,690.79
Cash flow from financing activities	85,918.03	48,152.84
Effective changes in cash and cash equivalents	-14.61	19,180.58
Cash and cash equivalents at the beginning of the period	50,843.20	26,278.50
Change in cash funds from exchange rate movements, changes in reporting entity structure and remeasurement	12.77	0.00
Changes in cash and cash equivalents due to changes in the scope of consolidation	7,666.41	5,384.12
Cash and cash equivalents at the end of the period	58,507.77	50,843.20

Notes to the Consolidated Financial Statements for the Financial Year 2024

A. General information

CHAPTERS Group AG has its registered office in Hamburg and is entered in the commercial register at Hamburg Local Court under registration number HRB 182147. The company's shares have been traded on the open market of the Frankfurt Stock Exchange since June 3, 2005 (WKN 661 830). The open market is not an organized market within the meaning of Section 2 (11) WpHG.

CHAPTERS Group AG invests - usually indirectly via subsidiaries - in companies, currently exclusively based in Europe and the USA. As of the reporting date, the company directly or indirectly held majority interests in 96 companies (previous year: 78), 59¹ of which were operating subsidiaries (previous year: 42). On the balance sheet date, the company has seven minority interests in which it holds more than 20%, one of which is in a listed stock corporation. The companies in which CHAPTERS Group AG holds a majority interest are small corporations in accordance with Section 267 (1) of the German Commercial Code (HGB), insofar as they are based in Germany.

As the parent company, CHAPTERS Group AG prepares consolidated financial statements and a Group management report for the 2024 fiscal year. The size criteria pursuant to Section 293 (1) HGB were exceeded for the first time in the 2021 fiscal year. The consolidated total assets amount to EUR 353.74 million on December 31, 2024 (previous year: EUR 223.95 million), revenue amounts to EUR 110.67 million (previous year: EUR 70.77 million), the average number of employees in the 2024 fiscal year is 805 (previous year: 952). For companies

that became part of the scope of consolidation in the 2024 fiscal year, employees are only included on a pro rata basis for the period in which the company was part of the Group. Managing directors or, in the case of CHAPTERS Group AG, members of the Management Board are not included in the calculation of the number.

The consolidated financial statements for the 2024 fiscal year are prepared in accordance with the provisions of the German Commercial Code (HGB) and the German Stock Corporation Act (AktG) and comprise the consolidated balance sheet, the consolidated income statement, the consolidated cash flow statement, the consolidated statement of changes in equity and the notes to the consolidated financial statements (including the statement of changes in liabilities and fixed assets). When using rounded amounts and percentages, differences may occur due to commercial rounding. The fiscal year of CHAPTERS Group AG and the majority of the subsidiaries included begins on January 1 of the calendar year and ends on December 31. The consolidated income statement - like the income statements of the consolidated companies - is prepared using the total cost method.

The Group management report of CHAPTERS Group AG has been combined with the management report of CHAPTERS Group AG in accordance with Section 315 (5) HGB in conjunction with Section 298 (2) HGB.

B. Scope and methods of consolidation

SCOPE OF CONSOLIDATION

The reporting date for the consolidated financial statements is December 31 of the fiscal year. This corresponds to the reporting date of the parent company CHAPTERS Group AG. With the exception of four companies, all annual financial statements of the companies included in the consolidated financial statements were prepared for the period from January 1, 2024, to December 31, 2024. For each of the four companies, annual financial statements were prepared for April 1, 2024, for December 31, 2024. The companies were included in the consolidated financial statements for the period in which they belonged to the Group.

In accordance with Section 294 (1) HGB, the consolidated financial statements include all companies in which CHAPTERS Group AG directly or indirectly holds more than 50% of the capital on the consolidated reporting date of December 31, 2024. Companies in which CHAPTERS Group AG has an indirect shareholding of less than 50%, but in which more than 50% of the capital is held by a Group company at each level of the investment chain, are also included. On December 31, 2024, there are no companies in which CHAPTERS Group AG holds less than 50% of the capital but to which it is entitled to more than 50% of the voting rights.

The consolidation date is the date of acquisition of the respective subsidiary. If no interim financial statements are prepared at the time of acquisition for transactions that took place during the year, these are derived using the pro rata temporis

method. Subsidiaries acquired in the 2024 fiscal year are only included in the consolidated income statement on a pro rata basis with the earnings generated since the acquisition date.

In addition to the parent company, the scope of consolidation on December 31, 2024, comprises 96 companies (previous year: 72 companies) that are fully consolidated. Three companies are not included in the consolidated financial statements with reference to Section 296 (2) HGB.

70 companies are based in Germany, three companies in Austria (one acquisition company and two operating subsidiaries) and one company in the Czech Republic (operating company). The Czech company also holds 100% of the shares in a company based in the Slovak Republic. Fifteen companies (one investment platform, five acquisition companies and nine operating companies) are based in France. Three companies (an investment platform, an acquisition company and an operating company) are based in Switzerland. Two companies are based in the USA. One company each is based in Spain (operating company), Bulgaria (no longer operating) and the UK (operating company).

Seven companies (previous year: five companies) in which CHAPTERS Group AG indirectly holds more than 20% but less than 50% of the capital are included in the consolidated financial statements as associated companies using the equity method.

¹ The deviations from the value in the combined management report result from the combination of several legal companies into one operating unit and vice versa.

No.	Society	Head-quarters	Category	Shareholding CHAPTERS Group AG	Involved via no.	Share of direct parent company	Part of the group since	Inclusion in conso-lidated financial statements 2023
Parent company								
1	CHAPTERS Group AG	Hamburg						
Direct participations								
2	CHAPTERS Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH ²	Hamburg	Holding company	100.00	1	100.00	Feb 19	✓
Indirect participations (First Level)								
3	NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH	Munich	platform company	80.00	2	80.00	Mar 19	✓
4	Ookam Software GmbH	Berlin	platform company	100.00	2	100.00	May 19	✓
5	CarMa Holding GmbH	Aalen	platform company	80.00	2	80.00	Jun 21	✓
6	mlog capital SAS	Le Bouscat, France	platform company	80.00	2	80.00	Dec 23	✓
7	CHAPTERS Beteiligungen Verwaltungs GmbH ²	Hamburg	Verwaltungs GmbH	100.00	2	100.00	Aug 22	✓
8	CHAPTERS Beteiligungen 1 GmbH & Co. KG ²	Hamburg	platform company	100.00	2	100.00	Aug 22	✓
9	Fintiba GmbH	Frankfurt	Operating company	55.00	2	55.00	Dec 21	✓
10	Kältehelden GmbH	Hamburg	Operating company	80.00	2	80.00	Aug 20	✓
11	CHAPTERS Switzerland GmbH	Zurich, Switzerland	platform company	100.00	2	100.00	Oct 24	
12	Altamount Software GmbH	Berlin	platform company	87.50	2	87.50	Jun 24	
13	Waterkant Software GmbH	Hamburg	platform company	80.00	2	80.00	Sep 24	
Indirect participations below NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH (No. 3)								
14	GfW Gesellschaft für Weiterbildung mbH ³	Berlin	Acquisition company	62.27	3	77.84	Dec 20	✓
15	Speakeasy Berlin GmbH	Berlin	Operating company	62.27	14	100.00	Dec 20	✓
16	Speakeasy München GmbH	Munich	Operating company	54.80	14	88.00	Mar 21	✓
17	Strassenberger Akademie GmbH	Berlin	Operating company	49.82	14	80.00	Mar 21	✓
18	Kunstschule Wandsbek GmbH	Hamburg	Operating company	62.27	14	100.00	Mar 21	✓
19	Die Neue Schule GbR	Berlin	Operating company	62.27	11	100.00	Apr 23	pro-rata
20	NGC CNC Beteiligungen GmbH	Alfdorf	Acquisition company	68.00	3	85.00	Apr 21	✓
21	Direkt CNC-Systeme GmbH	Alfdorf	Operating company	68.00	20	100.00	May 21	✓
22	NGC Immobilien Verwaltungs GmbH	Munich	AssetCo *	80.00	3	100.00	Nov 22	✓
Indirect participations below Ookam Software GmbH (No. 4)								
23	OSW Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	90.00	4	90.00	Jul 19	✓
24	Parity Software GmbH	Eberdingen-Hochdorf	Operating company	90.00	23	90.00	Aug 19	✓
25	GAIN Software GmbH	Schönbrunn i. Stgw.	Operating company	90.00	23	100.00	Jul 23	pro-rata
26	CSB – Bruns & Börjes GmbH	Augustfehn	Operating company	90.00	23	100.00	Jan 24	

27	gripsware datentechnik gmbh	Hemshofen	Operating company	100.00	49	100.00	Dec 19	✓
28	SWH Softwarehaus Heider GmbH	Bad Abbach	Operating company	100.00	49	100.00	Dec 19	✓
29	Software und Beratung Meinhardt GmbH	Eschwege	Operating company	91.00	49	91.00	Dec 22	✓
30	OSW 4 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	99.00	49	99.00	Aug 20	✓
31	BleTec Software GmbH	Roßdorf	Operating company	99.00	4	100.00	Dec 20	✓
32	OPAS Software GmbH	Strullendorf	Operating company	100.00	49	100.00	Dec 20	✓
33	OSW 6 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	90.00	4	90.00	Mar 21	✓
34	DATEX Software GmbH	Karlsruhe	Operating company	90.00	33	100.00	Apr 21	✓
35	OSW 7 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	90.00	4	90.00	Mar 21	✓
36	Software24.com GmbH	St. Stephen's Churches	Operating company	90.00	35	100.00	Apr 21	✓
37	WAREHaus GmbH	Solingen	Operating company	90.00	44	100.00	Jun 22	✓
38	MWM Software & Beratung GmbH	Bonn	Operating company	81.00	35	90.00	Jun 23	pro-rata
39	Key Logic GmbH	Eschborn	Operating company	90.00	35	90.00	Aug 23	pro-rata
40	Littera Software & Consulting GmbH	Hall in Tirol, Austria	Operating company	90.00	35	100.00	Nov 23	pro-rata
41	Littera Software & Consulting GmbH	Munich	Operating company	90.00	40	100.00	Nov 23	pro-rata
42	filmwerte GmbH	Potsdam	Operating company	90.00	35	100.00	Nov 24	
43	myfilmfriend LLC	Austin, USA	Operating company	90.00	42	100.00	Nov 24	
44	OSW 8 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	90.00	4	90.00	Sep 21	✓
45	Corporate Montage Europe GmbH	Wiesbaden	Operating company	90.00	44	100.00	Sep 21	✓
46	elKom Solutions GmbH	Tuttlingen	Operating company	100.00	49	100.00	Dec 21	✓
47	OSW 10 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	90.00	4	90.00	Dec 21	✓
48	Voigt Software und Beratung AG	Ilfeld	Operating company	90.00	47	100.00	May 22	✓
49	OSW 11 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH ⁴	Berlin	Acquisition company	100.00	4	100.00	Dec 21	✓
50	Condition Integrierte Software-lösungen GmbH	Goettingen	Operating company	100.00	49	100.00	Jan 23	✓
51	rocom GmbH	Riedering	Operating company	100.00	49	100.00	Dec 23	pro-rata
52	OSW 12 AT Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Vienna, Austria	Acquisition company	100.00	4	100.00	Feb 22	✓
53	Solarys Software GmbH	Vienna, Austria	Operating company	100.00	59	100.00	Feb 22 / Dec 22	✓
54	Utilities Systems s.r.o.	Prague, Czech Republic	Operating company	100.00	4	100.00	Apr 23	✓
55	Usys Slovakia, s.r.o.	Banská Bystrica, Republic of Slow.	Operating company	100.00	54	100.00	Apr 23	pro-rata
56	OSW 14 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	80.00	4	80.00	Jan 23	pro-rata

57	Teamsware GmbH	Munich	Operating company	80.00	56	100.00	Mar 23	pro-rata
58	OSW 15 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	80.00	4	80.00	Mar 24	
59	Divera GmbH	Wuppertal	Operating company	80.00	58	100.00	Nov 24	
Indirect participations below CarMa Holding GmbH (No. 5)								
60	CarrierWerke GmbH	Walldorf	Operating company	80.00	5	100.00	Aug 21	✓
61	LUMi GmbH (vormals Interactive Network Communications GmbH)	Frankfurt	Operating company	80.00	5	100.00	Nov 21	✓
62	CarMa rental GmbH	Frankfurt	AssetCo *	80.00	5	100.00	Feb 22	✓
63	Ingenia Glasfaser GmbH	Kirchberg an der Jagst	Operating company	64.00	5	80.00	Sep 22	✓
64	CarMa networks GmbH	Frankfurt	AssetCo *	80.00	5	80.00	Apr 23	pro-rata
65	codewerke GmbH	Heubach	Operating company	80.00	5	100.00	Nov 23	pro-rata
66	Jobst NET GmbH	Amberg	Operating company	80.00	62	100.00	Aug 23	pro-rata
67	Glasfaser Direkt GmbH	Cologne	Operating company	80.00	62	100.00	Aug 23	
68	EIFEL-NET GmbH	Euskirchen	Operating company	80.00	62	100.00	Aug 23	
Indirect participations below mlog capital SAS (No. 6)								
69	GI Informatique Holding SAS	Le Bouscat, France	Acquisition company	68.00	6	85.00	Dec 23	pro-rata
70	GI Informatique SAS	Bouillargues, France	Operating company	68.00	67	100.00	Jan 24	
71	BG Informatique SAS	Metz, France	Operating company	68.00	67	100.00	May 24	
72	CSWIN Holding SAS	Le Bouscat, France	Acquisition company	64.00	6	80.00	Dec 23	pro-rata
73	CSWIN SAS	Plérin, France	Operating company	64.00	70	100.00	Jan 24	
74	ACM2J SAS	Plérin, France	Operating company	64.00	70	100.00	Jan 24	
75	MAJELIS Tutelle SAS	Vienne, France	Operating company	64.00	70	100.00	Apr 24	
76	Equinoxe Holding SAS	Le Bouscat, France	Acquisition company	48.00	6	60.00	Jun 24	
77	Equinoxe Software SAS	Gouvieux, France	Operating company	48.00	74	100.00	Jul 24	
78	Equinoxe Automative SAS	Gouvieux, France	Operating company	24.00	75	50.00	Jul 24	
79	3GWIN Holding SAS	Le Bouscat, France	Acquisition company	72.00	6	90.00	Sep 24	
80	3GWIN SAS	Nice, France	Operating company	72.00	77	100.00	Oct 24	
81	Technocarte Holding SAS	Le Bouscat, France	Acquisition company	73.60	6	92.00	Nov 24	
82	Technocarte Ingenierie SAS	Fos sur Mer, France	Acquisition company	73.60	79	100.00	Nov 24	
83	Technocarte SAS	Fos sur Mer, France	Operating company	73.60	80	100.00	Nov 24	
Indirect participations below Fintiba GmbH (No. 9)								
84	Coracle GmbH	Hamburg	Operating company	55.00	9	100.00	Dec 24	
85	Bostein Sol GmbH	Hamburg	Operating company	55.00	9	100.00	Dec 24	

Indirect participations below CHAPTERS Software Switzerland GmbH (No. 11)								
86	CHSS 1 CHAPTERS Beteiligungs GmbH	Zurich, Switzerland	Acquisition company	100.00	11	100.00	Oct 24	
87	Xplain Iberica S.L.	Madrid, Spain	Operating company	100.00	11	100.00	Oct 24	
88	Xplain AG	Interlaken, Switzerland	Operating company	100.00	11	100.00	Oct 24	
Indirect participations below Altamount Software GmbH (No. 12)								
89	Altamount Beteiligung 1 GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	87.50	12	100.00	Jun 24	
90	GBS Europa GmbH	Karlsruhe	Operating company	87.50	87	100.00	Jun 24	
91	Group BusBS (UK) Ltd.	Manchester, Great Britain	Operating company	87.50	88	100.00	Jun 24	
92	GBS Bulgaria EOOD	Sofia, Bulgaria	No longer operational	87.50	88	100.00	Jun 24	
93	GBS Solutions North America LLC	Delaware, USA	No longer operational	87.50	88	100.00	Jun 24	
94	Altamount Beteiligung 2 GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	87.50	12	100.00	Oct 24	
Indirect participations below Waterkant Software GmbH (No. 13)								
95	Waterkant Software 1 Beteiligungs GmbH	Hamburg	Acquisition company	80.00	13	100.00	Sep 24	
96	HUP GmbH	Brunswick	Operating company	80.00	93	100.00	Sep 24	
97	LEO Bytes GmbH (vormals Enervision Charge GmbH)	Brunswick	Operating company	80.00	93	100.00	Sep 24	
98	Waterkant Software 2 Beteiligungs GmbH	Hamburg	Acquisition company	80.00	13	100.00	Dec 24	
99	Waterkant Software 3 Beteiligungs GmbH	Hamburg	Acquisition company	80.00	13	100.00	Dec 24	
Footnotes to the table p. 94-97								
² As of December 2024, still operating under the names MEDIQON Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH, MEDIQON Beteiligungen Verwaltungs GmbH and MEDIQON Beteiligungen 1 GmbH & Co. KG.								
³ Neue Schule GmbH was merged with GfW Gesellschaft für Weiterbildung GmbH with effect from 01/01/ 2024.								
⁴ Effective January 1, 2024, OSW 2 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH, OSW 3 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH and OSW 9 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH were merged into OSW 11 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH.								
* Companies own and lease property, plant and equipment to other subsidiaries within the Group								
WAIVER OF INCLUSION								
In accordance with Section 296 (2) HGB, three companies were not included due to their minor significance for the consolidated financial statements.								
Tilia Software GmbH, based in Ilsfeld, is a 50% subsidiary of Voigt Software und Beratung AG that was not operational in the 2024 fiscal year. HUP Benelux B.V., based in AP Bergschenhoek, Netherlands, is a wholly owned subsidiary of HUP GmbH. HUP Benelux B.V. was not operational in the 2024 fiscal year.								
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ASSOCIATED COMPANIES

No.	Society	Head-quarters	Category	Shareholding CHAPTERS Group AG	Involved via no.	Share of direct parent company	Part of the group since	Inclusion in consolidated financial statements 2023
100	NPV Nachfolge Beteiligungen GmbH ⁵	Dorsten	Acquisition company	44.00	1	44.00	Jan 19	✓
101	MedNation AG	Bonn	Operating company	20.00	1	20.00	Nov 21 ⁶	✓
102	VEIL VariETY in Colours GmbH	Hamburg	Operating company	49.80	2	49.80	Aug 22	✓
103	TraFin Scout GmbH	Frankfurt am Main	Operating company	33.09	2	33.09	Aug 22 ⁷	✓
104	Global Heart Beteiligungs-gesellschaft mbH ⁸	Frankfurt am Main	Holding company	48.88	8	41.73	Aug 22	✓
105	Software Circle plc ⁹	Manchester, Great Britain	Participation platform	29.90	1	29.90	Mar 24	
106	rocom services GmbH ¹⁰	Riedering	Operating company	50.00	51	50.00	Dec 23	

CHANGES IN THE SCOPE OF CONSOLIDATION

In addition to the additions to the scope of consolidation shown in the overview of the scope of consolidation, CHAPTERS Group AG's indirect interest in the following companies was reduced in the 2024 fiscal year:

- ⁵ NPV Nachfolge Beteiligungen GmbH holds 100% of the shares in E-M-C direct GmbH & Co KG and its general partner, NVP Elektroinstallationen Handel GmbH.
- ⁶ CHAPTERS Group AG has held shares in MedNation AG (formerly Eifelhöhen-Klinik AG) since August 2020 . The figure of 20% was exceeded for the first time in November 2021.
- ⁷ CHAPTERS Group AG has held shares in TraFin Scout GmbH since April 2022. The value of 20% was exceeded for the first time in August 2022.
- ⁸ The shares in Global Heart Beteiligungsgesellschaft mbH were increased from 41.73% to 48.88% in the 2024 fiscal year.
- ⁹ CHAPTERS Group AG has held shares in Manchester-based Software Circle plc (ISIN GB0009638130) since September 2002. The figure of 20 % was exceeded for the first time in March 2024.
- ¹⁰ CHAPTERS Group AG has held 50% of the shares in rocom services GmbH via rocom GmbH since December 2023. In accordance with Section 296 (2) HGB, the company was not included in the consolidated financial statements for the 2023 fiscal year.

No.	Society	Head-quarters	Category	Shareholding CHAPTERS Group AG 2024	Shareholding CHAPTERS Group AG 2023	Involved via no.
20	NGC CNC Beteiligungen GmbH	Alfdorf	Acquisition company	68.00	72.00	3
21	Direkt CNC-Systeme GmbH	Alfdorf	Operating company	68.00	72.00	20

CHAPTERS Group AG's indirect interest in the following companies increased in the 2024 fiscal year:

No.	Society	Head-quarters	Category	Shareholding CHAPTERS Group AG 2024	Shareholding CHAPTERS Group AG 2023	Involved via no.
4	Ookam Software GmbH	Berlin	Participation platform	100.00	80.00	1
23	OSW Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition platform	90.00	72.00	4
24	Parity Software GmbH	Eberdingen-Hochdorf	Operating company	90.00	72.00	23
25	GAIN Software GmbH	Schönbrunn i. Stgw.	Operating company	90.00	72.00	23
27	Gripware datentechnik gmbh	Hemshofen	Operating company	100.00	80.00	49
28	SWH Softwarehaus Heider GmbH	Bad Abbach	Operating company	100.00	80.00	49
29	Software und Beratung Meinhardt GmbH	Eschwege	Operating company	91.00	72.80	49
30	OSW 4 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	99.00	79.20	4
31	BleTec Software GmbH	Roßdorf	Operating company	99.00	79.20	30
32	OPAS Software GmbH	Strullendorf	Operating company	100.00	80.00	49
33	OSW 6 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	90.00	72.00	4
34	DATEX Software GmbH	Karlsruhe	Operating company	90.00	72.00	4
35	OSW 7 WAREHaus GmbH	Solingen	Operating company	90.00	72.00	4
36	Software24.com GmbH	St. Stephen's Churches	Operating company	90.00	72.00	35
37	WAREHaus GmbH	Solingen	Operating company	90.00	72.00	36
38	MWM Software & Beratung GmbH	Bonn	Operating company	81.00	64.80	35
39	Key Logic GmbH	Eschborn	Operating company	90.00	72.00	35
40	Littera Software & Consulting AT GmbH	Hall in Tirol, Austria	Operating company	90.00	72.00	35
41	Littera Software & Consulting GmbH	Munich	Operating company	90.00	72.00	40
44	OSW 8 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	90.00	64.00	4
45	Corporate Montage Europe GmbH	Wiesbaden	Operating company	90.00	64.00	44
46	Elkom Solutions GmbH	Tuttlingen	Operating company	100.00	80.00	49
47	OSW 10 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	90.00	72.00	4
48	Voigt Software und Beratung AG	Ilfeld	Operating company	90.00	72.00	47
49	OSW 11 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	100.00	80.00	4

50	Condition Integrierte Softwarelösungen GmbH	Goettingen	Operating company	100.00	80.00	49
51	rocom GmbH	Riedering	Operating company	100.00	80.00	49
52	OSW 12 AT Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Vienna, Austria	Acquisition company	100.00	80.00	4
53	Solarys Software GmbH	Vienna, Austria	Operating company	100.00	80.00	52
54	Utilities Systems s.r.o.	Prague, Czech Republic	Operating company	100.00	80.00	4
55	Usys Slovakia s.r.o.	Basnká Bystrica, Slovak Republic	Operating company	100.00	80.00	54
56	OSW 14 Ookam Beteiligungs GmbH	Berlin	Acquisition company	80.00	64.00	4
57	Teamsware GmbH	Munich	Operating company	80.00	64.00	56

In the 2024 fiscal year, the following companies were also deconsolidated:

Society	Head-quarters	Category	Shareholding CHAPTERS Group AG	Direct parent company	Share of direct parent company	Part of the group until
Indirect investments below NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH (No. 3)						
ENTRO Invest GmbH	Munich	Acquisition company	52.00	NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH	65.00	Sep 24
ENTRO Service GmbH	Munich	Acquisition company	45.86	ENTRO Invest GmbH	88.20	Sep 24
ENTRO Süd GmbH	Munich	Acquisition company	45.86	ENTRO Service GmbH	100.00	Sep 24
Wassermann GmbH	Nuremberg	Operating company	45.86	ENTRO Süd GmbH	100.00	Sep 24
Torpado GmbH	Dortmund	Operating company	45.86	ENTRO Service GmbH	100.00	Sep 24
Gebr. Kuttner GmbH	Quickborn	Operating company	45.86	ENTRO Service GmbH	100.00	Sep 24
ITS Industrie Tore Service GmbH	Krefeld	Operating company	45.86	ENTRO Service GmbH	100.00	Sep 24
KHT Industriepartner GmbH & Co. KG	Hamburg	Operating company	45.86	ENTRO Service GmbH	100.00	Sep 24
KHT Industriepartner Verwaltungs GmbH	Hamburg	Verwaltungs GmbH	45.86	ENTRO Service GmbH	100.00	Sep 24

In accordance with Section 296 (1) no. 2 HGB, Glasfaser Direkt GmbH, based in Cologne, and EIFEL-NET GmbH, based in Euskirchen, were not consolidated in the 2023 fiscal year. Both com-

panies were consolidated for the first time on January 1, 2024. The shares in Glasfaser Direkt GmbH were acquired in August 2023. A pro rata net loss of EUR 260.90 thousand for 4 months is at-

tributable to the period of affiliation with the Group in the 2023 fiscal year. This resulted primarily from personnel expenses of EUR 175.63 thousand and other operating expenses of EUR 82.86 thousand. Fixed assets mainly included advance payments for assets under construction of EUR 3,000.00 thousand. The carrying amount of the advance payments in the separate financial statements of Glasfaser Direkt GmbH was unchanged at the time of initial consolidation. In the course of the purchase price allocation, the advance payment was revalued at EUR 750.00 thousand and is included with that amount in the consolidated financial statements for the fiscal year 2024. Receivables from affiliated companies of EUR 664.42 thousand were not eliminated in the 2023 fiscal year but recognized as other liabilities in the consolidated financial statements for the 2023 fiscal year. There were also trade receivables of EUR 166.94 thousand and trade payables of EUR 423.47 thousand on the consolidated reporting date of December 31, 2023. The initial consolidation resulted in a negative goodwill of EUR 2,265.03 thousand and deferred tax assets of EUR 675.00 thousand.

The shares in EIFEL-NET GmbH were acquired in August 2023. A net loss of EUR 506.22 thousand is attributable to the 4-month period of affiliation with the Group in the 2023 fiscal year. This resulted primarily from losses from the disposal of fixed assets of EUR 332.51 thousand and other operating

expenses of EUR 450.16 thousand, other operating expenses of EUR 450.16 thousand and cost of materials of EUR 60.32 thousand as well as depreciation of fixed assets of EUR 53.84 thousand. Revenues of EUR 61.27 thousand and income from the reversal of provisions and special items of EUR 378.04 thousand are attributable to the period. The fixed assets mainly included the fibre optic network with a carrying amount of EUR 2,579.76. The carrying amount of the fiber optic network was unchanged at the time of initial consolidation and was revalued at EUR 281.25 thousand in the course of the purchase price allocation and is included with that amount in the consolidated financial statements for the 2024 fiscal year. On the consolidated reporting date of December 31, 2023, there were trade receivables of EUR 1,798.92 thousand, other provisions of EUR 474.07 thousand and trade payables of EUR 69.00 thousand.

There are also liabilities to affiliated companies of EUR 595.65 thousand which were not eliminated in the 2023 fiscal year but recognized as other assets in the consolidated financial statements for the 2023 fiscal year. The initial consolidation resulted in a debit difference of EUR 430.66 thousand and deferred tax assets of EUR 669.88 thousand.

CAPITAL CONSOLIDATION

Capital consolidation for companies acquired or founded directly or indirectly by CHAPTERS Group AG from third parties is carried out using the purchase method in accordance with Section 301 HGB. The carrying amount at the direct parent company of the acquired and founded company is offset against the amount of the revalued equity of the subsidiary attributable to these shares. Under the revaluation method used, the assets, liabilities, prepaid expenses, deferred income and special items to be included are recognized at their fair value at the time of initial inclusion in the consolidated financial statements (which, with the exception of Fintiba GmbH, EIFEL-NET GmbH and Glasfaser Direkt GmbH, corresponds to the time of acquisition). A purchase price allocation was performed by CHAPTERS Group AG (with the support of Baker Tilly GmbH & Co. KG Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft) for the revaluation of equity. The revalued assets resulting from the purchase price allocation are recognized for the consolidated financial statements at the level of the respective subsidiary acquired and amortized there.

Any positive difference between the carrying amount at the direct parent company and the revalued equity of the subsidiaries as part of the purchase price allocation is capitalized as goodwill for the consolidated financial statements at the level of the direct parent company and amortized there.

Any negative difference between the carrying amount at the direct parent company and the revalued equity of the subsidiaries as part of the purchase price allocation is recognized as difference from capital consolidation on for the consolidated financial statements at the level of the direct parent company and reported there as an item after equity. The difference from capital consolidation on is released over the weighted average remaining useful life of the acquired depreciable assets. If the acquired assets consist largely of non-depreciable assets, the treatment of the difference from capital consolidation on is based on the consumption or disposal of the non-depreciable assets. In this case, the difference is released to the income statement to the extent that the non-depreciable assets are depreciated or recognized as a disposal, e.g. due to a sale.

In accordance with Section 301 (2) HGB, valuation takes place at the time of acquisition of the respective subsidiary. If no interim financial statements are prepared at the time of acquisition for transactions that took place during the year, these are derived using the pro rata temporis method. Subsidiaries acquired in the 2024 fiscal year are only included in the consolidated income statement on a pro rata basis with the results generated since the acquisition date.

In the case of a successive acquisition of shares, the date of initial capital consolidation and thus also the date of the change from at-equity to full consolidation is the date on which CHAPTERS Group AG gained control and the parent-subsidiary relationship was established.

NON-CONTROLLING INTERESTS

In the group structure of CHAPTERS Group AG, minority shareholders are involved in the subsidiaries at several levels. In accordance with Section 307 HGB, a balancing item for the equity attributable to non-controlling interest is recognized. In the consolidated income statement, the profit and loss attributable to non-controlling interests (including the results from capital consolidation attributable to them and the resulting depreciation and amortization) are reported separately and the balancing item in equity is updated accordingly.

CONSOLIDATION OF LIABILITIES, EXPENSES AND INCOME, ELIMINATION OF INTERCOMPANY PROFITS AND LOSSES

Receivables and liabilities, revenue as well as expenses and income within the scope of consolidation were eliminated. In particular, this includes existing (shareholder) loans within the scope of consolidation as well as interest charged on them. There were no significant interim results from business transactions between consolidated companies.

FOREIGN CURRENCY TRANSLATION

In accordance with Section 308a HGB, the modified closing rate method is used to translate the financial statements of subsidiaries whose currency is not the euro. Assets and liabilities are generally translated at the mean spot exchange rate on the reporting date. Expenses and income are translated into euros at the average exchange rate. Equity items are translated at the historical exchange rates applicable at the time of initial consolidation. The balance sheet currency translation differences are recognized directly in equity after the reserves under the item "Currency difference from revaluation" until the foreign business operation is sold.

SHARES IN ASSOCIATED COMPANIES

Shares in associated companies are accounted for using the at-equity method and are recognized at acquisition cost, increased or decreased by the changes in equity of the associated company since acquisition. If the associated company prepares consolidated financial statements, these are used as a basis, otherwise the individual financial statements are used. No adjustments are made to accounting policies in the relevant financial statements of associated companies that differ from those used in the consolidated financial statements. For the result of changes in equity of associated companies, the respective annual result after taxes is taken into account. Profit distributions received are deducted. If the acquisition costs at the time of acquisition differ from the proportionate equity acquired, the goodwill or negative difference is amortized or released in an ancillary calculation over ten years and is included in the result from associated companies. If the cumulative loss of the respective company since the investment by CHAPTERS Group AG exceeds the carrying amount of the investment, the shares are recognized at a value of EUR 1.00 until recovery via the relevant company's net income.

C. Summary of accounting methods

The consolidated financial statements of the CHAPTERS Group AG Group are prepared on the basis of the individual financial statements of the fully consolidated subsidiaries included in the Group and the associated companies accounted for using the at-equity method. If the associated company prepares consolidated financial statements, these are used as a basis. No consolidated financial statements are prepared by the fully consolidated subsidiaries. For subsidiaries that are not domiciled in Germany, significant differences between local accounting standards and the German Commercial Code (HGB) are eliminated.

Permissible accounting policy options are exercised uniformly in the consolidated financial statements irrespective of whether or how such options are exercised in the individual annual financial statements of the companies included in the consolidated financial statements in accordance with Section 308 HGB.

INTANGIBLE ASSETS

At the level of the fully consolidated subsidiaries included in the consolidated financial statements, **intangible assets acquired** are recognized at their acquisition cost and amortized on a straight-line basis over their useful life (3 to 10 years). This mainly relates to purchased licenses and the externally commissioned (further) development of software products. Software developed by the companies themselves is not capitalized in the consolidated financial statements.

As part of the **purchase price allocation**, the intangible assets of the fully consolidated subsidiaries acquired are identified and revalued. This relates in particular to the respective brand and the software products of the fully consolidated

subsidiaries. The valuation is based on the relief from royalty method.. The identified intangible assets are amortized on a straight-line basis over the customary useful life of 15 years for the brand and 3 to 7 years for the software. The other intangible assets identified as part of the purchase price allocation include a favorable rental agreement, which is valued on the basis of the difference to the standard market rent and the remaining term of the rental agreement and is amortized on a straight-line basis over ten years.

Goodwill represents the represents the remaining difference between the acquisition costs and the fair value of the revalued net assets of the acquired company attributable to the group at the time of acquisition. The goodwill reflects the long-term business relationships as well as the good operating profitability of the operating companies. Identified goodwill is amortized on a straight-line basis over 10 years.

On December 31, 2024, there were no indications of a probable permanent impairment and therefore no need for impairment of intangible assets.

PROPERTY, PLANT AND EQUIPMENT

The **operating properties** reported under property, plant and equipment are carried at cost less accumulated straight-line depreciation. The amortization period is between 30 and 50 years. As part of the purchase price allocation, hidden reserves of EUR 316.00 thousand were already identified in the 2021 fiscal year on the basis of a market value appraisal. The hidden reserves are amortized on a straight-line basis over the expected remaining useful life of 22 years.

Property, plant and equipment are recognized at acquisition costs less accumulated depreciation and any impairment losses. Scheduled depreciation is generally calculated using the straight-line method over the expected useful life of the asset. The expected useful life is predominantly 8 to 10 years. In the 2023 fiscal year, CarMa Holding GmbH acquired 100% of the shares in Jobst Net GmbH. The company provides Internet services and has fiber optic lines that connect cable branches with fiber optics to the local distribution nodes. The amortization period for these assets is 20 years.

Other equipment, operating and office equipment are reported at acquisition costs less accumulated depreciation and any impairment losses. Scheduled depreciation is generally calculated using the straight-line method over the expected useful life of the asset. The expected useful life is 3 to 10 years.

Low-value assets with individual acquisition values of up to EUR 250.00 are treated as immediately deductible operating expenses. Assets with acquisition or production costs of more than EUR 250.00 and up to EUR 800.00 are usually written off in full in the year of acquisition or production.

FINANCIAL ASSETS

Loans to associated companies are generally valued at nominal value or acquisition cost. On December 31, 2024, there were no indications of a probable permanent impairment and therefore no need for impairment.

Other investments in companies and **shares in affiliated companies** (if not consolidated) are recognized at cost.

Securities are recognized as fixed assets. Securities are valued individually upon addition and in accordance with the acquisition cost principle. The acquisition costs correspond to the purchase price paid when the shares were acquired plus any transaction fees incurred. If the securities are denominated in foreign currencies, they are translated at the mean spot exchange rate on December 31, 2024, in accordance with Section 256a HGB. Securities are generally held as medium-term capital investments. In accordance with the lower of cost or market principle under commercial law (Section 253 (3) sentence 5 HGB), equity investments are recognized with the lower of cost or market value on December 31, 2024. Appreciation is recognized if it is expected that the fair value is likely to be permanently above the book value recognized on the relevant reporting date before appreciation. The acquisition costs correspond to the purchase price paid when the shares were acquired plus any transaction fees incurred. Bond investments are valued at the lower of acquisition cost and nominal value. On December 31, 2024, there were no indications of a probable permanent impairment and therefore no need for impairment.

CURRENT ASSETS

Raw materials and supplies are valued at average cost. If lower replacement prices are available, these are recognized in accordance with the strict lower of cost or market principle.

Work in progress are valued at cost, taking into account the stage of completion.

Finished goods and merchandise include the hidden reserves from the order backlog identified as part of the purchase price allocation. If customer contracts (usually maintenance contracts

for software) exist at the time of acquisition that require the payment of fees, the income resulting from these contracts until the next possible termination date is valued and capitalized. The order backlog identified in this way is amortized over the remaining term of the contracts. There were no indications of impairment and the resulting need for write-downs on December 31, 2024.

Receivables and other assets are measured at nominal value or acquisition cost and, if necessary, less impairments for individual risks.

Bank balances and cash in hand are recognized at nominal value.

PROVISIONS

Provisions take into account all identifiable future obligations at the time the balance sheet is prepared and are recognized at the amount required to settle the obligation based on prudent business judgment, taking into account future price and cost increases. Provisions with a remaining term of more than one year are discounted at the average market interest rate corresponding to their remaining term. For the recognition of provisions for share-based compensation, an option valuation according to Black-Scholes is carried out.

LIABILITIES

Liabilities (with the exception of the perpetual bond) are recognized at the settlement amounts. The perpetual bond is recognized at its nominal amount. The bond conditions allow for early repayment at a lower amount; the relevant difference between the nominal amount and the repayment value in accordance with the bond conditions on the reporting date is recognized in prepaid expenses.

Subsequent purchase price payments in connection with the acquisition of new companies are reported in the consolidated financial statements as

seller loans under other liabilities. If the payment is linked to the achievement of certain operating targets ("earn-out payments"), these are recognized under liabilities if it can be assumed that the targets will be achieved and thus the payment of the additional purchase price elements can be assumed at the time the consolidated financial statements are prepared.

ACCRUED ITEMS AND DEFERRED INCOME

Accrued and deferred items were created for expenses or income before the balance sheet date if they represent expenses or income for a certain period after the balance sheet date.

DEFERRED TAXES

Deferred tax liabilities are recognized in connection with the purchase price allocation and the (temporary) difference between the carrying amounts in the tax balance sheet of the respective individual company and the carrying amounts in the HGB consolidated financial statements. Deferred tax assets are recognized in connection with negative differences between the carrying amounts of assets in the HGB consolidated financial statements and the respective separate financial statements.

Deferred taxes are reversed in line with the amortization of the assets resulting from the purchase price allocation or in line with the reversal of the negative differences between the carrying amount in the HGB consolidated financial statements and at the level of the individual company. For companies based in Germany, an average combined tax rate of 30% for all companies is used for simplification purposes; for companies based outside Germany, the local tax rate at the time of acquisition of the shares is used. There is no offsetting in accordance with section 306 sentence 2 HGB.

D. Notes to the consolidated balance sheet

FIXED ASSETS

The development of the individual fixed asset items and depreciation and amortization in the Group during the fiscal year can be found in the consolidated statement of changes in fixed assets attached to the notes to the consolidated financial statements.

Shares in associated companies are recognized at amortized value for the amortized value, the acquisition costs are increased or reduced by the proportionate annual result attributable to CHAPTERS Group AG (or its direct subsidiaries) and the amortization of goodwill or the release of a negative difference. If the cumulative loss of the respective company since the investment by CHAPTERS Group AG exceeds the carrying amount of the investment, the shares are recognized at a value of EUR 1.00 until recovery via the relevant company's current income. The difference between the amortized value (if negative) and the carrying amount is EUR 452.69 thousand (previous year: EUR 323.69 thousand). If the offsetting of acquisition costs

against the share in the equity of the respective company results in goodwill or negative difference I (if the acquisition costs are lower than the company's equity at the time of acquisition), this is amortized or released to income on a straight-line basis over 10 years from the time of acquisition. Amortization of goodwill arising in previous years in connection with associates amounts to a cumulative EUR 735.80 thousand, thereof EUR 604.93 thousand in the 2024 fiscal year. On 12/31/2024, the remaining goodwill amounts to EUR 7,123.60 thousand (previous year: EUR 487.98 thousand) thereof EUR 6,697.51 thousand is attributable to the investment in Software Circle plc acquired in the first half of 2024. The negative difference was first recognized in the 2021 fiscal year and amounts to EUR 132.92 thousand after reversal in the fiscal year ended December 31, 2024 (previous year: EUR 458.13 thousand).

The **goodwill** identified as part of the purchase price allocation developed as follows in the 2024 fiscal year (figures in EUR thousand):

	Opening balance on 01/01/2024	Additions in the fiscal year (incl. changes in the scope of consolidation)	Disposals in the fiscal year // Transfers // Currency differences	Depreciation and amortization in the fiscal year	Ending balance on 12/31/2024
From purchase price allocation	99,678.08	99,368.87	-10,496.10	-14,105.38	174,445.47
From individual financial statements	183.15	0.00	1,181.15	-299.35	1,064.95
Total	99,861.23	99,368.87	-9,314.95	-14,404.73	175,510.42

¹¹ This relates to the investment in two companies by CarMa Holding GmbH in the 2023 fiscal year. The necessary financial statements of the individual companies were not yet available for the companies at the time the 2023 consolidated financial statements were prepared, so they were not included in accordance with Section 296 (1) no. 2 HGB.

The companies included in **shares in affiliated companies (non-consolidated)**¹¹ amounting to EUR 1,217.63 thousand in the 2023 consolidated financial statements were consolidated in the 2024 fiscal year.

The Group's property, plant and equipment increased by EUR 3,583.84 thousand to EUR 10,658.45 thousand in the fiscal year. Around 64% of the increase resulted from investments by a subsidiary of CarMa Holding. In the 2023 fiscal year, CarMa Holding acquired the Glasfaser-Direkt Group, including a partially completed fiber-to-the-home telecommunications network, which is now being completed by the CarMa Group. The first-time consolidation of the two companies of the Glasfaser-Direkt Group acquired in the 2023 fiscal year accounted for an additional 16% of the increase. In total, c. 80% of the increase hence is attributable to companies belonging to the CarMa-Group.

Opening balance on 01/01/2024	Additions in the fiscal year	Disposals in the fiscal year	Reversals in the fiscal year	Ending balance on 12/31/2024
1,897.14	2,853.59	-0.17	-2,022.25	2,728.31

FINISHED GOODS AND MERCHANDISE FROM PURCHASE PRICE ALLOCATION

The order backlog identified as part of the purchase price allocation developed as follows in the 2024 fiscal year (figures in EUR thousand):

RECEIVABLES AND OTHER ASSETS

Trade receivables of EUR 10,342.08 thousand (previous year: EUR 7,697.56 thousand) are present for operating companies included in the consolidated financial statements. EUR 3,497.64 thousand are attributable to the acquisition of further subsidiaries. A reduction by EUR 1,505.19 thousand in trade receivables from the previous year is attributable to the deconsolidation of subsidiaries. Receivables amounting to EUR 652.07 thousand were accumulated at the companies included in the consolidated financial statements for the 2023 and 2024 fiscal years.

Receivables from associated companies of EUR 332.02 thousand (previous year: EUR 241.91 thousand) relate to loan receivables from companies in which CHAPTERS group owns a minority interests. The amount is attributable in full to retained interest on shareholder loans issued to subsidiaries. The interest accrued on the shareholder loans can be retained or paid at the subsidiaries' discretion. In principle, the payment of interest by the subsid-

iaries is planned. Interest receivables are therefore also reported under current assets.

CASH AT BANKS AND CASH IN HAND

Cash and cash equivalents amounting to EUR 58,507.77 thousand (previous year: EUR 50,843.20 thousand) are predominantly balances at banks. EUR 23.51 thousand (previous year: EUR 154.78 thousand) includes cash on hand. EUR 26,490.11 thousand (previous year: EUR 26,953.03 thousand) is attributable to the cash and cash equivalents of CHAPTERS Group AG as the parent company; the cash and cash equivalents at subsidiary level amount to EUR 32,017.66 thousand (previous year: EUR 23,890.17 thousand). Cash pooling does not take place. A detailed analysis of the changes in cash and cash equivalents can be found in the consolidated cash flow statement. The amount of cash and cash equivalents attributable to the cash and bank balances of acquired companies amounted to EUR 8,662.87 thousand. The change due to the disposal of companies that were part of the 2023 consolidated group amounted to a total of EUR -996.46 thousand.

ACCRUED ITEMS AND DEFERRED INCOME

Deferred income is recognized for the operating subsidiary in connection with payments already received in the 2024 fiscal year for contracts with a contract term beyond the reporting date and amounts to EUR 10,182.92 thousand (previous year: EUR 4,077.31 thousand). An amount of EUR 3,900.93 thousand of the increase is attributable to the addition of companies to the scope of

consolidation. Prepaid expenses amount to EUR 1,808.44 thousand (previous year: EUR 3,533.03 thousand) of which EUR 528.39 thousand (previous year: EUR 2,818.31 thousand) is recognized for interest expenses expected at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG as the parent company due to the reversal of the discount for the perpetual bond issued in June 2020.

EQUITY

The detailed changes in equity are shown in the consolidated statement of changes in equity.

The **subscribed capital** of CHAPTERS Group AG amounted to EUR 22,986.03 thousand on the reporting date (previous year: EUR 18,149.19 thousand) and is divided into 22,986,027 (previous year: 18,149,192) bearer shares. The share capital was increased by EUR 1,398.51 thousand upon registration on March 6, 2024. As a result, the **capital reserve** was increased by EUR 23,229.31 thousand. A second increase in share capital of EUR 3,438.32 thousand took place upon registration on August 23, 2024. As a result, the capital reserve was increased by a further EUR 81,488.23 thousand to EUR 229,909.73 thousand on December 31, 2024 (previous year: EUR 125,192.19 thousand). In the previous year, minority shareholders made payments of EUR 152.56 thousand into the capital reserves of fully consolidated subsidiaries, some thereof were allocated to the Group for consolidation reasons. The subsidiaries were deconsolidated in 2024. As a result, the amount of EUR 152.56 thousand paid in the previous year has been deducted.

On 29 June 2023, the Annual General Meeting resolved to increase the company's share capital once or several times from EUR 16,066.60 thousand by up to EUR 8,033.30 thousand to up to EUR 24,099.90 thousand (Authorized Capital 2023/I). After partial utilization, the authorized capital on 31 December 2023 amounts to EUR 4,984.86 thousand.

On 9 July 2024, the Annual General Meeting resolved to increase the company's share capital once or several times by a maximum nominal amount of EUR 4,788.99 thousand (Authorized Capital 2024/I). After partial use in July 2024, the authorized capital on 31 December 2024 amounts to EUR 1,350.67 thousand.

PROVISIONS

The provisions of EUR 19,203.59 thousand are recognized in the income statement. (previous year: EUR 10,385.66 thousand) are made up as follows:

Provisions	12/31/2024 in EUR '000	Previous year in EUR '000
Tax provisions	7,028.76	4,119.43
Other provisions	12,174.83	6,266.23
thereof for annual accounts and audit	699.36	458.35
thereof for personnel expenses (excluding share-based compensation)	1,302.96	530.88
thereof for share-based compensation at CHAPTERS Group AG level	3,655.57	876.50
thereof vacation provisions	1,240.99	267.88
thereof for warranty	84.34	158.23
thereof for potential additional purchase price payments (earn-outs)	2,285.00	2,485.00

Tax provisions increased by EUR 2,909.33 thousand year-over-year. Of this amount, EUR 1,929.41 thousand is attributable to companies that became part of the Group in the 2024 fiscal year. The deconsolidation resulted in a disposal of EUR 143.87 thousand.

The increase of EUR 2,696.21 thousand in other provisions is attributable to the growth of the Group. The effects of deconsolidation account for EUR 502.55 thousand.

In the 2023 fiscal year, the supervisory board of the shareholder established a share option plan ("Virtual Share Option Plan", "VSOP") for the company's Management Board. The share option plan was adopted for key employees in the company in the 2024 fiscal year. Further information on the options can be found under "Remuneration of the executive bodies". The share options are valued according to Black Scholes.

	Management board	Key employees
Options granted thereof vested on 12/31/2024	1,000,000 500,000	227,500 48,230
Earliest exercise date	12/31/2026	12/31/2027-02/28/2028
Strike Price	22.27	26.03-27.30
Option value per option on 12/31/2024	6.70	5.91-6.40

LIABILITIES

Liabilities totaling EUR 86,741.35 thousand (previous year: EUR 80,301.36 thousand) include EUR 16,000.00 thousand (previous year: EUR 16,000.00 thousand) (previous year: EUR 25,000.00 thousand) for the **perpetual bond** issued by CHAPTERS Group AG in May 2020. The nominal value of the bond is EUR 25 million. No final maturity date has been agreed and no liens or similar rights have been created. The interest rate is 7%, with May 28, 2026 agreed as the first interest payment date. The issue discount of 35% is recognized under pre-paid expenses and will be released to income pro rata temporis in accordance with the terms of the bond. In April 2024, the company acquired a nominal amount of EUR 9.0 million at a price of 91.07% of the nominal amount as part of a voluntary buyback offer. In March 2025, the company announced the full repayment of the bond on May 28, 2025. Thus, the shares in the bond held by the company itself are be netted - unlike in previous years - resulting in an amount of EUR 16,000.00 thousand (previous year: EUR 25,000.00 thousand) is reported under liabilities.

Liabilities to banks mainly relate to acquisition loans taken out to finance the acquisition of the operating subsidiaries. This financing is raised at the level of the acquisition companies or the operating companies themselves. If the financing was raised at the level of the acquisition company, it is usually secured by the acquisition company pledging the shares in the operating company or a guarantee from the operating company in favor of the financing bank. The amount secured by pledging shares amounts to EUR 7.22 million (pre-

vious year: EUR 8.81 million). For an amount of EUR 0.00 million (previous year: EUR 0.99 million), land charges were provided as collateral. There is no joint liability on the part of other Group companies or CHAPTERS Group AG ("ring-fencing"). In some cases, interest rate hedges were concluded for the loans. The funds will be used to partially repay the shareholder loans provided by CHAPTERS Group AG as the parent company of the Group for the acquisition.

Bank liabilities were reduced by EUR 3.03 million due to the disposal of consolidated companies – in relation to the acquisition of new companies, existing bank financing of EUR 1.82 million was assumed. Repayments on bank loans were made for a total amount of EUR 6.13 million.

Trade payables of EUR 4,338.08 thousand (previous year: EUR 3,064.81 thousand) mainly include liabilities for purchased services at the level of the operating subsidiaries. Year-over-year, trade payables increased by EUR 1,273.27 thousand. Of this amount, EUR 2,013.57 thousand is attributable to the growth of the Group through the acquisition of further subsidiaries. EUR 734.28 thousand in trade payables from the previous year were disposed of as part of the deconsolidation of subsidiaries.

Other liabilities include **seller loans** of EUR 14,246.38 thousand (previous year: EUR 14,922.70 thousand) resulting from the deferral of purchase prices as part of the acquisition of operating companies by the sellers.

Also included are **liabilities to minority shareholders** of EUR 2,797.54 thousand (previous year: EUR 3,259.50 thousand). The shareholder loans of minority shareholders are granted at the same conditions as the shareholder loans of CHAPTERS Group AG. Disposals of consolidated companies resulted in a decrease of EUR 0.98 million.

The maturities of the liabilities are shown in the following schedule of liabilities:

		Total in EUR '000	Up to 1 year in EUR '000	From 1 to 5 years in EUR '000	More than 5 years in EUR '000
Bond	31.12.2024 31.12.2023	16,000.00 25,000.00			16,000.00 25,000.00
Liabilities to banks	31.12.2024 31.12.2023	43,351.25 29,426.02	6,620.90 7,116.09	33,347.13 21,791.41	3,383.21 518.52
Advance payments received on orders	31.12.2024 31.12.2023	162.26 364.51	162.26 364.51		
Trade payables	31.12.2024 31.12.2023	4,338.08 3,064.81	4,338.08 3,064.81		
Other liabilities	31.12.2024 31.12.2023	22,889.77 22,446.02	14,826.05 18,522.09	5,266.19	2,797.54 3,923.93
thereof from seller loans	31.12.2024	14,246.38	8,980.19	5,266.19	
thereof to minority shareholders	31.12.2024	2,797.54			2,797.54
thereof from taxes	31.12.2024	2,278.31	2,278.31		
thereof for social security	31.12.2024	301.90	301.90		
Liabilities	31.12.2024 31.12.2023	86,741.35 80,301.36	25,947.29 29,067.50	38,613.31 21,791.41	22,180.75 29,442.45

DEFERRED TAXES

The recognized deferred tax liabilities result from the purchase price allocation in the course of preparing the consolidated financial statements and developed as follows in the fiscal year:

Opening balance on 01/01/2024 in EUR '000	Additions in the fiscal year in EUR '000	Reversals in the fiscal year / exchange rate related differences in EUR '000	Ending balance on 12/31/2024 in EUR '000
5,102.61	5,329.06	-1,574.03 -4.63	8,853.00

Deferred tax assets of EUR 1,485.70 (previous year: EUR 237.75 thousand) are due to EUR 125.13 thousand (previous year: EUR 190.89 thousand) of internally generated intangible assets capitalized in the individual financial statements of a subsidiary, which

are depreciated for tax purposes in accordance with local regulations. Internally generated intangible assets are not capitalized in the HGB consolidated financial statements. EUR 1,360.56 thousand (previous year: EUR 46.85 thousand) of deferred tax assets result from a lower valuation of property, plant and equipment as part of the purchase price allocation compared to the valuation in the individual financial statements of the relevant company.

CONTINGENT LIABILITIES

On December 31, 2024, contingent liabilities of EUR 838.90 thousand (previous year: EUR 136.53 thousand) are due to the assumption of maximum amount guarantees for leasing and supplier contracts of a subsidiary. Based on the business development of the subsidiary, no claims are expected.



E. Notes to the consolidated income statement

REVENUE

The Group's revenue totaling EUR 110,673.47 thousand (previous year: EUR 70,766.28 thousand) consists of EUR 31,580.30 thousand is attributable to the segment Public (previous year: EUR 14,329.87 thousand), EUR 33,512.34 thousand to the segment Enterprise (previous year: EUR 20,729.00 thousand), EUR 14,907.63 thousand to the segment Financial Technologies (previous year: EUR 0.00 thousand) and EUR 30,548.90 thousand to the segment Other (previous year: EUR 35,532.38 thousand). Revenue from holding companies (if not eliminated in the consolidation) of EUR 124.30 thousand (previous year: EUR 175.03 thousand) is included.

The segmentation of revenue was changed compared to the previous year. A reconciliation between the presentation in the previous year and the current year can be found in the combined management report.

Revenue is mainly generated from the sale of services and software licenses and the associated maintenance contracts. The majority of revenue is generated in Germany, while around 15.1% of revenue is generated in other European countries.

Revenue of EUR 92,343.76 thousand was generated by companies that were already consolidated in the 2023 fiscal year, thereof EUR 12,560.09 thousand is attributable to companies that were deconsolidated in the 2024 fiscal year and were only included in the consolidated financial statements with their results up to the deconsolidation date in September. Excluding these companies, revenue from consolidated companies in both years amounted to EUR 79,783.68 thousand (previous year: EUR 70,824.57 thousand). Companies included in the consolidated financial statements for the first time in the 2024 fiscal year generated revenue of EUR 18,329.71 thousand.

OTHER OPERATING INCOME

Other operating income breaks down as follows:

	2024 in EUR '000	Previous year in EUR '000
Ordinary operating income	1,413.93	952.03
Income from the disposal of and write-ups to non-current assets	6,469.02	6,386.43
Income from the reversal of provisions	128.03	133.88
Income relating to other periods	370.95	72.00
Income from currency translation	22.91	14.60
Other operating income	8,404.84	7,558.93

Ordinary operating income includes EUR 470.45 thousand (previous year EUR 278.77 thousand) of income from offsetting benefits in kind.

Operating income of EUR 224.44 thousand is attributable to companies that were newly consolidated in the 2024 fiscal year. Income of EUR 754.87 thousand is attributable to companies that were included in the consolidated financial statements for their full fiscal year in both fiscal years. The previous year's figure for these companies amounted to EUR 490.64 thousand. EUR 273.94 thousand relates to companies that were only included in the Group on a pro rata basis in the previous year with an amount of EUR 91.62 thousand. The ENTRO Group, which was deconsolidated in the 2024 fiscal year, accounted for EUR 160.67 thousand in the 2024 fiscal year compared to EUR 188.27 thousand in 2023. In addition, the previous year's figure includes an amount of EUR 181.50 thousand attributable to companies of the ARUDI Group that were included in the 2023 consolidated financial statements until the deconsolidation in September 2023.

Income from the disposal of and appreciation of non-current assets includes an amount of EUR 2,764.97 thousand (previous year EUR 3,118.61 thousand) from the sale of securities by CHAPTERS Group AG. Of exceptional relevance in the 2024 fiscal year are the expenses of EUR 3,523.27 thousand (previous year: EUR 3,036.13 thousand) included income from the deconsolidation of companies of which EUR 2,101.22 thousand (previous year: EUR 2,035.22 thousand) is attributable to non-cash income from deconsolidation.

Depreciation and amortization

	2024 in EUR '000	Previous year in EUR '000
Amortization of intangible assets and depreciation of property, plant and equipment from purchase price allocation	-3,439.35	-2,009.57
Amortization of intangible assets at the level of the individual companies	-1,027.81	-440.14
Depreciation of property, plant and equipment for individual companies	-1,771.06	-1,045.18
Amortization of goodwill from consolidation	-14,105.38	-8,954.06
On current assets (to the extent that these exceed the company's normal depreciation)	-28.02	-25.57
Depreciation and amortization	- 20,371.63	- 12,474.52

The amortization of intangible fixed assets and depreciation of property, plant and equipment from purchase price allocation results in an amount of EUR 915.58 thousand from companies that became part of the group in the 2024 fiscal year. EUR 1,687.41 thousand results from companies that were already consolidated for their entire fiscal year in 2023. An amount of EUR 836.36 thousand results from companies that were only included in the Group pro rata in the previous year for EUR 322.70 thousand.

EUR 408.16 thousand of the amortization of intangible fixed assets of the individual companies results from companies that became part of the group in the 2024 fiscal year. EUR 488.38 thousand results from companies that were already consolidated with their full year results in the 2023 fiscal year. EUR 131.27 thousand results from companies that were only included in the Group pro rata in the previous year with an amount of EUR 59.23 thousand.

The depreciation of property, plant and equipment of the individual companies results in the amount of EUR 357.78 thousand from companies that became part of the group in the 2024 fiscal year. An amount of EUR 942.71 thousand results from companies that were already included in the scope of consolidation for their entire fiscal year in 2023. EUR 470.57 thousand results from companies that were only included in the Group on a pro rata basis in the previous year with an amount of EUR 154.02 thousand. The ENTRO Group, which was deconsolidated in the 2024 fiscal year, accounted for a total of EUR 191.76 thousand in the 2024 fiscal year and EUR 143.75 thousand in the previous year. In addition, the previous year's figure includes EUR

121.04 thousand attributable to companies of the ARUDI Group that were included in the consolidated financial statements for 2023 until the deconsolidation in September 2023.

The amortization of goodwill from consolidation results in EUR 2,201.75 thousand from companies that became part of the group in the 2024 fiscal year. EUR 6,236.74 thousand results from companies that were already consolidated for their entire fiscal year in 2023, whereby the value increased by EUR 678.97 thousand in the fiscal year due to the change in shares in individual companies (mainly the increase in shares in Ookam Software GmbH). EUR 5,666.88 thousand results from companies that were only included in the Group on a pro rata basis in the previous year and were included at EUR 2,201.50 thousand in the previous year. The ENTRO Group, which was deconsolidated in the 2024 fiscal year, accounted for EUR 898.67 thousand in the 2024 fiscal year and EUR 492.78 thousand in the previous year. In addition, the previous year's figure includes EUR 1,175.99 thousand attributable to companies of the ARUDI Group that were included in the 2023 consolidated financial statements until the deconsolidation date in September 2023.

OTHER OPERATING EXPENSES

	2024 in EUR '000	Previous year in EUR '000
Room costs	-4,539.23	-2,619.86
Insurance/contributions	-965.44	-364.98
Vehicle costs	-1,718.75	-1,280.81
Advertising and travel expenses	-5,064.83	-2,195.27
Maintenance and repair	-1,188.50	-643.65
Legal and consulting costs	-3,123.74	-1,608.80
Costs for bookkeeping and preparation of annual financial statements	-1,264.78	-746.22
Costs resulting from the corporate form of CHAPTERS Group AG (including the costs of auditing the consolidated and annual financial statements)	-604.14	-376.76
External services	-2,140.64	-224.69
Licenses and concessions	-1,065.36	-488.31
Other operating costs	-5,086.47	-3,975.58
Ordinary operating expenses	-26,761.88	-14,524.93
Expenses from currency translation	-392.83	-608.21
Expenses relating to other periods	-284.31	-129.30
Losses from the disposal of fixed assets	-83.07	-2,306.08
Losses from impairments, from the disposal of current assets and additions to the value adjustment for receivables	-94.83	-25.64
Other operating expenses	-27,616.92	-17,594.17

Losses from the disposal of non-current assets include EUR 70.89 thousand (previous year EUR 2,121.05 thousand) in losses from the sale of securities held as fixed assets at the level of CHAPTERS Group AG.

Of the operating expenses of EUR 26,761.88 thousand, EUR 3,526.09 thousand is attributable to companies that became part of the group in the 2024 fiscal year. EUR 14,160.34 thousand is attributable to companies that were included in the consolidated financial statements for their entire fiscal year in both the 2024 and 2023 fiscal years (previous year: EUR 10,396.01 thousand). The increase is due to higher (one-off) legal and consulting costs in connection with external financing taken out in 2024 and higher costs in connection with additional revenue in 2024. EUR 6,365.98 thousand results from companies that were only included on a pro rata basis in the consolidated

financial statements in the previous year with an amount of EUR 920.99 thousand. Taking into account the results prior to the date of initial consolidation, the operating expenses for these companies amounted to EUR 4,971.08 thousand in the previous year. The companies of the ENTRO Group are included in the 2024 fiscal year with their results up to September 2024. In the 2023 fiscal year, some of the companies were also only included on a pro rata basis. Operating expenses attributable to the companies in 2024 amount to EUR 2,709.47 thousand compared to EUR 1,750.90 thousand in the 2023 consolidated financial statements.

The 2023 consolidated financial statements also include other operating expenses of the companies of the ARUDI Group of EUR 1,457.03 thousand. The companies of the ARUDI Group were included for 2023 with their results up to the deconsolidation in September 2023 and are no longer included in 2024.

Result from associated companies

	2024 in EUR '000	Previous year in EUR '000
Distributions received	0.00	798.00
Net profit for the year attributable to CHAPTERS Group AG	491.99	1,036.69
Net loss for the year attributable to CHAPTERS Group AG	-149.46	-149.50
Losses in excess of the carrying amount	142.27	114.50
Net profit for the year used for the reversal of impairment losses	-17.15	0.00
Offsetting net income for the year against losses carried forward from previous years	0.00	-161.72
Amortization of goodwill	-795.09	-508.74
Reversal of negative goodwill	20.59	65.45
Total result from associated companies	-306.86	1,194.66

In the 2024 fiscal year, CHAPTERS Group AG received no distributions from associated companies in the 2024 fiscal year (previous year: EUR 1,316.70 thousand).

INCOME FROM OTHER SECURITIES AND LOANS CLASSIFIED AS FINANCIAL ASSETS

Of the income of EUR 408.71 thousand (previous year: EUR 694.84 thousand), EUR 242.09 thousand is due to dividends and interest received by CHAPTERS Group AG on bond investments in the securities portfolio (previous year: EUR 181.52 thousands and EUR 369.16 thousand) from interest received from CHAPTERS Group AG on bond investments in the securities portfolio. EUR 118.38 thousand (previous year: EUR 93.83 thousand) includes interest on loans to companies in which an equity interest is held. EUR 7.81 thousand (previous year: EUR 50.33 thousand) includes interest on other loans from financial assets.

OTHER INTEREST AND SIMILAR INCOME

Other interest and similar income totaling EUR 1,691.39 thousand (previous year: EUR 828.54 thousand) mainly results from interest income

on the shares in the perpetual bond held by CHAPTERS Group AG itself as well as from interest income on bank deposits and interest rate hedges.

DEPRECIATION ON FINANCIAL ASSETS

The depreciation on financial assets of EUR 1,131.14 thousand (previous year: 1,529.15 thousand) are entirely due to unscheduled depreciation on securities held by CHAPTERS Group AG as the ultimate parent company as part of liquidity management.

INTEREST AND SIMILAR EXPENSES

Of the interest and similar expenses of totaling EUR 5,392.86 thousand (previous year: EUR 4,223.52 thousand), EUR 1,992.69 thousand (previous year: 1,836.49 thousand) are due to the pro rata temporis reversal of the discount for the bond included in accrued items in CHAPTERS Group AG as the ultimate parent company in the 2024 fiscal year. At subsidiary level, interest expenses amount to EUR 3,400.17 thousand (previous year: EUR 2,335.46 thousand) and are mainly incurred for the acquisition loans taken out by the companies to (re-)finance the purchase prices paid for the acquisition of new companies.

INCOME TAXES

Income taxes are paid at the level of the respective individual companies. Income tax groups regularly exist between the acquisition company and the operating company in which the acquisition company holds a direct interest. There are no other consolidated tax groups for income tax purposes, so that losses in other Group companies are not offset.

MINORITY INTERESTS IN THE RESULT

Minority interests of EUR -778.08 thousand (previous year: EUR - 2,306.62 thousand) are reported in net from shares in profits and losses. The profit attributable to minority interests amounts to EUR 2,606.13 thousand (previous year: EUR 1,361.52 thousand) and is offset against a loss share of EUR -3,384.21 thousand (previous year: EUR -3,668.14 thousand).



WUPPERTAL

HEADQUARTERS OF DIVERA GMBH

F. Other information

EMPLOYEES

The average number of employees in the 2024 fiscal year was 805 (previous year: 952). Of these, 300 employees work for companies in which Ookam Software GmbH holds the majority of shares, 185 employees work for companies in which NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH holds the majority of shares, 72 employees work for companies in which Fintiba GmbH holds the majority of shares, 36 employees work for companies in which Altamount Software GmbH holds the majority of the shares, 34 employees at companies in which mlog capital SAS holds the majority of shares, 29 employees at companies in which CarMa Holding GmbH holds the majority of shares, 26 employees at companies in which Waterkant Software GmbH holds the majority of shares and 19 employees at companies in which CHAPTERS Switzerland Software GmbH holds the majority of shares. 16 people are employed at Kältehelden GmbH. 83 employees are attributable to companies that are no longer part of the Group at the end of the year. The number of employees at CHAPTERS Group AG as the parent company is five (previous year: three). For companies that became part of the group in the 2024 fiscal year, employees are only included on a pro rata basis for the period in which the company was part of the Group. Managing directors or, in the case of CHAPTERS Group AG, members of the Management Board are not included in the calculation of the number.

OTHER FINANCIAL OBLIGATIONS

On the reporting date, there were other financial obligations from rental and leasing agreements amounting to EUR 6,467.11 thousand.

FEE OF THE AUDITOR OF THE CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

The fee for the Group auditor for audit services is expected to amount to approximately EUR 220.00 thousand for the 2024 financial year (prior year: EUR 135.5 thousand). This includes the fee for the audit of the consolidated and separate financial statements of CHAPTERS Group AG, as well as the audits of (consolidated) financial statements of domestic subsidiaries. In addition, other services rendered by BDO abroad within the Group were invoiced at approximately EUR 27.00 thousand.

INFORMATION ABOUT THE EXECUTIVE BODIES

Appointed as a member of the **Management Board** in the 2024 fiscal year:

1. Mr. Jan-Hendrik Mohr, Hamburg, MSc. Financial Mathematics, BSc. Business administration, banker (Chairman of the Executive Board since October 19, 2021)
Mr. Jan-Hendrik Mohr was appointed to the company's Management Board on March 1, 2020. Mr. Jan-Hendrik Mohr is also Managing Director of JMX Capital GmbH, Hamburg, and Chairman of Software Circle plc (formerly Grafenia plc), Manchester, UK.
Within the Management Board, Mr. Jan-Hendrik Mohr is responsible for Mergers & Acquisitions and Fundamental Issues and - together with Ms. Marlene Carl - for Investor Relations, Treasury and IT.
2. Ms. Marlene Carl, Hamburg, MSc. Finance, BSc. Business administration, bank clerk
Ms. Marlene Carl was appointed to the company's Management Board as of October 19, 2021. Ms. Marlene Carl is also a member of

the board of directors of Tucows Inc. based in Toronto, Canada.

Within the Management Board, Ms. Marlene Carl is responsible for Finance, Administration and Taxes and - together with Mr. Jan-Hendrik Mohr - for Investor Relations, Treasury and IT.

Members of the **Supervisory Board** were elected in the 2024 fiscal year:

1. Dr. Mathias Saggau, Bonn, Investment Manager, MSA Capital GmbH, (Chairman of the Supervisory Board)
2. Dr. Martin Possienke, Bad Homburg v. d. Höhe, Investment Manager, Falkenstein Management GmbH (Deputy Chairman). Chairman of the Supervisory Board)
3. Ms. Edda Heidbrink, Cologne, lawyer, self-employed (Deputy Chairman) Chairman of the Supervisory Board). Ms. Edda Heidbrink is also a member of the Supervisory Board of AMEVIDA SE.
4. Mr. Paul Buser, Bradenton (Florida), USA, Investment Manager, Sator Grove Holdings. Mr. Paul Buser is also a member of the Supervisory Board of Kimelo, San Francisco (California), USA and of Hunt Club, Inc., Chicago, USA

REMUNERATION OF THE EXECUTIVE BODIES

In the 2024 fiscal year, the executive board received fixed remuneration totaling EUR 288.75 thousand (previous year: EUR 296.8 thousand). In addition to the fixed remuneration, the company's supervisory board also established a virtual share option plan ("VSOP") for the company's Management Board in the 2023 fiscal year, which incentivizes the long-term increase in the company's value and rewards a sustainable increase in the share price.

As part of the VSOP, the Executive Board was granted a total of 1,000,000 virtual share options with a start date of January 1, 2023, which can be exercised at the earliest on December 31, 2026, and at the latest on December 31, 2027. Each option entitles the holder to payment of the difference between the relevant share price at the time of exercise (calculated as the volume-weighted average price of the last 30 trading days) and the strike price set by the Supervisory Board. The strike price for the share options for the Management Board was set at EUR 22.27 per option. The remuneration under the VSOP for the Management Board is capped at a maximum of EUR 12.0 million per Management Board member; this amount would be reached four years after the grant date if the relevant share price exceeds EUR 46.27. Payment can be made in cash or by delivery of shares in CHAPTERS Group AG - settlement is at the discretion of the Supervisory Board.

The options are subject to a four-year vesting period, during which the options vest pro rata per quarter. Standard market "bad leaver" provisions, under which all options expire regardless of when they expire, are provided for. At the end of the four-year vesting period, the options can be exercised within one year. Payment is made in three installments, the first of which is one third of the total amount after exercise. The remaining amount is paid out in equal tranches one or two years after exercise, in each case multiplied by the development of the company's share price since exercise.

In the 2024 fiscal year, a total of 250,000 share options vested for the members of the management board, meaning that a total of 500,000 share options vested over the last two years. The amount of the resulting payment can be finally determined by December 31, 2026, at the earliest.

The Supervisory Board was granted remuneration totaling EUR 96.00 thousand.

dated financial statements of CHAPTERS Group AG are published in the company register.

GROUP RELATIONSHIPS

CHAPTERS Group AG, based in Hamburg, is the ultimate parent company and prepares consolidated financial statements and a Group management report for the 2024 fiscal year. The size criteria pursuant to Section 293 (1) HGB were exceeded for the first time in the 2021 fiscal year. The consoli-

APPROPRIATION OF EARNINGS

The Executive Board proposes to carry forward the accumulated loss of CHAPTERS Group AG as an individual company of EUR 2,966.99 thousand, consisting of a net profit for the year of EUR 3,637.67 thousand and a loss carried forward of EUR 6,604.67 thousand.

G. Supplementary report

By the time the financial statements were prepared, subsidiaries of CHAPTERS Group AG have acquired interests in six additional companies, two of which are based in France and one in Switzerland. For two further companies, contracts have already been signed, but closing is still pending.

In April 2025, the company directly acquired the shares in NGC CNC Beteiligungen GmbH and the underlying operating company direkt cnc-systeme GmbH, which were previously held indirectly via NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH, and increased its stake from 68% to 72%.

In connection with these transactions and, to a lesser extent, to finance the running costs of subsidiaries, CHAPTERS Group AG invested a total of EUR 31.5 million, thereof around EUR 21 million by means of shareholder loans and around EUR 10.3 million by means of equity contribution.

From the refinancing of shareholder loans through bank financing at subsidiary level, CHAPTERS Group AG has around EUR 33.5 million in addition, interest for previous years amounting to EUR 0.73 million was paid by the subsidiaries.

In April 2025, an MBO of NGC Nachfolgekapital GmbH and a separate MBO of its subsidiary GfW Gesellschaft für Weiterbildung with its five operating subsidiaries took place. The company received EUR 7.65 million as a result; an amount of EUR 1.40 million was deferred as a seller loan.

In May 2025, the merger of Fintiba GmbH and its wholly owned subsidiary Coracle GmbH (acquired in December 2024) with Expatrio Global Services GmbH was notarized. The CHAPTERS Group (indirectly) holds a 61.8% stake in the newly created company compared to the previous (indirect) 55% stake in Fintiba GmbH. CHAPTERS Beteiligungsgesellschaft GmbH has assumed a total purchase price obligation of EUR 61.6 million for the increase in its stake in the combined company. A portion of this will be paid in cash, while shareholders of Expatrio Global Services GmbH will receive 36.6% of the limited partnership shares in CHAPTERS Beteiligungen 1 GmbH & Co. KG, which in turn holds a 48.9% stake in Frankfurt International Bank AG, as a further component of the purchase price. Following implementation of the transaction, CHAPTERS Group AG's indirect shareholding in Frankfurt International Bank AG will be reduced to

31.0%. EUR 20 million of the purchase price obligation relates to shareholders of Fintiba GmbH and was deferred as a seller loan. It is intended to offer the shareholders of Fintiba to contribute their purchase price claim to CHAPTERS Group AG as part of a capital increase against contribution in kind from authorized capital in return for the granting of shares after the transaction has been completed. At the combined company level, EUR 93.2 million in debt was raised in the course of the transaction; these liabilities are not guaranteed by CHAPTERS Group AG.

On March 17, 2025, the company submitted a buy-back offer for EUR 16.00 million nominal amount of the perpetual bond at a price of 98.72% of the nominal amount. The company was tendered a nominal volume of around EUR 10.00 million, which was accepted in this amount. The outflow of liquidity for the company amounts to around EUR 9.88 million. In addition, the company has announced the full repayment of the bond on May 28, 2025, and the additional outflow of liquidity amounts to around EUR 6.0 million.

On April 7, 2025, the increase in share capital by EUR 471.22 thousand through cash contributions using the authorized capital (2024/I) resolved by the Management Board with the approval of the Supervisory Board on March 31, 2025 was registered. Following registration, the company's share capital amounts to EUR 23,457.25 thousand.

Hamburg, May 26, 2025


.....
Jan-Hendrik Mohr
CEO


.....
Marlene Carl
CFO

Group fixes asset schedule as of December 31, 2024

Acquisition and production costs						
	01/01/2024 in EUR '000	Additions in EUR '000	Rebookings in EUR '000	Disposals in EUR '000	Consolidation- related changes in EUR '000	12/31/2024 in EUR '000
I. Intangible assets	140,682.37	116,893.62	0.00	-155.34	8,009.79	265,430.43
1. Purchased concessions, industrial property rights and similar rights and assets of which from purchase price allocation	24,408.07 19,869.21	17,379.98 16,725.67	7.64	-155.34	14,974.91 -24.07	56,615.25 36,570.80
2. Goodwill of which from consolidation	116,259.11 115,499.44	99,368.77 99,368.87			-6,965.12 -11,940.20	208,662.86 202,928.11
3. Advance payments made	15.19	144.77	-7.64			152.32
II. Property, plant and equipment	13,388.02	3,704.78	0.00	-738.14	5,093.54	21,448.19
1. Land and buildings	1,333.19	19.25			495.88	1,848.32
2. Property, plant and equipment	1,061.33	432.58		-46.46	230.93	1,678.38
3. Other equipment, operating and office equipment	10,335.86	1,534.33	10.52	-691.69	3,616.72	14,805.75
4. Advance payments and assets under construction	657.65	1,718.62	-10.52		750.00	3,115.74
III. Financial assets	34,731.80	32,013.71	-1,217.63	-10,886.47	241.59	54,883.00
1. Shares in associated companies	16,414.60	20,212.20	2,347.73			38,974.54
2. Shares in affiliated companies (not consolidated)	1,217.63		-1,217.63			0.00
3. Loans to associated companies	1,365.00	290.00				1,655.00
4. Other participations	1,097.84		-12.50		49.50	1,134.84
5. Securities held as fixed assets	14,396.48	10,321.94	-2,335.23	-10,646.22	190.11	11,927.07
6. Other loans	240.25	1,189.57	0.00	-240.25	1.99	1,191.55
Total fixed assets	188,802.19	152,612.10	-1,217.63	-11,779.96	13,344.92	341,761.62

Depreciation and amortization							Book value		
	01/01/2024 in EUR '000	Additions in EUR '000	Disposals in EUR '000	Effects from currency translation in EUR '000	Consoli- dation- related changes in EUR '000	12/31/2024 in EUR '000	Effects from appreciation, interest income and results from associated companies (net) in EUR '000	12/31/2024 in EUR '000	12/31/2023 in EUR '000
I. Intangible assets	-23,595.26	-18,685.46	148.11	-1.23	-15,717.81	-57,851.66		207,578.77	117,087.11
1. Purchased concessions, industrial property rights and similar rights and assets of which from purchase price allocation	-7,197.39 -4,278.39	-4,280.74 -3,552.28	148.11	-0.04 -0.25	-13,369.17 3.61	-24,699.22 -7,827.30		31,916.03 28,743.50	17,210.68 15,590.82
2. Goodwill of which from consolidation	-16,397.88 -15,821.36	-14,404.73 -14,105.38		-119 -119	-2,348.64 1,445.29	-33,152.44 -28,482.64		175,510.42 174,445.46	99,861.23 99,678.08
3. Advance payments made	0.00				0.00			152.32	15.19
II. Property, plant and equipment	-6,313.41	-1,658.14	585.47	-1.25	-3,402.40	-10,789.73		10,658.45	7,074.61
1. Land and buildings	-127.24	61.51		-0.09	-456.44	-522.27		1,326.05	1,205.94
2. Property, plant and equipment	-248.00	-175.11	46.39	-116	-195.83	-572.54		1,105.84	813.33
3. Other equipment, operating and office equipment	-5,938.17	-1,544.54	539.08		-2,750.13	-9,694.92		5,110.82	4,397.69
4. Advance payments and assets under construction	0.00					0.00		3,115.74	657.65
III. Financial assets	-3,620.49	-1,131.14	455.68	0.00	0.00	-4,351.72	-853.93**	49,677.36	30,287.01
1. Shares in associated companies	0.00					0.00	-956.20	38,018.34	15,586.76
2. Shares in affiliated companies (not consolidated)	0.00					0.00		0.00	1,217.63
3. Loans to associated companies	0.00					0.00	54.98	1,709.98	1,375.45
4. Other participations	-1,072.84					-1,072.84		62.00	25.00
5. Securities held as fixed assets	-2,603.41*	-1,131.14	455.68			-3,278.87		8,648.20	11,793.07
6. Other loans	0.00					0.00	47.29	1,238.84	289.10
Total fixed assets	-33,529.16	-21,474.74	1,189.26	-2.48	-19,120.22	-72,937.35	-853.93	267,914.58	154,448.72

* Depreciation and appreciation from previous years are offset.
** Aggregated presentation including prior-period impacts.

Independent Auditor's Report

To CHAPTERS Group AG, Hamburg

AUDIT OPINIONS

We have audited the consolidated financial statements of CHAPTERS Group AG, Hamburg, and its subsidiaries (the Group), consisting of the consolidated balance sheet as of December 31, 2024, the consolidated income statement, the consolidated statement of changes in equity, and the consolidated cash flow statement for the fiscal year from January 1, 2024 to December 31, 2024, as well as the notes to the consolidated financial statements, including a summary of significant accounting policies.

In addition, we have audited the combined management report of CHAPTERS Group AG for the fiscal year from January 1, 2024 to December 31, 2024.

- Based on the findings of our audit, in our opinion:
- ❖ the accompanying consolidated financial statements comply, in all material respects, with the requirements of German commercial law and, in accordance with the German principles of proper accounting, provide a true and fair view of the Group's net assets, financial position, and results of operations as of December 31, 2024 and for the fiscal year from January 1, 2024 to December 31, 2024; and
 - ❖ the accompanying combined management report as a whole provides an accurate view of the Group's position. In all material respects, this combined management report is consistent with the consolidated financial statements, complies with German legal requirements, and appropriately presents the opportunities and risks of future development.

In accordance with § 322 paragraph 3 sentence 1 of the German Commercial Code (HGB), we declare that our audit has not led to any objections regarding the propriety of the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report.

BASIS FOR THE AUDIT OPINIONS

We conducted our audit of the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report in accordance with § 317 HGB and in compliance with the German generally accepted standards for financial statement audits as promulgated by the Institut der Wirtschaftsprüfer (IDW). Our responsibilities under those requirements and principles are further described in the section "AUDITOR'S RESPONSIBILITY FOR THE AUDIT OF THE CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS AND THE COMBINED MANAGEMENT REPORT" of our auditor's report. We are independent of the Group entities in accordance with the provisions under German commercial and professional law and have fulfilled our other professional responsibilities in accordance with these requirements.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinions on the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report.

OTHER INFORMATION

The legal representatives or the supervisory board are responsible for the other information. The other information includes all parts of the annual report except for the audited consolidated financial statements, the combined management report, and our auditor's report.

Our audit opinions on the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report do not cover the other information, and accordingly, we do not express any audit opinion or any other form of assurance thereon.

In connection with our audit of the consolidated financial statements, it is our responsibility to read the other information and to consider whether

- ❖ there are material inconsistencies with the consolidated financial statements, the combined management report, or the knowledge obtained during the audit, or
- ❖ the other information otherwise appears to be materially misstated.

RESPONSIBILITY OF THE LEGAL REPRESENTATIVES AND THE SUPERVISORY BOARD FOR THE CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS AND THE COMBINED MANAGEMENT REPORT

The legal representatives are responsible for the preparation of the consolidated financial statements in accordance with the requirements of German commercial law in all material respects and that, in compliance with the German principles of proper accounting, the consolidated financial statements provide a true and fair view of the net assets, financial position, and results of operations of the Group.

They are also responsible for such internal controls as they determine are necessary under the German principles of proper accounting to enable the preparation of consolidated financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the consolidated financial statements, the legal representatives are responsible for assessing the Group's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless actual or legal circumstances indicate otherwise.

Furthermore, the legal representatives are responsible for the preparation of the combined management report that as a whole provides a suitable view of the Group's position and is consistent with the consolidated financial statements in all material respects, complies with the German statutory requirements, and appropriately presents the opportunities and risks of future development.

They are also responsible for the precautions and measures (systems) deemed necessary to enable the preparation of the combined management report in accordance with applicable German legal provisions and to provide sufficient appropriate evidence for the statements made therein.

The supervisory board is responsible for overseeing the financial reporting process used to prepare the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report.

AUDITOR'S RESPONSIBILITY FOR THE AUDIT OF THE CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS AND THE COMBINED MANAGEMENT REPORT

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the consolidated financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and whether the combined management report as a whole provides an accurate view of the Group's position, is

consistent in all material respects with the consolidated financial statements and the findings of the audit, complies with German legal requirements, and appropriately presents the opportunities and risks of future development, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our audit opinions on the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report.

Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but not a guarantee, that an audit conducted in accordance with § 317 HGB and the German generally accepted standards for financial statement audits as established by the IDW will always detect a material misstatement. Misstatements may arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these consolidated financial statements and the combined management report.

As part of an audit in accordance with these standards, we exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism throughout the audit. We also:

- ❖ identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinions. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than for one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal controls;
- ❖ obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit of the consolidated financial statements and of the systems relevant to the audit of the combined management report in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the

purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the Group's internal controls or systems;

- ❖ evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used by the legal representatives and the reasonableness of estimates and related disclosures made by them;
- ❖ conclude on the appropriateness of the legal representatives' use of the going concern basis of accounting and, based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the Group's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in our auditor's report to the related disclosures in the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify our audit opinion. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our auditor's report. However, future events or conditions may cause the Group to cease to continue as a going concern;
- ❖ evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the consolidated financial statements, including the disclosures, and whether the consolidated financial statements present the underlying transactions and events in a manner that achieves fair presentation in accordance with the German principles of proper accounting;
- ❖ plan and perform the audit of the consolidated financial statements so as to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence regarding the financial information of the entities or business activities within the Group to express audit opinions on the consolidated financial statements and the combined management report. We are responsible for the direction, supervision, and performance of the group audit. We remain solely responsible for our audit opinions;
- ❖ evaluate the consistency of the combined management report with the consolidated financial statements, its compliance with the

law, and the overall presentation of the Group's position;

- ❖ perform audit procedures on the forward-looking statements made by the legal representatives in the combined management report. On the basis of sufficient appropriate audit evidence, we in particular evaluate the significant assumptions used by the legal representatives as a basis for the forward-looking statements and evaluate the proper derivation of the forward-looking statements from these assumptions. We do not express a separate audit opinion on the forward-looking statements or on the assumptions on which they are based. There is a significant unavoidable risk that future events will differ materially from the forward-looking statements.

We communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that we identify during our audit.

Hamburg, May 26, 2025

BDO AG Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft

s/ Härle
Public Auditor

s/ Ramm
Public Auditor

